

Kannada, Step by Step, Root by Root

An etymology-driven curriculum, built one word at a time

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This edition compiled incrementally — new chapters added as they
are written.

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Preface

This book teaches Kannada one word at a time, and it teaches each word by taking it apart. It is written for someone starting from zero — who may not read a single Kannada letter — so the script is taught *inside the word lessons themselves*: each word introduces exactly the letters it needs, so you learn to read ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ and learn that it means “greetings” in the same few minutes. There is no alphabet drill to sit through first. (A reader who already reads Kannada simply skims the “letters in this word” notes.)

Kannada is one of the four literary **Dravidian** languages — a family entirely separate from the Indo-European one that gave us English, Latin, and Sanskrit. Its own personality shows in one contrast, drawn again and again in these pages: where its oldest sister **Tamil** guards its native word-stock, Kannada borrowed *freely* from Sanskrit. So “hello” is the Sanskrit ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ (namaskāra) — yet “no” and “okay” are the native Dravidian ಇಲ್ಲ (illa) and ಸರಿ (sari), shared almost unchanged with Tamil. Each lesson sets the word beside its cousins across the family — English always, and Sanskrit, Hindi, and the other Dravidian languages where they illuminate — every form supplied in full, so no prior knowledge of any of them is assumed.

How to use this book

Every numbered section is one word, or one small phrase, and takes a few minutes — the length of a queue, an errand, or the walk to the bus. Read them in order the first time through: each section stands on the ones before it, and nothing is used before it has been taught. After that the book becomes reference, and you can open it anywhere.

Say the Kannada out loud wherever you can. The prompts under *Your turn* are written to be spoken, and saying a word is most of what makes it stay. The questions under *Before you move on* carry their own answers in brackets: cover them, answer from memory, then look.

Nothing here is gated behind the alphabet. Each lesson introduces exactly the letters and sounds its own word needs, so you are reading real words from the first page rather than drilling a chart. The whole script is gathered in a reference at the back of the book — somewhere to look things up when you are curious, never a chapter to sit through first.

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Chapter 1

Greetings

Modes: 👁 eyes (6) ⇌ **Hands-free start:** first 1 of 6 lessons.

The Kannada greetings and the words that oil a first conversation — and, taught through them, how to read the Kannada script and how Kannada sits inside the Dravidian family. Each lesson introduces the letters its word needs, so you learn to read the word and understand it at once.

1.1 ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ (*namaskāra*) — “greetings,” a making of a bow

The letters in this word

Kannada reads **left to right**, and every consonant carries a built-in “a.” ನ na, ಮ ma, ರ ra. A **vowel sign** changes that vowel: ಕ ka + the long-“ā” sign → ಕಾ kā. And a vowel-less consonant **stacks under** the next as a conjunct (*ottakṣara*): ಸ loses its vowel and tucks under ka → ಸ್ಕ “ska.” Read ನ·ಮ·ಸ್·ಕಾ·ರ → *namaskāra*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ (*namaskāra*) is **not** native Kannada — it is **Sanskrit**: *namas* (“a bow, homage”) + *kāra* (“a making,” from the root *kr*, “to do”) = “the making of a bow.” The very same word as Hindi *namaskār*. Where its sister Tamil kept a home-grown greeting (*vaṇakkam*), Kannada borrowed freely from Sanskrit — the theme of this whole book.

Across the family — the same idea, five ways

Language	“Hello”	Source
Kannada	ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ <i>namaskāra</i>	Sanskrit
Telugu	<i>namaskāram</i>	Sanskrit
Malayalam	<i>namaskāram</i>	Sanskrit
Hindi	<i>namaste</i>	Sanskrit
Tamil	<i>vaṇakkam</i>	native Dravidian
English	<i>hello</i>	Germanic

Tamil alone kept its own word; the rest lean on the Sanskrit *namas-*.

Why it’s said this way

Said with the palms pressed together and a small bow — the gesture *is* the word. It serves as both **hello and goodbye**, any time, to almost anyone, respectful without being stiff.

1.2 ಧನ್ಯವಾದ (*dhanyavāda*) — “thank you,” an utterance of “worthy”

The letters in this word

New: ಧ *dha* (an **aspirated** *d* — a puff of breath), and the conjunct ನ್ಯ (*na* stacked with *ya* → “*nya*”). ವಾ is *vā*. Read ಧ·ನ್ಯ·ವಾ·ದ → *dhanyavāda*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಧನ್ಯವಾದ (*dhanyavāda*) is **Sanskrit**: *dhanya* (“worthy, blessed,” from *dhana*, “wealth”) + *vāda* (“a saying,” root *vad*, “to speak”) = “an utterance of ‘[you are] worthy.’” The same word as Hindi *dhanyavād* and Telugu *dhanyavādamulu*.

Across the family — the same idea, five ways

Language	“Thanks”	Note
Kannada	ಧನ್ಯವಾದ <i>dhanyavāda</i>	Sanskrit
Telugu	<i>dhanyavādamulu</i>	Sanskrit — same word
Hindi	<i>dhanyavād</i>	Sanskrit — same word
Tamil	<i>nanri</i>	native (“goodness”)
Malayalam	<i>nandi</i>	native — Tamil’s cousin

A stark split: Kannada, Telugu, Hindi take the Sanskrit word; Tamil and Malayalam keep native *nanri* / *nandi*.

1.3 ಹೌದು (*haudu*) — “yes”

The letters in this word

ಹೌ is *hau* (ಹ *ha* with the “au” vowel sign hugging it); ದು is *du* (ದ *da* with the “u” sign beneath). Read ಹೌ·ದು → *haudu*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹೌದು (*haudu*) is the everyday “yes / that’s so” — a genuinely **native** Kannada word, after two Sanskrit loans.

Grammar Lens

Like its sister Tamil, Kannada often says “yes” by **echoing the verb**: asked *bandiddīyā?* (“have you come?”), a natural yes is *bandiddēne* (“I have come”). Bank *haudu* as the simple word, but expect a “yes” to come back as a whole verb — a habit shared across the Dravidian family.

1.4 ಇಲ್ಲ (*illa*) — “no,” a word Tamil shares almost exactly

The letters in this word

ಇ is the **independent vowel** “i” (word-initial, so a full letter). ಲ್ಲ is “lla” — ಲ *la* vowel-stripped and stacked under another *la*, a held “ll.” Read ಇಲ್ಲ → *illa*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಇಲ್ಲ (*illa*) is built on the old Dravidian root *il*, “not-being” — so, like Tamil *illai*, it really means “[it] is not, [there] is not,” serving as the everyday “no.” Its positive twin is ಇದೆ (*ide*), “there is.”

Grammar Lens

Dravidian negates by *being*. Where English inserts *not*, Kannada — exactly like Tamil — swaps in the negative verb of existence: *pustaka ide* (“there *is* a book”) → *pustaka illa* (“there *is not* a book”). A shared inheritance: Tamil *illai*, Kannada *illa*, Malayalam *illa* — one family, one way to say a thing is not.

Across the family — the same idea, five ways

Language	“No / isn’t”	Note
Kannada	ಇಲ್ಲ <i>illa</i>	native (root <i>il</i>)
Tamil	<i>illai</i>	the <i>same</i> root
Malayalam	<i>illa</i>	the <i>same</i> root
Telugu	<i>lēdu</i>	native, a different root
Hindi	<i>nahīnī</i>	Indo-European (unrelated)

1.5 ಸರಿ (*sari*) — “okay,” shared whole with Tamil

The letters in this word

ಸ is *sa*; ರಿ is *ri* (ರ *ra* with the “i” sign). No conjunct here — two clean, round syllables. Read ಸ·ರಿ → *sari*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಸರಿ (*sari*) is native Dravidian for “correct, even, right,” and so “okay, agreed” — the verbal nod of Kannada. It is the *same word* as Tamil *sari* — identical in sound and meaning, only the script differs; doubled, *sari sari* means “alright, alright.”

Grammar Lens

One shared word, two scripts. *sari* is identical in Kannada and Tamil in sound and meaning — only the letters differ (Kannada writes it ಸರಿ, Tamil in its own script). Watching a shared word change its clothes but not its sound is the fastest way to feel how close these languages are — the pattern-matching that carries you across Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam.

1.6 Recap, and how Kannada says goodbye

Read		Meaning	Origin
ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ	<i>namaskāra</i>	hello	Sanskrit
ಧನ್ಯವಾದ	<i>dhanyavāda</i>	thank you	Sanskrit
ಹೌದು	<i>haudu</i>	yes	native
ಇಲ್ಲ	<i>illa</i>	no / isn't	native (= Tamil <i>illai</i>)
ಸರಿ	<i>sari</i>	okay	native (= Tamil <i>sari</i>)

The pattern is already visible: the two greeting/politeness words are Sanskrit loans; the three everyday grammar words are native Dravidian, two of them shared almost unchanged with Tamil.

Why it's said this way

The same “go and come back” as Tamil. Kannada, too, avoids a bare “I’m leaving.” The everyday goodbye is ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ (*hōgi baruttēne*), “having gone, I [will] come [back],” and the reply is ಹೋಗಿ ಬನ್ನಿ (*hōgi banni*), “go, and come back.” The very worldview inside Tamil’s *pōy varugirēn*: never simply depart — promise a return.

Next chapter: introducing yourself — *nanna hesaru...* (“my name...”) — and Kannada’s *nīnu* / *nīvu* (familiar / respectful “you”).

Chapter 2

Introducing Yourself

Modes: ⇄ voice (4) 👁 eyes (4) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 8 lessons.

Now a first real exchange — giving your name, asking for someone else’s, and saying you’re glad to meet them:

ನನ್ನ ಹೆಸರು ಅರುಣ್. (*nanna hesaru Arun* — “My name is Arun.”)
ನಿಮ್ಮ ಹೆಸರು ಏನು? (*nimma hesaru ēnu* — “What is your name?”)

Built the same way as the greetings — each piece taken apart, its letters and its root, then assembled.

2.1 ಹೆಸರು (*hesaru*) — “name,” and the *p-to-h* shift

The letters in this word

ಹ (*ha*) + ೀ (the *e*-sign) → ಹೆ (*he*); ಸ (*sa*); ರು (*ru*). Read ಹೆ·ಸ·ರು → *hesaru*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹೆಸರು (*hesaru*, “name”) is **native Dravidian**, from Proto-Dravidian *pesar — and it hides a famous Kannada sound-law: an old initial *p* became *h*. So *pesar → *hesar → *hesaru*. That makes it a *cousin* of Tamil *peyar* (same root; Tamil kept the *p*, Kannada softened it to *h*) — and, like *peyar*, *not* related to the Sanskrit *nāma* (Hindi *nām*, English *name*). The Dravidian south kept its own word for “name.”

Across the family — the same idea, five ways

Language	“Name”	Source
Kannada	ಹೆಸರು <i>hesaru</i>	Dravidian *pesar (p→h)
Tamil	<i>peyar</i>	the <i>same</i> Dravidian root (kept <i>p</i>)
Telugu	<i>pēru</i>	the <i>same</i> Dravidian root
Malayalam	<i>pēr</i>	the <i>same</i> Dravidian root
Hindi	<i>nām</i>	Sanskrit (Indo-European)
English	<i>name</i>	Indo-European

The $p \rightarrow h$ shift is why *hesaru* looks unlike its sisters — but it is the same word.

2.2 ನನ್ನ (*nanna*) — “my”

The letters in this word

ನ (*na*) + the conjunct ನ್ನ (*nn*) → *nanna* — a doubled, held *nn*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನನ್ನ (*nanna*, “my”) is the possessive of ನಾನು (*nānu*, “I”) — native Dravidian, on the pronoun stem *nān, the same one behind Tamil *nān* / *en*. It has no Indo-European cousin: the Dravidian “I/my” is a different word from the European *I/my*.

2.3 ನನ್ನ ಹೆಸರು ... (*nanna hesaru ...*) — “my name is...”

ನನ್ನ (my) + ಹೆಸರು (name) + name = **nanna hesaru ...** *Nanna hesaru Arun.*
= “My name is Arun.”

Grammar Lens

No word for “is.” As in Tamil, notice there is *no* verb: Kannada sets “my name” beside “Arun” and lets the “is” be understood — the **zero copula** of the Dravidian family. *Nanna hesaru Arun* = literally “my name Arun.”

2.4 ನೀನು / ನೀವು (*nīnu* / *nīvu*) — “you,” familiar and respectful

The letters in this word

ನೀ (*nī*) + ನು (*nu*) → *nīnu*; ನೀ + ವು (*vu*) → *nīvu*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನೀನು (*nīnu*, familiar “you”) ← Proto-Dravidian **nīn* — the same native root as Tamil *nī*. ನೀವು (*nīvu*) is the respectful/plural “you.”

Grammar Lens

Respect by the plural, once more. *nīnu* (familiar) vs. *nīvu* (respectful, and literally plural) — the same politeness-by-plural as Tamil *nīṅgaḷ* and French *vous*. For a first meeting, *nīvu*.

2.5 ಏನು (*ēnu*) — “what”

The letters in this word

ಏ (independent long *ē*, word-initial) + ನು (*nu*) → *ēnu*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಏನು (*ēnu*, “what”) is native Dravidian, on the interrogative stem **yā-* / **e-* — the same Dravidian question-root as Tamil *enna*, heading Kannada’s question family: *ēnu* (what), *yāru* (who), *elli* (where), *yāke* (why).

2.6 ನಿಮ್ಮ ಹೆಸರು ಏನು? — “what’s your name?”

ನಿಮ್ಮ (*nimma*, “your”) is the possessive of *nīvu* (“you,” respectful). So ನಿಮ್ಮ ಹೆಸರು ಏನು? is literally “**your name what?**” — and again *no “is.”* Three words, no verb.

Grammar Lens

Answer with the sentence you built: *Nanna hesaru Arun*. The familiar “your” is *ninna* (from *nīnu*): *ninna hesaru ēnu*?

2.7 ಸಂತೋಷ (santōṣa) — “joy,” and “pleased to meet you”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The warm close is ನಿಮ್ಮನ್ನು ಭೇಟಿಯಾಗಿ ಸಂತೋಷ (nimmannu bhēṭiyāgi santōṣa) — “**having met you, joy.**” But note the key word: ಸಂತೋಷ (santōṣa, “joy, contentment”) is **Sanskrit** (*sam*- “fully” + *toṣa* “satisfaction”), not native. Where Tamil reaches for its home-grown *magilcci*, Kannada — true to form — uses a Sanskrit word even for “pleased.” The same split you saw over “hello” and “thanks” runs right through the introductions.

2.8 The whole exchange

Kannada		English
ನನ್ನ ಹೆಸರು ಮೀರಾ.	<i>nanna hesaru Mira</i>	My name is Mira.
ನಿಮ್ಮ ಹೆಸರು ಏನು?	<i>nimma hesaru ēnu</i>	What’s your name?
ನನ್ನ ಹೆಸರು ಅರುಣ್.	<i>nanna hesaru Arun</i>	My name is Arun.
ಸಂತೋಷ.	<i>santōṣa</i>	Pleased to meet you.

Every atom traced: *hesaru* (Dravidian *pesar, p→h; *not name*), *nanna* (from *nānu*, “I”), *ēnu* (Dravidian question-stem) — and *santōṣa*, a Sanskrit loan for “pleased,” the family thread again. The Kannada habit to keep: the **zero copula** (no “is”). Next chapter: *hēgiddīra*? (“how are you?”) and answering with *chennāgiddēne* — the responding cycle.

Chapter 3

How Are You?

Modes: ⇐ voice (1) ⇐ eyes (5) ⇐ Hands-free start: all 6 lessons.

After the name comes the exchange everyone actually has — carried by the Dravidian verb “to be”:

ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? (nīvu hēgiddīrā — “How are you?”)
ನಾನು ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ, ಧನ್ಯವಾದ. (nānu cennāgiddēne, dhanyavāda — “I’m well, thank you.”)

3.1 ಹೇಗೆ (hēge) — “how,” another of the ē-questions

The letters in this word

ಹೇ (hē) + ಗೆ (ge) → ಹೇಗೆ (hēge).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹೇಗೆ (hēge, “how”) is native Dravidian, on the interrogative base ē-/yā- from ēnu. Kannada gathers its questions here: ēnu (what), hēge (how), yāru (who), elli (where), yāvāga (when). It is the same Dravidian question-root heading Tamil’s *eppaṭi* and Telugu’s *elā* — a family older than the Sanskrit words Kannada otherwise borrows so readily.

3.2 ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? — “how are you?”

The new word is ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ (hēgiddīrā): hēge (“how”) fused with the verb ಇರು (iru, “to be, exist, stay”) + the respectful-you ending. So ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ?

is “you how are?”, the verb last, as in every Kannada sentence. The verb *iru* is the very same native Dravidian “to be” that Tamil uses — and (Chapter 5) the verb for “I live.”

Grammar Lens

The verb carries “you.” The ending already means “you (respectful),” so *nīvu* can be dropped. To a friend: ನೀನು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀಯಾ? (*nīnu hēgiddīyā?*). Match the “you” to the verb-ending.

3.3 ನಾನು (*nānu*) — “I,” the Dravidian first person

The letters in this word

ನಾ (*nā*) + ನು (*nu*) → ನಾನು (*nānu*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನಾನು (*nānu*, “I”) ← Proto-Dravidian *yān / *nān — native, and (unlike Hindi’s *main*, cousin of English *me*) **not** related to the European “I/me” family. Its possessive is the ನನ್ನ (*nanna*, “my”) you met in Chapter 2. Kannada borrows Sanskrit freely for higher vocabulary, but its bedrock pronouns stayed Dravidian.

3.4 ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ (*cennāgi*) — “well,” and how to answer

The letters in this word

ಚೆ (*ce* — the letter ಚ is “ch as in *cheese*”) + ನ್ನಾ (*nnā*) + ಗಿ (*gi*) → ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ (*cennāgi*, “well, nicely”) is native Dravidian, from ಚೆನ್ನು (*cennu*, “good, beautiful”) + the adverb-maker *-āgi* (“in a ... way”) — so it means, at heart, “in a beautiful way.” The root *cennu* is pure Kannada, no Sanskrit or European cousin.

Fuse it with *iru*: ನಾನು ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ (*nānu cennāgiddēne*) — “I am well.”

3.5 ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ (*paravāgilla*) — “no problem”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ means “it does not matter / there is no harm” — *paravā* (“harm”) + ಇಲ್ಲ (*illa*, “is-not”), the Chapter-1 negative. It serves as “it’s okay / no worries / you’re welcome.” The atom ಇಲ್ಲ (*illa*) is Kannada’s “is-not,” the mirror of *iru* (“is”). It is shared, almost unchanged, across **Kannada, Tamil, and Malayalam** — a deep Dravidian bond; only Telugu breaks away to *lēdu* (so Telugu’s “no problem” is *paravāledu*, Kannada’s *paravāgilla*).

Grammar Lens

Illa negates existence and stands alone as “no”: *dudḍu illa* (“there’s no money”). Hold *iru* / *illa* together — “is” and “is-not.”

3.6 The whole exchange

Kannada	English
ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ?	How are you?
ನಾನು ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ, ಧನ್ಯವಾದ.	I'm well, thank you.
ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ.	No problem / you're welcome.

Every atom is traced. *Hēge* belongs to the native *ē*- question family; *nānu* is Proto-Dravidian, unrelated to *me*; and *cennāgi* means “beautifully.” The *iru* / *illa* pair supplies “is” and “is-not,” with *illa* shared by Tamil and Malayalam. Next chapter: the farewells — and Kannada, like all its family, never says a plain “goodbye.”

Chapter 4

Farewells

Modes: ⇐ voice (1) ◉ eyes (4) ⇐ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

Kannada, like every Dravidian language, does not say a plain “goodbye.” It promises to return:

ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ. (*hōgi baruttēne* — “I’ll go and come back.”)

4.1 ಹೋಗು (*hōgu*) — “go,” and ಬಾ (come)

The letters in this word

ಹೋ (*hō*) + ಗು (*gu*) → ಹೋಗು. Its partner ಬಾ (*bā*, “come”).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹೋಗು (*hōgu*, “to go”) and ಬಾ (*bā*, “come”) are native Dravidian verbs. As commands they are whole words: *hōgu!* (“go!”), *bā!* (“come!”). You need both, because Kannada’s goodbye is “I go, and I *come back*.”

4.2 ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ (*hōgi baruttēne*) — “I’ll go and come back”

ಹೋಗಿ (*hōgi*, “having gone”) + ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ (*baruttēne*, “I come”) — literally “**having gone, I come [back]**,” i.e. “I’ll go and come back.” A Kannada speaker never signs off with a bare “I’m leaving.” The warm reply is ಹೋಗಿ ಬನ್ನಿ (*hōgi banni*, “go and come [back]”).

Across the family — the same idea, five ways

Language	“go and come back” (goodbye)
Kannada	<i>hōgi baruttēne</i>
Tamil	<i>pōy varugirēṇ</i>
Telugu	<i>velli vastānu</i>
Malayalam	<i>pōyi varām</i>
Bengali (Indo-Aryan)	<i>āshi</i> (“I come”)

The whole south, and beyond, prefers a promise of return to a blunt farewell.

4.3 ನಾಳೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ (*nāḷe sigōṇa*) — “see you tomorrow”

The letters in this word

ನಾಳೆ (*nāḷe*): ನಾ (*nā*) + ಳೆ (*ḷe*, retroflex ಳ *ḷ*). ಸಿಗೋಣ (*sigōṇa*) = *sigu* (“meet”) + *-ōṇa* (“let’s”).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನಾಳೆ (*nāḷe*, “tomorrow”) is native, from *nāl* (“day”) — the same root as Tamil’s *nāḷai*. ಸಿಗು (*sigu*, “to meet, be found”) gives *sigōṇa* (“let’s meet”) — “tomorrow, let’s meet.” The *-ōṇa* ending is Kannada’s warm “let’s ...”: *hōgōṇa* (“let’s go”).

4.4 ಮತ್ತೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ — “we’ll meet again”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಮತ್ತೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ = ಮತ್ತೆ (*matte*, “again”) + *sigōṇa* (“let’s meet”). Both are native Dravidian: *matte* (“again”) and *sigu* (“to meet”). Where Tamil’s “we’ll meet again” reaches for the Sanskrit loan *sandi*, Kannada keeps the native *sigu* — the same phrase, from home-grown stock.

4.5 The farewells

Kannada	English
ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ.	I'll go and come back. (goodbye)
ಹೋಗಿ ಬನ್ನಿ.	Go and come back. (the reply)
ನಾಳೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ.	See you tomorrow.
ಮತ್ತೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ.	We'll meet again.

Roots banked: *hōgu/bā* (go/come), *nāle* (“tomorrow” ← *nāl* “day,” shared with Tamil), and *sigu* (“meet,” native — where Tamil borrowed *sandi*). Next chapter: the first real verbs — *nānu kannada mātanāḍuttēne* — and Kannada’s sentences begin to move.

Chapter 5

The First Verbs

Modes: ⇐ voice (1) ◉ eyes (4) ⇐ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

Until now, “to be” and “to be-not.” Now verbs that *act* — and Kannada’s sentences begin to move:

ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ. (*nānu kannaḍa mātanāḍuttēne* — “I speak Kannada.”)

5.1 ಮಾತನಾಡು (*mātanāḍu*) — “to speak,” your first full verb

The letters in this word

ಮಾ (*mā*) + ತ (*ta*) + ನಾ (*nā*) + ಡು (*ḍu*) → ಮಾತನಾಡು.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಮಾತನಾಡು (*mātanāḍu*, “to speak”) is native Dravidian, built on ಮಾತು (*mātu*, “word, speech”). To say “I speak,” Kannada stacks two endings on the stem — tense then person:

mātanāḍ- + *-utt-* (present) + *-ēne* (“I”) → ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ
(*mātanāḍuttēne*), “I speak.”

The *-ēne* ending is “I,” so *nānu* is rarely needed: *mātanāḍuttāne* (he), *mātanāḍuttāṇe* (she), *mātanāḍuttāre* (they / you-respectful).

Grammar Lens

Stem + tense + person. Every Kannada verb is built this way. And, like Tamil and Telugu, Kannada marks **no gender in the first person**: *mātanāḍuttēne* is the same for a man or a woman.

5.2 ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ — “I speak Kannada”

ನಾನು (I) + ಕನ್ನಡ (*kannaḍa*, the object) + ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ (speak) — “I Kannada speak,” verb last. The name ಕನ್ನಡ (*kannaḍa*) is native, often linked to *kar-nāḍu* (“the high/black land,” whence *Karnataka*). Kannada has a literature over a thousand years old and a store of classical honours — a classical tongue of some fifty million speakers.

Grammar Lens

No gender on “I speak.” *Mātanāḍuttēne* is the same whether a man or a woman says it — Kannada, like Tamil and Telugu, marks no gender in the first or second person (only the third: *-āne* he, *-āḷe* she).

5.3 ಇರು (*iru*) — “to be, to stay, to live”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಇರು (*iru*, “to be, exist, stay, live”) is native Dravidian — the very same *iru* Tamil uses, and the verb behind Chapter 3’s *hēgiddīrā* (“how are you”) and *cennāgiddēne* (“I’m well”). It also means “to reside”: ನಾನು ಬೆಂಗಳೂರಿನಲ್ಲಿ ಇದ್ದೇನೆ (*nānu Beṅgaḷūrinalli iddēne*, “I live in Bangalore”). One verb covers “be,” “stay,” and “live.”

Grammar Lens

“In” comes after the noun. ಬೆಂಗಳೂರಿನಲ್ಲಿ (*Beṅgaḷūrinalli*) = *Beṅgaḷūru* + *-alli* (“in”), glued to the *end* of the noun. Kannada uses **postpositions** (case-suffixes): “Bangalore-in I am,” the verb last.

5.4 ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡು (*kelasa māḍu*) — “to work”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಮಾಡು (*māḍu*, “to do, make”) is a core native verb, and Kannada — like Hindi with *karnā*, Tamil with *sey*, and Telugu with *cēyu* — builds compounds by putting a noun in front of it: ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡು (*kelasa māḍu*, “work-do” = “to work”), *aḍuge māḍu* (“to cook”), *sahāya māḍu* (“to help,” with a **Sanskrit** noun on the **native** *māḍu*). So “I work” is ನಾನು ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ (*nānu kelasa māḍuttēne*).

Grammar Lens

Noun + ಮಾಡು = a new verb — the exact twin of Hindi’s “noun + *karnā*,” Tamil’s “noun + *sey*,” and Telugu’s “noun + *cēyu*.” Four languages, two from an unrelated family, all landed on the same trick.

5.5 Sentences about yourself

Kannada	English
ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ.	I speak Kannada.
ನಾನು ಬೆಂಗಳೂರಿನಲ್ಲಿ ಇದ್ದೇನೆ.	I live in Bangalore.
ನಾನು ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ.	I work.

Three verbs, one engine: a stem, a tense-marker, a person-ending, the verb always last — and no gender in the first person. Roots banked: *mā-tanāḍu* (speak ← *mātu* “word”), *iru* (be/stay/live, with *-alli* “in” on the noun’s end), and *māḍu* (do → *kelasa māḍu* “to work,” the twin of Hindi’s *karnā*). From here, Kannada’s sentences only grow.

Chapter 6

Case Endings and Dative Subjects

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) 👁 eyes (2) ✍ pen (2) ⇄ **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say that I know Kannada the way Kannada itself says it — with no subject at all, marking myself with the dative -ge.

Say ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು — “to-me Kannada known” — set against ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ, then line up the four Dravidian datives -ge · -ukku · -ku · -ikku.

6.1 -ಗೆ (-ge) — “to, for”

Your first **case ending**. English puts “to” in **front**, as a separate word. Kannada sticks it on the **back** — the biggest structural fact about the language, in one suffix.

You’ll want to know: Adding it on

word	+ -ge	meaning
ಹೆಸರು <i>hesaru</i> — name	ಹೆಸರ ^{ಗೆ} ಗೆ <i>hesarige</i>	to/for the name
ಕೆಲಸ <i>kelasa</i> — work	ಕೆಲಸಕ್ಕೆ <i>kelasakke</i>	for work

Two shapes, one suffix: **-ige** after some stems, **-kke** after others. Kannada adjusts it to fit the word in front — but you can still see exactly where the noun stops and the ending starts.

And with “I”, which reshapes first:

ನಾನು *nānu* (“I”) → ನನಗೆ *nanage* (“to me”)

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

All four descend from one Proto-Dravidian dative, **-k(k)u**. Look at what became of its *k*:

language	dative
Tamil	-ukku
Telugu	-ku / -ki
Malayalam	-ikku / -inu
Kannada	-ge / -ige

Kannada is the one that **voiced** it — *k* → *g* between vowels — and carried that change into the dative, where its sisters kept the hard consonant. Note the other Kannada form, **-kke**: a **doubled** consonant resists voicing, so the geminate preserved the original *k*. The two Kannada shapes are the same suffix caught on either side of a sound change.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “hesaru ... hesarige”
- “nānu ... nanage” — “I” ... “to me”
- “kelasakke” — “for work,” from Ch. 5’s ಕೆಲಸ
- the family — “-ukku · -ku · -ge · -ikku”

Before you move on

What does **-ಗೆ** mean? (“**To**” or “**for**.”) Where does it go? (**On the end** of the noun.) What is “to me”? (ನನಗೆ *nanage*.) Why does Kannada have *g* where its sisters have *k*? (Kannada **voiced** the *k* between vowels; doubled **-kke** resisted and kept the old hard form.)

6.2 -ಗೆ — one suffix, one job

You can now attach **-ಗೆ** and make ನನಗೆ “to me.” Look at what that visible seam tells you about how Kannada builds longer words.

Grammar Lens: Stacking versus fusion

	Kannada -ge	a Latin ending like -īs
pins down the case?	yes — dative, always	no — dative or ablative
carries number?	no — a separate suffix does	yes — plural, baked in
carries declension class?	no	yes — first or second
can you see the seam?	yes: <i>hesar + ige</i>	no — one fused lump

Kannada **stacks** suffixes. Each suffix carries one meaning and sits in a fixed order, so the learner can see where the noun ends and the case marker begins. That is what **agglutinative** means here: longer words are assembled from pieces whose jobs remain visible.

Latin **fuses** several jobs into one ending. *-īs* carries case, plural number, and declension class at once—and it does not even settle whether the case is dative or ablative. Kannada **-ŕ** carries one unambiguous job: “to/for.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hesar + ige* — a visible noun-plus-case seam
- Kannada *-ge* — one job, dative
- Latin *-īs* — case, plural, and declension fused

Before you move on

Why is Kannada called agglutinative? (**It stacks visible pieces, each with one job.**) How many jobs can Latin *-īs* fuse? (**Case, number, and declension class—and its case can still be dative or ablative.**)

6.3 ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು — “I know Kannada”

Chapter 5 gave you ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ — “I speak Kannada” — with the verb ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ. Now say “I **know** Kannada.” Kannada will not let you use *nānu*.

You’ll want to know: The sentence

ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು. *nanage kannada gottu*. literally: “**to-me** Kannada [is] **known**.”

piece

ನನಗೆ <i>nanage</i>	“to me” — the dative from the last lesson
ಕನ್ನಡ <i>kannada</i>	Kannada (Ch. 5)
ಗೊತ್ತು <i>gottu</i>	“known”

Two things to notice. **You are not the subject** — *nānu* is gone, moved into the dative, leaving *kannada* as the unmarked word the sentence is about. And *gottu* isn’t really a verb doing an action; it’s closer to “[is] **known**.” So nothing in this sentence is *doing* anything at all.

Grammar Lens: Why: things that happen *to* you

Kannada separates what you **do** from what **happens to** you. Speaking is an action, so Ch. 5 used *nānu*. But knowing, liking, wanting, being hungry — these **arrive**. Kannada marks that by putting the person in the **dative**.

English frames it as	Kannada frames it as
I know Kannada	Kannada is known to me
I like it	it is pleasing to me
I am cold	cold is to me

English keeps one fossil of the same idea: “**methinks**” — where *me* is a dative, “it seems **to me**.” Kannada made it a rule.

Grammar Lens: All four sisters do it

language	“I know [the language]”	the dative
Kannada	<i>nanage kannāḍa gottu</i>	-ge
Tamil	<i>enakku tamil teriyum</i>	-ukku
Telugu	<i>nāku telugu vaccu</i>	-ku
Malayalam	<i>enikku malayāḷam ariyām</i>	-ikku

One construction, four languages, four suffixes that are visibly the **same suffix** — Kannada’s *g* being the softened *k* of the others. The Dravidian family showing its bones, exactly as *blanc/bianco/branco* did for Romance.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*nanage kannāḍa gottu*”
- the contrast — “*nānu kannāḍa mātanāḍuttēne*” (I speak) ... “*nanage kannāḍa gottu*” (known to me)
- the literal — “to-me Kannada known”
- the four cousins — “*-ge · -ukku · -ku · -ikku*”

Before you move on

What does ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು literally say? (“**To-me** Kannada **known**.”) What has English got that Kannada hasn’t? (A nominative “**I**” — *nānu* is replaced by the dative *nanage*.) Is *gottu* an action verb? (**No** — it’s “[is] known”; nothing is doing anything.) Why the dative? (Knowing **happens to** you.) Which English word keeps the same idea? (**Methinks**.)

6.4 ನ — one character, met inside words you already say

Rounded and looping like Telugu (its sister script), most letters topped by a small curved headstroke; no continuous top line.

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ನ

ನ — *na*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *n*, it is **na**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ನ somewhere inside it:

- ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ *namaskāra* — hello / greetings (namaskāra — “a making of a bow”)
- ಧನ್ಯವಾದ *dhanyavāda* — thank you (dhanyavāda — “an utterance of ‘worthy’”)
- ನನ್ನ *nanna* — my
- ನೀನು / ನೀವು *nīnu* / *nīvu* — you (familiar / respectful)

Writing: ನ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ನ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ನ in the ones that have it

ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ · ಧನ್ಯವಾದ · ಹೌದು

- *Trace it:* ನ three times, saying *na* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ನ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — **ನ**? What sound does it carry? (*na*.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

6.5 ಂ — one character, met inside words you already say

Rounded and looping like Telugu (its sister script), most letters topped by a small curved headstroke; no continuous top line.

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: **ಂ**

ಂ — *ba*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *b*, it is **ba**.

You already say these, and every one of them has **ಂ** somewhere inside it:

- ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ *hōgi baruttēne* — goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”)

Writing: **ಂ** — copy what you see

Put your pen on **ಂ** and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look*: at these words, and find **ಂ** in the ones that have it

ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ಬ three times, saying *ba* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ಬ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ಬ? What sound does it carry? (*ba.*)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 7

Numbers One to Ten

Modes: 👁 eyes (2) ✍ pen (2) 🖐 Hands-free start: none of the 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can count from one to ten in Kannada and read the Kannada digits ೦–೧೦ off the page.

Count ಒಂದು through ಹತ್ತು aloud, read the digits ೧ ೨ ೩ ೪ ೫ ೧೦, and hear the p → h shift that turns Tamil pattu into Kannada hattu.

7.1 ಒಂದು, ಎರಡು, ಮೂರು, ನಾಲ್ಕು, ಐದು — one to five

If you walked here through Tamil, you already know these numbers — Kannada just says them with its own accent.

You'll want to know: The five

	numeral	word	said
1	೦	ಒಂದು	<i>ondu</i>
2	೧	ಎರಡು	<i>eraḍu</i>
3	೨	ಮೂರು	<i>mūru</i>
4	೩	ನಾಲ್ಕು	<i>nālku</i>
5	೪	ಐದು	<i>aidu</i>

The single symbols ೦ ೧ ೨ ೩ ೪ ೫ are Kannada's own digits — you'll meet them on bus numbers and prices, distinct from the words above.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

These are **native Dravidian** numbers, not Sanskrit borrowings — the same word-stock Tamil kept. Line them up against Tamil and they are plainly the same word wearing a Kannada coat:

	Tamil	Kannada
2	<i>iraṇṭu</i>	eraḍu
3	<i>mūṇru</i>	mūru
4	<i>nāṇku</i>	nāḷku
5	<i>aintu</i>	aidu

One is the family’s odd number: Tamil *onru* and Kannada *ondu* are cousins (from an old *on-*), but Telugu will break rank with *okaṭi* when you get there. So learn *ondu* now, but expect Telugu’s “one” to surprise you.

Grammar Lens: A Kannada habit to notice

The **anusvara** — the small circle ◌◌ in ಒಂದು (*on-du*) — is a nasal that takes its colour from the letter after it: an *n* before *d* in *ondu*, an *m* before *b* later in *ombattu* (nine). One mark, whatever nasal the next consonant needs. You’ll see it constantly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ondu, eraḍu, mūru, nāḷku, aidu”
- the Tamil→Kannada shift — “iraṇṭu → eraḍu”, same number, new coat
- read the digits — ೧ ೨ ೩ ೪ ೫

Before you move on

Count to five in Kannada. (*Ondu, eraḍu, mūru, nāḷku, aidu.*) Are these borrowed from Sanskrit? (**No** — native Dravidian, shared with Tamil.) Which number will Telugu form differently? (**One** — *okaṭi*, vs Kannada *ondu*.) What does the ◌◌ anusvara do in *ondu*? (Stands for the nasal the next consonant needs — here *n* before *d*.) Next: six to ten.

7.2 ಆರು, ಏಳು, ಎಂಟು, ಒಂಬತ್ತು, ಹತ್ತು — six to ten

Five more — and the last one shows the single sound-change that most makes Kannada *sound* like Kannada.

You'll want to know: The five

	numeral	word	said
6	೬	ಆರು	<i>āru</i>
7	೭	ಏಳು	<i>ēlu</i>
8	೮	ಎಂಟು	<i>eṇṭu</i>
9	೯	ಒಂಬತ್ತು	<i>ombattu</i>
10	೧೦	ಹತ್ತು	<i>hattu</i>

(Ten needs two digits — ೧೦, a one and a zero — just like 10.)

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Put ten beside Tamil:

Tamil **pattu** → Kannada **hattu**.

Kannada systematically softened an old word-initial **p-** into **h-**. It isn't a one-off: it runs right through the language —

	Tamil	Kannada
ten	<i>pattu</i>	hattu
milk	<i>pāl</i>	hālu
tooth	<i>pal</i>	hallu

Once you know the rule, a Kannada *h-* word often hands you its Tamil cousin for free: hide the *h-*, restore a *p-*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Six and seven stay close cousins (Tamil *āru* / Kannada *āru*; Tamil *ēlu* / Kannada *ēlu* — note Kannada hardened Tamil's rare **l** into an ordinary retroflex **ḷ**). **Eight and nine** wander more: Kannada *eṇṭu* and *ombattu* are still relatives of Tamil *eṇṭu* and *onpatu*, but **Telugu** leaves the family entirely there (*enimidi*, *tommidi*) — so treat 8–9 as the loose cells.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “āru, ēlu, eṇṭu, ombattu, hattu”
- the shift — “pattu → hattu”, “pāl → hālu”: hide the h, find the p
- read the digits — ೬ ೭ ೮ ೯ ೦೦

Before you move on

Count six to ten in Kannada. (*Āru, ēlu, eṇṭu, ombattu, hattu.*) What regular shift turns Tamil *pattu* into Kannada *hattu*? (Word-initial **p-** → **h-** — also *pāl* → *hālu*.) What happened to Tamil’s rare **ḷ** in Kannada *ēlu*? (It hardened into an ordinary retroflex **ḷ**.) Which numbers should you trust least as family cousins? (**Eight and nine** — Telugu especially wanders.)

7.3 ಁ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ಁ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ಁ

ಁ — *u*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *u*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಁ somewhere inside it:

- ಹೌದು *haudu* — yes (haudu)
- ಹೆಸರು *hesaru* — name
- ನೀನು / ನೀವು *nīnu* / *nīvu* — you (familiar / respectful)
- ಏನು *ēnu* — what

Writing: ಁ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಁ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ಁ in the ones that have it

ಹೌದು · ಹೆಸರು · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ಁ three times, saying *u* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ಁ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ಁ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *u* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

7.4 ೀ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ೂ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ೀ

ೀ — *e*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *e*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ೀ somewhere inside it:

- ಹೆಸರು *hesaru* — name
- ಹೇಗೆ *hēge* — how
- ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ *cennāgi* — well, nicely — and the reply ”ನಾನು ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ
- ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ *hōgi baruttēne* — goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”)

Writing: ೀ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ೀ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ೀ in the ones that have it

ಹೆಸರು · ಹೇಗೆ · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ೀ three times, saying *e* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ೀ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ೀ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *e* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 8

Please

Modes: 👁 eyes (1) ✍ pen (2) 🖐 Hands-free start: none of the 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say please in Kannada, and use the polite verb ending Kannada reaches for far more often than the word itself.

Build ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು out of daya (“compassion”) + ittū (“having placed”), then make the everyday polite request instead: ಕುಳಿತುಕೊಳ್ಳಿ, “please sit.”

8.1 ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು (dayaviṭṭu) — please (having placed compassion)

Kannada’s everyday “please” is, once you open it up, a small act of generosity: “having **placed** compassion” between us.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು = please, literally “having placed compassion / kindness.” Two pieces:

- ದಯ (daya) = compassion, kindness, grace — from Sanskrit daya.
- ಇಟ್ಟು (ittu) = “having placed / set down,” from the verb ಇಡು (idu) “to place, to put.”

So dayaviṭṭu means, at heart, *setting kindness down (before you)* — asking the listener to act from compassion.

That is exactly how **Tamil** builds it (*tayavu seytu*, “do the kindness”), and the same instinct as **Arabic** *min faḍlik* (“from your **grace**”) and **Hindi** *kṛpayā* (from *kṛpā*, “**compassion**”). A wide arc of Asia says *please* by naming the kindness it hopes for.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

daya + a light verb, four times over:

- Kannada ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು *dayaviṭṭu* — compassion + **having placed**
- Tamil தயவுசெய்து *tayavu seytu* — kindness + **do**
- Telugu దయచేసి *dayacēsi* — compassion + **having done**
- Malayalam ദയവായി *dayavāyi* — compassion + **as / having become**

Why it’s said this way

The honest note: a standalone please-word is a little **formal / emphatic**. Everyday Kannada politeness leans on the **respectful command** — the verb ending -ಇ (-i): ಕುಳಿತುಕೊಳ್ಳಿ (*kuḷitukolli*) “please sit,” ಹೇಳಿ (*hēḷi*) “please tell me.” That ending already means “please” do this. Add ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು in front when you want to underline the courtesy.

The letters in this word

Look at ಟ್ಟು — a **doubled** *ṭ*. The first ಟ್ is *ṭa* silenced by the **virama** (its vowel cut), and it tucks **under** the next letter as an *ottu* (a subscript form) before ಟು *ṭu*. Kannada writes a double consonant by stacking, not repeating side by side — a neat contrast with how the Roman alphabet just writes “tt.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “daya” — compassion — then “iṭṭu,” having placed
- the whole word — “dayaviṭṭu” = please

- the everyday way — the verb ending: “kuḷitukolli” = please sit

Before you move on

What is the Kannada word for please? (ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು *dayavittu*.) What do its pieces mean? (“**Compassion**” *daya* + “**having placed**” *ittu*.) Which cousins ask the same way? (**Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam** with *daya* — plus **Arabic** *faḍl*, **Hindi** *kṛpā*.) What carries “please” in ordinary speech? (**The respectful verb ending** -ಇ -i.)

8.2 ಿ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ಂ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ಿ

ಿ — *no sound of its own — it takes one away.*

It is a **vowel-killer**. Every consonant in this script arrives with an *a* already inside it — that is what an abugida is. This mark takes the *a* back, leaving the bare consonant. It is how the script writes two consonants in a row.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಿ somewhere inside it:

- ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ *namaskāra* — hello / greetings (namaskāra — “a making of a bow”)
- ಧನ್ಯವಾದ *dhanyavāda* — thank you (dhanyavāda — “an utterance of ‘worthy’”)
- ಇಲ್ಲ *illa* — no / there isn’t (illa — the negative)
- ನನ್ನ *nanna* — my

Writing: ூ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ூ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ூ in the ones that have it
ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ · ಧನ್ಯವಾದ · ಹೌದು
- *Trace it:* ூ three times, and each time say what it does: **it kills the built-in a**
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ூ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ூ? What does it do to the consonant it sits on? (**Takes away the built-in a.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

8.3 ௃ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ூ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ௃

ೃ — *ga*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *g*, it is **ga**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ௃ somewhere inside it:

- ಹೇಗೆ *hēge* — how
- ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? *nīvu hēgiddīrā* — how are you? (respectful)
- ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ *cennāgi* — well, nicely — and the reply ”ನಾನು ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ
- ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ *paravāgilla* — it’s okay / no problem / you’re welcome

Writing: ಗ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಗ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ಗ in the ones that have it
- ಹೇಗೆ · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ
- *Trace it:* ಗ three times, saying *ga* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ಗ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ಗ? What sound does it carry? (*ga.*)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 9

Sorry

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) ✍️ pen (2) 🖐️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can apologise in Kannada and ask someone to forgive me.

Say ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ, trace it back through kṣamisu to Sanskrit kṣamā, and contrast it with Tamil's unrelated mannikkavum.

9.1 ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ (kṣamisi) — forgive me / sorry

You already know ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು (*dayaviṭṭu*), “please.” Kannada’s “sorry” reuses a trick you’ll see everywhere in this language: taking a Sanskrit noun and turning it into a working Kannada verb.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- ಕ್ಷಮಾ (*kṣamā*) = “**patience, forbearance, forgiveness**” — a Sanskrit noun, unchanged.
- -ಇಸು (*-isu*) = a **verb-making suffix**: bolt it onto a Sanskrit noun and you get a brand-new Kannada verb. *kṣamā* + *-isu* → ಕ್ಷಮಿಸು (*kṣamisu*), “**to forgive**.” (The same move builds ಪ್ರಾರಂಭಿಸು *prārambhisu*, “to begin,” from Sanskrit *prārambha*.)
- -ಃ (i) = the plain **imperative** ending — the very one you met on ಕುಲಿತುಕೊಲ್ಲಿ (*kulitukolli*) (“please sit”) in the please lesson.

So ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ is simply “**forgive!**” — *kṣamisu* wearing its imperative

ending.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Three of the four Dravidian cousins build “sorry” from the very same Sanskrit noun, each with its own verb-making suffix and its own imperative shape:

- Kannada ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ *kṣamisi* — Sanskrit *kṣamā* + **-isu** (verb) + **-i** (imperative)
- Telugu క్షమించండి *kṣamiṇcaṇḍi* — Sanskrit *kṣamā* + **-iṅcu** (verb) + **-aṇḍi** (imperative)
- Malayalam ക്ഷമിക്കണം *kṣamikkanaṇi* — Sanskrit *kṣama* + **-ikkuka** (verb) + **-aṇaṇi** (necessitative)
- Tamil மன்னிக்கவும் *mannikkavum* — its **own** native root *manni*, not Sanskrit at all

Why it’s said this way

ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ is a genuine, everyday way to say “sorry” — not overly formal — but in casual conversation you’ll also hear the softer ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ ಬಿಡಿ (*kṣamisi bidi*, roughly “just forgive [it]”) or simply the borrowed English “**sorry**,” which is extremely common in spoken Kannada.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*kṣamā*” — the Sanskrit noun, patience/forgiveness
- the verb — “*kṣamisu*,” to forgive — then “*kṣamisi*,” forgive!
- contrast — Tamil’s *mannikkavum* uses its own root instead

Before you move on

What is ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ built from? (Sanskrit *kṣamā* “forgiveness” + the verb-making suffix **-isu** + the imperative **-i**.) Which cousin languages do the same trick, and which one doesn’t? (Telugu and

Malayalam also verb-ify *kṣamā*; **Tamil** uses its own native root *manni* instead.) What do people often say casually instead? (**Kṣamisi biḍi**, or simply borrowed English “**sorry**.”)

9.2 ூ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ெ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ூ

ூ — *i*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *i*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ூ somewhere inside it:

- ಸರಿ *sari* — okay / alright / correct (sari)
- ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? *nīvu hēgiddīrā* — how are you? (respectful)
- ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ *cennāgi* — well, nicely — and the reply ”ನಾನು ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ
- ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ *paravāgilla* — it’s okay / no problem / you’re welcome

Writing: ூ — **copy what you see**

Put your pen on ூ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ೀ in the ones that have it

ಸರಿ · ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ೀ three times, saying *i* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ೀ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ೀ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *i* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

9.3 ೀ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ೀ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ೀ

ೀ — *la*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *l*, it is **la**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ೀ somewhere inside it:

- ನಾಳೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ *nāḷe sigōṇa* — see you tomorrow
- ಆರು ಏಳು ಎಂಟು ಒಂಬತ್ತು ಹತ್ತು — six to ten

Writing: ೀ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ೀ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ೀ in the ones that have it

ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ೀ three times, saying ೀa as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ೀ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ೀ? What sound does it carry? (la.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 10

Days of the Week

Modes:  voice (1)  pen (2)  Hands-free start: first 1 of 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name any day of the week in Kannada, including the Sunday that uses a different sun-name from Hindi's.

Run Somavāra through Śanivāra, then name Sunday ಭಾನುವಾರ and say why it is Bhānu here where Hindi says Ravi.

10.1 ಸೋಮವಾರ to ಭಾನುವಾರ — the Sanskrit week

Unlike Tamil and Malayalam, Kannada's week is built entirely from Sanskrit — the same recipe as Hindi's. But even here, one day picks a **different** Sanskrit word than Hindi does.

You’ll want to know: The pattern: [deity] + ವಾರ, “day”

Kannada	deity/planet	day
ಸೋಮವಾರ (<i>Somavāra</i>)	Moon (Soma)	Monday
ಮಂಗಳವಾರ (<i>Maṅgaḷavāra</i>)	Mars (Maṅgala)	Tuesday
ಬುಧವಾರ (<i>Budhavāra</i>)	Mercury (Budha)	Wednesday
ಗುರುವಾರ (<i>Guruvāra</i>)	Jupiter (Guru/ Br̥haspati)	Thursday
ಶುಕ್ರವಾರ (<i>Śukravāra</i>)	Venus (Śukra)	Friday
ಶನಿವಾರ (<i>Śanivāra</i>)	Saturn (Śani)	Saturday
ಭಾನುವಾರ (<i>Bhānuvāra</i>)	the Sun (Bhānu, “light, splendor”)	Sunday

Five of these are identical in shape to Hindi’s — same deity, same **-vāra/-vār** ending. **Sunday** is the interesting exception: where Hindi says रविवार (*Ravivār*, from *Ravi*, “sun”), Kannada says ಭಾನುವಾರ (*Bhānuvāra*), built on a **different** Sanskrit word for the sun — **Bhānu**, “light, splendor,” rather than *Ravi*. Sanskrit has **many** names for the sun, and different languages downstream picked different ones for their week.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “Somavāra, Maṅgaḷavāra, Budhavāra, Guruvāra, Śukravāra, Śanivāra” — Monday through Saturday
- the different one — “Bhānuvāra,” Sunday
- the contrast — Hindi says Ravivāra (Ravi), Kannada says Bhānuvāra (Bhānu) — two different Sanskrit sun-names

Before you move on

What ending does every Kannada weekday share, and where’s it from? (-ವಾರ *-vāra*, Sanskrit “day.”) Which day differs from Hindi’s version, and how? (**Sunday** — Kannada’s *Bhānuvāra* (“light”) uses a different Sanskrit sun-name than Hindi’s *Ravivār* (“Ravi”).)

10.2 ತ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ೀ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ತ

ತ — *ta*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *t*, it is **ta**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ತ somewhere inside it:

- ಸಂತೋಷ *santōṣa* — joy / pleased to meet you
- ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ *hōgi baruttēne* — goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”)
- ಮತ್ತೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ *matte sigōṇa* — we’ll meet again
- ಮಾತನಾಡು *mātanāḍu* — to speak

Writing: ತ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ತ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ತ in the ones that have it
ಸಂತೋಷ · ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ
- *Trace it:* ತ three times, saying *ta* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ತ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ತ? What sound does it carry? (*ta.*)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

10.3 ಓ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ಳ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ಓ

ಓ — *o*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *o*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಓ somewhere inside it:

- ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು *nanage kannada gottu* — 'I know Kannada'

Writing: ಓ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಓ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ಓ in the ones that have it

ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ㄹㅛ three times, saying *o* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ㄹㅛ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ㄹㅛ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *o* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 11

Four Core Colours

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ✍ pen (2) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 1 of 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name four basic colours in Kannada — black, white, red, and blue.

Say ಕಪ್ಪು, ಬಿಳಿ, ಕೆಂಪು — the three native colours — then the borrowed ನೀಲಿ, and point out that the week is Sanskrit where the colours are not.

11.1 ಕಪ್ಪು, ಬಿಳಿ, ಕೆಂಪು, ನೀಲಿ — native colors, after a fully Sanskrit week

Kannada’s week ran entirely on Sanskrit deity-names. Its colors tell a different story — here, native Dravidian vocabulary is back in charge, except for one familiar exception.

You’ll want to know: Three native colors

- ಕಪ್ಪು (*kappu*) = “**black**” — native Dravidian.
- ಬಿಳಿ (*bili*) = “**white**” — native Dravidian.
- ಕೆಂಪು (*kempu*) = “**red**” — native Dravidian.

You’ll want to know: The familiar borrowed blue

ನೀಲಿ (*nīli*) = “**blue**” — from the **same Sanskrit ನೀल (nīla)** that Tamil, Malayalam, and Hindi all reach for. Even Kannada, whose week went fully

Sanskritic, still keeps its everyday black/white/red **native** — it’s specifically **blue** that pulls in the Sanskrit word, across all four Dravidian languages and Hindi alike.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “kappu, bili, kempu” — black, white, red
- “nīli” — blue, the shared Sanskrit word
- the contrast — Kannada’s week is Sanskritic, but its colors (except blue) are native

Before you move on

Are Kannada’s black/white/red native or Sanskrit? (**Native Dravidian** — kappu, bili, kempu.) Which color is the shared Sanskrit loan across Kannada, Tamil, Malayalam, and Hindi? (**Blue** — ನೀಲಿ *nīli* / நீலம் *nīlam* / नील *nīla* / नीला *nīlā*.)

11.2 ದ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ತ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ದ

ದ — *da*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *d*, it is **da**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ದ somewhere inside it:

- ಧನ್ಯವಾದ *dhanyavāda* — thank you (dhanyavāda — “an utterance of ‘worthy’”)
- ಹೌದು *haudu* — yes (haudu)

- ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? *nīvu hēgiddīrā* — how are you? (respectful)
- ಒಂದು ಎರಡು ಮೂರು ನಾಲ್ಕು ಐದು *ondu eraḍu mūru nālku aidu* — one to five

Writing: ದ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ದ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ದ in the ones that have it

ಧನ್ಯವಾದ · ಹೌದು · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ದ three times, saying *da* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ದ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ದ? What sound does it carry? (*da*.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

11.3 ಇ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ಿ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ಇ

ಇ — *i*.

It is an **independent vowel** — the shape the vowel *i* takes when a word begins with it, rather than the sign it becomes inside a word.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಇ somewhere inside it:

- ಇಲ್ಲ *illa* — no / there isn't (illa — the negative)
- ಇರು *iru* — to be, to stay, to live

Writing: ಇ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಇ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ಇ in the ones that have it

ಇಲ್ಲ · ಇರು · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ಇ three times, saying *i* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ಇ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ಇ? What sound does it carry? (*i*.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 12

Family

Modes:  voice (1)  pen (2)  Hands-free start: first 1 of 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name my parents and my brothers and sisters in Kannada, choosing the right word for older or younger.

Name ಅಪ್ಪ and ಅಮ್ಮ, then the four age-graded siblings ಅಣ್ಣ · ತಮ್ಮ · ಅಕ್ಕ · ತಂಗಿ, where age is chosen before gender.

12.1 ಅಪ್ಪ, ಅಮ್ಮ, and four sibling words — the same system as Tamil

Kannada asks the same question Tamil does about any sibling: **older, or younger?** — and the words for answering it are almost identical.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- ಅಪ್ಪ (*appa*) = “**father**” — matches Tamil *appā* closely.
- ಅಮ್ಮ (*amma*) = “**mother**” — matches Tamil *ammā* closely.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Kannada	meaning	compare Tamil
ಅಣ್ಣ (anna)	older brother	annan — near match
ತಮ್ಮ (tamma)	younger brother	tambi — near match
ಅಕ್ಕ (akka)	older sister	akkā — near match
ತಂಗಿ (tangi)	younger sister	tangai — near match

Just like Tamil, Kannada has **no single word** that simply means “brother” or “sister” — you name the sibling’s **relative age** every time, not just their gender. This age-first system runs across the whole Dravidian family, not just one language.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “appa, amma” — father, mother
- “anna, tamma” — older/younger brother
- “akka, tangi” — older/younger sister

Before you move on

How many Kannada sibling words are there, and what do they split on? (**Four** — ಅಣ್ಣ/ತಮ್ಮ, ಅಕ್ಕ/ತಂಗಿ — split by **relative age**, not just gender.) How closely do Kannada’s words match Tamil’s? (**Very closely** — nearly the same forms across the whole set.)

12.2 ರ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ಡ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ರ

ರ — *ra*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *r*, it is **ra**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ರ somewhere inside it:

- ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ *namaskāra* — hello / greetings (namaskāra — “a making of a bow”)
- ಸರಿ *sari* — okay / alright / correct (sari)
- ಹೆಸರು *hesaru* — name
- ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? *nīvu hēgiddīrā* — how are you? (respectful)

Writing: ರ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ರ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ರ in the ones that have it
ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ · ಸರಿ · ಧನ್ಯವಾದ
- *Trace it:* ರ three times, saying *ra* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ರ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ರ? What sound does it carry? (*ra*.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

12.3 ಕ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ಇ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ಕ

ಕ — *ka*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *k*, it is **ka**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಕ somewhere inside it:

- ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ *namaskāra* — hello / greetings (namaskāra — “a making of a bow”)
- ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡು *kelasa māḍu* — to work (lit. “work-do”)
- ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು *nanage kannaḍa gottu* — ‘I know Kannada’
- ಒಂದು ಎರಡು ಮೂರು ನಾಲ್ಕು ಐದು *ondu eraḍu mūru nālku aidu* — one to five

Writing: ಕ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಕ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ಕ in the ones that have it

ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ · ಧನ್ಯವಾದ

- *Trace it:* क three times, saying *ka* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find क once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — क? What sound does it carry? (*ka*.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 13

Head and Hand

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ✍ pen (2) ⇄ **Hands-free start:** first 1 of 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the head and the hand in Kannada.

Say ತಲೆ and ಕೈ, and hear how nearly unchanged they are across Tamil, Malayalam and Kannada.

13.1 ತಲೆ, ಕೈ — head and hand, the shared Dravidian core

Three languages, nearly one word each — Kannada’s basic body parts line up with Tamil and Malayalam almost perfectly.

You’ll want to know: The words

- ತಲೆ (*tale*) = “**head**” — native Dravidian, matching Tamil *talai* and Malayalam *thala*.
- ಕೈ (*kai*) = “**hand**” — native Dravidian, matching Tamil and Malayalam’s *kai* almost exactly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “tale” — head

- “kai” — hand
- the match — nearly identical across Tamil, Malayalam, Kannada

Before you move on

What are Kannada’s words for head and hand? (ತಲೆ *tale*, ಕೈ *kai*.)
How closely do they match Tamil and Malayalam? (**Very closely**
— all three share essentially the same native Dravidian words.)

13.2 ಾ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ಠ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ಾ

ಾ — *ā*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *ā*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಾ somewhere inside it:

- ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ *namaskāra* — hello / greetings (namaskāra — “a making of a bow”)
- ಧನ್ಯವಾದ *dhanyavāda* — thank you (dhanyavāda — “an utterance of ‘worthy’”)
- ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? *nīvu hēgiddīrā* — how are you? (respectful)
- ನಾನು *nānu* — I

Writing: ಾ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಾ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ೀ in the ones that have it
ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ · ಧನ್ಯವಾದ · ಹೌದು
- *Trace it:* ೀ three times, saying ā as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ೀ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ೀ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts ā on; takes the built-in a off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

13.3 ಯ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ೀ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ಯ

ಯ — *ya*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *y*, it is **ya**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಯ somewhere inside it:

- ಧನ್ಯವಾದ *dhanyavāda* — thank you (dhanyavāda — “an utterance of ‘worthy’”)

- ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು *dayaviṭṭu* — please (dayaviṭṭu)

Writing: ಯ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಯ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ಯ in the ones that have it

ಧನ್ಯವಾದ · ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ಯ three times, saying *ya* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ಯ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ಯ? What sound does it carry? (*ya.*)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 14

Seasons

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ✍ pen (1) ⇄ **Hands-free start:** first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the four seasons in Kannada, including the monsoon that actually shapes the Karnataka year.

Say ಬೇಸಿಗೆ, ಮಳೆಗಾಲ and ಚಳಿಗಾಲ from native roots, then the doubly-Sanskrit ವಸಂತ ಋತು for spring.

14.1 ವಸಂತ ಋತು, ಬೇಸಿಗೆ, ಮಳೆಗಾಲ, ಚಳಿಗಾಲ — native words, plus a double Sanskrit loan

Kannada’s summer, rain, and cold words are native, just like Tamil’s — but its word for “spring” borrows **twice** from Sanskrit, not once.

You'll want to know: The words

Kannada	meaning	source
ವಸಂತ ಋತು (<i>vasanta ṛtu</i>)	“spring”	both <i>vasanta</i> AND <i>ಋತು ṛtu</i> (“season”) are Sanskrit
ಬೇಸಿಗೆ (<i>bēsige</i>)	“summer”	native Dravidian
ಮಳೆಗಾಲ (<i>maḷegāla</i>)	“rainy season”	ಮಳೆ <i>maḷe</i> , native Dravidian (“rain”) + ಕಾಲ <i>kāla</i> (“time,” itself a Sanskrit loan)
ಚಳಿಗಾಲ (<i>caḷigāla</i>)	“winter/cold season”	ಚಳಿ <i>caḷi</i> , native Dravidian (“cold”) + <i>kāla</i>

Why it's said this way

Where Tamil and Malayalam just say *kaalam* (“time/season,” itself ultimately Sanskrit-derived too, but assimilated long ago as ordinary vocabulary), Kannada's word for spring, **ವಸಂತ ಋತು**, keeps **both** halves visibly Sanskrit — *vasanta* the season-name, *ṛtu* the very word for “season.” Summer, rain, and cold, by contrast, are built on native Dravidian roots (*bēsige*, *maḷe*, *caḷi*).

And as with Tamil and Malayalam: it's **ಮಳೆಗಾಲ** (*maḷegāla*, the rains) that shapes Karnataka's agricultural year the most, not a clean four-way Western split.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “bēsige” — summer, native
- “maḷegāla” — the rains
- “caḷigāla” — the cold season, native
- the double loan — “vasanta ṛtu” — both halves Sanskrit

Before you move on

How does ವಸಂತ ಋತು differ from the Tamil/Malayalam spring-word? (**Both halves are Sanskrit** — *vasanta* and *ṛtu*, “season” itself — where Tamil/Malayalam just add the long-assimilated *kaalam*.) Which season actually shapes Karnataka’s year most? (ಮಳೆಗಾಲ, the rains.)

14.2 ಡ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ಯ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ಡ

ಡ — *ḍa*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *ḍ*, it is **ḍa**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಡ somewhere inside it:

- ಮಾತನಾಡು *mātanāḍu* — to speak
- ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡು *kelasa māḍu* — to work (lit. “work-do”)
- ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು *nanage kannaḍa gottu* — ‘I know Kannada’
- ಒಂದು ಎರಡು ಮೂರು ನಾಲ್ಕು ಐದು *ondu eraḍu mūru nālku aidu* — one to five

Writing: ಡ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಡ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here

until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ಡ in the ones that have it

ಮಾತನಾಡು · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ಡ three times, saying *ḍa* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ಡ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ಡ? What sound does it carry? (*ḍa*.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 15

Water and Rice

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) ✍️ pen (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask for water in Kannada and tell raw rice apart from cooked rice.

Say ನೀರು — matching Tamil’s neer, not Malayalam’s — then separate ಅಕ್ಕಿ, raw rice, from ಅನ್ನ, the cooked rice on the plate.

15.1 ನೀರು, ಅಕ್ಕಿ, ಅನ್ನ — water matching Tamil, and rice, raw and cooked

Kannada’s water-word sides with Tamil, not with Malayalam’s surprising break from the pack.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನೀರು (*nīru*) = “**water**” — matching Tamil’s நீர் (*nīr*, the root inside *tanṇīr*) closely. Kannada didn’t make Malayalam’s switch to the *vel*-“bright/white” root.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- ಅಕ್ಕಿ (*akki*) = “**rice**” (raw grain).
- ಅನ್ನ (*anna*) = “**cooked rice**” (the meal) — likely Sanskrit-influenced, the same general idea as Tamil’s *sātam*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nīru” — water, matching Tamil
- “akki” — raw rice
- “anna” — cooked rice

Before you move on

Does Kannada’s water-word match Tamil’s or Malayalam’s?
(**Tamil’s** — *nīru/nīr*, not Malayalam’s *vellam*.) What’s the raw/
cooked rice pair? (ಅಕ್ಕಿ *akki* raw, ಅನ್ನ *anna* cooked.)

15.2 ೀ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ೀ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ೀ

ೀ — *ō*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *ō*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ೀ somewhere inside it:

- ಸಂತೋಷ *santōṣa* — joy / pleased to meet you
- ಹೋಗು *hōgu* — to go (and ಬಾ, come)
- ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ *hōgi baruttēne* — goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”)
- ನಾಳೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ *nāle sigōṇa* — see you tomorrow

Writing: ூ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ூ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ூ in the ones that have it

ಸಂತೋಷ · ಹೋಗು · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ூ three times, saying *ō* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ூ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ூ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *ō* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 16

The Traditional Months

Modes:  voice (1)  pen (1)  Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the twelve traditional Kannada months and say when the new year Ugadi falls.

Recite Caitra through Phālguna, place Ugadi at Chaitra Śukla Pratipada, and note that this calendar is shared with Hindi, not with Tamil or Malayalam.

16.1 ಜೈತ್ರ to ಫಾಲ್ಗುಣ — the calendar Kannada shares with Hindi, not with Tamil

Tamil and Malayalam each built their own solar calendar. Kannada takes a different path entirely — the same path as Hindi.

You'll want to know: The twelve months

ಜೈತ್ರ, ವೈಶಾಖ, ಜ್ಯೇಷ್ಠ, ಆಷಾಢ, ಶ್ರಾವಣ, ಭಾದ್ರಪದ, ಅಶ್ವಯುಜ, ಕಾರ್ತಿಕ, ಮಾರ್ಗಶಿರ, ಪುಷ್ಯ, ಮಾಘ, ಫಾಲ್ಗುಣ (*Caitra, Vaiśākha, Jyēṣṭha, Āṣāḍha, Śrāvaṇa, Bhādrapada, Āśvayuja, Kārtika, Mārgaśīra, Puṣya, Māgha, Phālguna*).

Why it's said this way

This is the **same pan-Indian Sanskritic lunisolar calendar** you already met as Hindi's **Vikram Samvat** — the same twelve month names, tied to the same **six-ṛtu** seasonal cycle. Karnataka's own New Year, **Ugadi**, falls on *Chaitra Śukla Pratipada* — the first day of the bright fortnight of Chaitra — exactly the reasoning behind Hindu New

Year celebrations across much of India. Unlike Tamil’s or Malayalam’s genuinely home-grown solar calendars, Kannada didn’t build its own separate system here — it shares this one with Hindi, Telugu, and much of the rest of the subcontinent.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the twelve — “Caitra, Vaiśākha, Jyēṣṭha, Āṣāḍha, Śrāvaṇa, Bhādrapada, Āśvayuja, Kārtika, Mārgaśira, Puṣya, Māgha, Phālguna”
- “Ugadi — Chaitra Śukla Pratipada”
- the honest point — shared with Hindi, unlike Tamil/Malayalam’s own calendars

Before you move on

Does Kannada use its own solar calendar, like Tamil and Malayalam? (**No** — it uses the **same pan-Indian lunisolar calendar** as Hindi’s Vikram Samvat.) What is Kannada’s New Year called, and when does it fall? (**Ugadi**, on *Chaitra Śukla Pratipada*.)

16.2 ಹ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ಹೀ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ಹ

ಹ — *ha*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *h*, it is **ha**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಹ somewhere inside it:

- ಹೌದು *haudu* — yes (haudu)
- ಹೆಸರು *hesaru* — name
- ಹೇಗೆ *hēge* — how
- ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? *nīvu hēgiddīrā* — how are you? (respectful)

Writing: ಹ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಹ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

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Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ಹ in the ones that have it
ಹೌದು · ಹೆಸರು · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ
- *Trace it:* ಹ three times, saying *ha* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ಹ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ಹ? What sound does it carry? (*ha.*)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 17

Noon and Midnight

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) ✍️ pen (1) 🖐️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say noon and midnight in Kannada and point out the “middle” word they share.

Say ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ and ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ, then isolate the madhya sitting inside both.

17.1 ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ, ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ — one Sanskrit root, two everyday Kannada words

You’ve just seen Hindi’s *dopahar* (an old timekeeping unit) and *aadhi raat* (plain “half night”). Kannada takes a completely different path — straight to Sanskrit, and straight down the middle.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (*madhyāhna*) = “**noon, midday**” — a Sanskrit *tatsama* (borrowed whole, unchanged) compound: ಮಧ್ಯ (*madhya*, “**middle**”) + ಅಹ್ನ (*ahna*, “**day**”). This is the everyday, ordinary Kannada word for noon — not a formal or bookish alternative the way it can feel in some of its sister languages.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ (*madhyarātri*) = “**midnight**” — the exact same ಮಧ್ಯ (*madhya*, “middle”) root, this time compounded with ರಾತ್ರಿ (*rātri*,

“**night**”). Same logic, same “middle” word, just paired with “night” instead of “day.”

Why it’s said this way

Both words are unmistakably **Sanskrit tatsama** compounds — Kannada borrowed them whole rather than building native Dravidian equivalents. That’s worth contrasting directly with Hindi, a language actually *descended* from Sanskrit: Hindi has these exact same words too (*madhyāhna*, *madhyarātri*), but treats them as the more **formal, literary** register — its everyday words are the homegrown *dopahar* (“two pahars”) and *aadhi raat* (“half night”) instead. Kannada, by contrast, took the Sanskrit-formal compound and made it the **plain, everyday** word — there’s no separate native-Dravidian doublet in common use here the way there is for some other concepts.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “madhyāhna” — noon, “middle of the day”
- “madhyarātri” — midnight, “middle of the night”
- the shared piece — “madhya,” middle, in both words

Before you move on

What Sanskrit root do ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ and ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ share, and what does it mean? (ಮಧ್ಯ, *madhya*, “middle.”) Are these native Dravidian words or Sanskrit borrowings? (**Sanskrit tatsama** borrowings, taken whole.) Does Hindi treat its version of these words as everyday or formal? (**Formal/literary** — Hindi’s everyday words are *dopahar* and *aadhi raat* instead.)

17.2 ಸೆ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ಸೆ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ಸ

ಸ — *sa*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *s*, it is **sa**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಸ somewhere inside it:

- ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ *namaskāra* — hello / greetings (namaskāra — “a making of a bow”)
- ಸರಿ *sari* — okay / alright / correct (sari)
- ಹೆಸರು *hesaru* — name
- ಸಂತೋಷ *santōṣa* — joy / pleased to meet you

Writing: ಸ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಸ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ಸ in the ones that have it

ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ · ಸರಿ · ಧನ್ಯವಾದ

- *Trace it:* ಸ three times, saying *sa* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ಸ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — **ਝ**? What sound does it carry? (**sa.**)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 18

Telling Time

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) ✍️ pen (1) 📞 Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can tell someone the time on the hour in Kannada.

Say ಗಂಟೆ — *hour*, and also “bell” — then ಒಂದು ಗಂಟೆ and ಎರಡು ಗಂಟೆ for one and two o’clock.

18.1 ಗಂಟೆ — the same “bell” word as Hindi, borrowed through Prakrit

You’ve already met Hindi’s *ghaṇṭā* — “hour,” literally “bell.” Kannada has the exact same word, arriving by the exact same logic.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಗಂಟೆ (*gaṇṭe*) = “**hour**” — and, just like Hindi, it means “**bell, gong**” just as commonly. It’s related to the same Sanskrit घण्टा (*ghaṇṭā*, “bell”). The semantic shift is identical to Hindi’s: temples, towns, and clock towers announced the hour by striking a bell, so the bell-word became the hour-word.

Why it’s said this way

This is a genuinely different picture from Tamil’s. Kannada’s *gaṇṭe*, like Hindi’s *ghaṇṭā*, is a **Sanskrit-derived** “bell → hour” word. Tamil, by contrast, most likely uses a **native Dravidian** word for

exactly the same “bell → hour” idea — a different root entirely, arrived at independently (though even specialists don’t call this fully settled). So the *pattern* (bell-word becomes hour-word) repeats across languages, but the *word itself* splits along the familiar Sanskrit/native line (compare *madhyāhna* vs. Tamil’s *naḷ*-based words for noon).

Grammar Lens: telling the time

ಒಂದು ಗಂಟೆ. — “One o’clock.” (*ondu gaṇṭe*, “one hour/bell”)

ಎರಡು ಗಂಟೆ. — “Two o’clock.” (*eraḍu gaṇṭe*)

Kannada simply pairs the cardinal number with *gaṇṭe* — no ordinal/cardinal split like Arabic’s, no singular/plural verb switch like Hindi’s *bajnā*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “gaṇṭe” — hour, also “bell”
- “ondu gaṇṭe” — one o’clock
- “eraḍu gaṇṭe” — two o’clock

Before you move on

What does ಗಂಟೆ mean besides “hour,” and what Sanskrit word is it related to? (“**Bell, gong**” — related to Sanskrit *ghaṇṭā*.) Is this the same root Hindi uses for “hour”? (**Yes** — Hindi’s *ghaṇṭā* is the same Sanskrit word.) Does Tamil use this same Sanskrit root for “hour”? (**Most likely not** — it uses a native Dravidian word instead, arrived at independently.)

18.2 ೆ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ೆ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ಚ

ಚ — *ca*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *c*, it is **ca**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಚ somewhere inside it:

- ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ *cennāgi* — well, nicely — and the reply "ನಾನು ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ"
- ವಸಂತ ಋತು ಬೇಸಿಗೆ ಮಳೆಗಾಲ ಚಳಿಗಾಲ — spring, summer, monsoon, winter
- ಚೈತ್ರ ವೈಶಾಖ ಜ್ಯೇಷ್ಠ ಆಷಾಢ ಶ್ರಾವಣ ಭಾದ್ರಪದ ಅಶ್ವಿನ್ಯುಜ ಕಾರ್ತಿಕ ಮಾರ್ಗಶಿರ ಪುಷ್ಯ ಮಾಘ ಫಾಲ್ಗುಣ — the twelve lunisolar months

Writing: ಚ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಚ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

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Your turn

- *Look*: at these words, and find ಚ in the ones that have it

ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it*: ಚ three times, saying *ca* as you finish each one
- *Look*: back at any page of this chapter and find ಚ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — **ɜ**? What sound does it carry? (*ca.*)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 19

Asking Someone's Age

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) ✍️ pen (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: first 1 of 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can ask someone how old they are in Kannada and give my own age in return.

Ask ನಿನ್ನ ವಯಸ್ಸು ಎಷ್ಟು? and answer ನನ್ನ ವಯಸ್ಸು ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು — a complete verbless exchange about age.

19.1 ನಿನ್ನ ವಯಸ್ಸು ಎಷ್ಟು? — “your age, how much?”

Here’s a genuinely nice callback: the Sanskrit word behind Kannada’s “age” is a distant cousin of a Latin word you already know.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ವಯಸ್ಸು (*vayassu*, “age”) comes from Sanskrit वयस् (*vayas*, “age, youth, vigor, strength”), which traces back to **Proto-Indo-European** *wéy_h1os*. That PIE root is the **same** one behind Latin *vīs*, “force, strength, vigor” — so Sanskrit’s word for “age” and Latin’s word for “force” are genuine, distant cousins, both carrying the older sense of “vigor, life-force” before splitting toward different specific meanings.

Grammar Lens: a simple possessive, no verb

ನಿನ್ನ ವಯಸ್ಸು ಎಷ್ಟು? — “How old are you?” — literally
“your age — how much?” (*ninna vayassu eṣṭu?*)

ನನ್ನ ವಯಸ್ಸು ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು. — “I am twenty years old.” — literally

“my age [is] twenty.” (*nanna vayassu ippattu.*)

Just like Arabic’s *‘umr*, this is a **verbless** construction in the present tense — Kannada simply states “your age” and “how much,” with no “is” needed. But notice the shape is simpler than Arabic’s: no possessive suffix fused onto the noun, just the ordinary possessive word ನಿನ್ನ (*ninna*, “your”) sitting in front of ವಯಸ್ಸು.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “vayassu” — age
- “ninna vayassu eṣṭu?” — how old are you?
- “nanna vayassu ippattu” — I am twenty, “my age [is] twenty”

Before you move on

What Sanskrit word is ವಯಸ್ಸು from, and what Latin word is its PIE cousin? (वयस्, *vayas*, “age/vigor” — cousin of Latin *vīs*, “force,” both from PIE *wéyh₁os*.) Does Kannada use a verb to state age? (**No** — “your age how-much,” no verb needed.) How do you say “I am twenty”? (*Nanna vayassu ippattu* — “my age [is] twenty.”)

19.2 ಁ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ು — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ಁ

ಁ — a nasal, ridden on the syllable before it.

It is a **nasal**, written as a mark rather than as a letter. It rides on the syllable before it and turns the end of it nasal.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಁ somewhere inside it:

- ಸಂತೋಷ *santōṣa* — joy / pleased to meet you
- ಒಂದು ಎರಡು ಮೂರು ನಾಲ್ಕು ಐದು *ondu eraḍu mūru nālku aidu* — one to five
- ಆರು ಏಳು ಎಂಟು ಒಂಬತ್ತು ಹತ್ತು — six to ten
- ಗಂಟೆ *gaṇṭe* — hour — the SAME Sanskrit “bell” word behind Hindi’s *ghantā*

Writing: ೆ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ೆ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

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Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ೆ in the ones that have it

ಸಂತೋಷ · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ೆ three times, humming the nasal at the end of the syllable as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ೆ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ೆ? What does it add to the syllable before it? (**A nasal.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 20

Numbers 11–20 and Weather

Modes: 🗣️ voice (2) ✍️ pen (1) 🖐️ Hands-free start: first 2 of 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what the weather is doing in Kannada and count past ten up to twenty.

Say ಹವಾಮಾನ — the Persian hava plus Sanskrit māna — and report the weather with ಮಳೆ ಬರುತ್ತಿದೆ, “rain is coming.”

20.1 ಹನ್ನೊಂದು to ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು — numbers 11–20

You’ve now seen four different language families each build “twenty” as its own special, opaque word — Sanskrit’s *vimshati*, Latin’s *viginti*, Arabic’s *‘ishrūn*. Kannada’s twenty genuinely started life as “two tens” too — but be careful: the modern surface no longer shows it plainly.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Kannada’s teens are built on ಹತ್ತು (*hattu*, “ten”) plus each digit — ಹನ್ನೊಂದು (*hannondū*, 11), ಹನ್ನೆರಡು (*hanneradu*, 12), and onward through ಹತ್ತೊಂಬತ್ತು (*hattombattu*, 19). Each teen is a compound built the same way English builds “four-teen” — just placed the same digit-plus-ten pattern in front instead of behind.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು (*ippattu*, “twenty”) traces back to Proto-Dravidian *ir- (“two”) + *paHtu (“ten”) — a genuine compositional origin,

“two-tens.” But be honest about what’s actually visible today: the ***ir-** piece is an old *bound* root, not the same as modern Kannada’s everyday word for “two,” ಎರಡು (*eraḍu*) — a separate, longer descendant of the same ancient family. And the “ten” piece surfaces here as **-pp-** (geminated after the *r*), not as modern ಹತ್ತು (*hattu*)’s **h-** — because Kannada’s historical *p* → *h* shift only fired at the **start** of a word, and this “ten” sits in the **middle** of the compound, so it never lenited. So *ippattu* really did start as “two-tens” — you just can’t spot modern *eraḍu* or modern *hattu* inside it anymore the way you might expect. Compare this to Sanskrit’s विंशति (*vimshati*), Latin’s *vīginti*, and Arabic’s عشرون (*‘ishrūn*): those have **no** compositional “two-ten” origin at all, not even a buried one — a genuinely different kind of history from Kannada’s.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “hannondu, hannerāḍu” — 11, 12
- “hattu” — ten (today’s word), “eraḍu” — two (today’s word)
- “ippattu” — twenty, “two-tens” underneath, from the OLD *ir-/paHtu* roots, not directly from *hattu/eraḍu*

Before you move on

How are Kannada’s teens built? (ಹತ್ತು (ten) + a digit, compounded.) Does ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು (twenty) have a compositional “two-tens” origin? (**Yes** — Proto-Dravidian **ir-* “two” + **paHtu* “ten.”) Can you still spot modern *eraḍu* or modern *hattu* inside it today? (**No** — the old bound “two” root and the un-lenited middle-of-word “ten” root look different from their modern standalone descendants.) Do Sanskrit’s *vimshati* or Latin’s *vīginti* have any compositional origin like this at all? (**No** — neither has a buried “two-ten” history the way Kannada’s does.)

20.2 ಹವಾಮಾನ — a genuine two-language hybrid word

Kannada’s word for “weather” isn’t purely Sanskrit or purely native — it’s a compound with a piece from each of two different borrowed sources.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹವಾಮಾನ (*havāmāna*) = “**weather**” — built from two pieces:

- ಹವಾ (*hava*, “**air**”) — itself a loanword, from **Persian** هوا (*havā*), which traces back to **Arabic** هَوَا (*hawā*², “air”). This is the exact same root behind Hindi’s own हवा (*havā*, “air, wind”).
- ಮಾನ (*māna*, “**measure**”) — from **Sanskrit** मान (*māna*), “measure, standard” (the same word behind *pramāṇa*, “proof, measure of truth”).

So *havāmāna* literally means “**air-measure**” — and it’s genuinely a two-source hybrid, not a single borrowed compound: one piece Perso-Arabic, one piece Sanskrit, fused into one Kannada word.

You’ll want to know: ಮಳೆ ಬರುತ್ತಿದೆ — “rain is coming”

ಮಳೆ ಬರುತ್ತಿದೆ. — “It’s raining.” — literally “**rain is coming**.” (*maḷe baruttide*.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “havāmāna” — weather, literally “air-measure”
- “hava” — air, a Persian/Arabic loan
- “maḷe baruttide” — it’s raining, “rain is coming”

Before you move on

What are the two pieces of ಹವಾಮಾನ, and where does each come from? (ಹವಾ, “air,” a **Persian/Arabic** loan; ಮಾನ, “measure,”

native **Sanskrit**.) What does *havāmāna* literally mean?
 (“**Air-measure**.”) What other Indian language shares the exact
 same word for “air”? (**Hindi** — *havā*.)

20.3 ಪ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ೀ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ಪ

ಪ — *pa*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *p*, it is **pa**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ಪ somewhere inside it:

- ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ *paravāgilla* — it’s okay / no problem / you’re welcome
- ಕಪ್ಪು ಬಿಳಿ ಕೆಂಪು ನೀಲಿ — black, white, red, blue
- ಅಪ್ಪ ಅಮ್ಮ ಅಣ್ಣ ತಮ್ಮ ಅಕ್ಕ ತಂಗಿ — father, mother, and four age-graded sibling words
- ಚೈತ್ರ ವೈಶಾಖ ಜ್ಯೇಷ್ಠ ಆಷಾಢ ಶ್ರಾವಣ ಭಾದ್ರಪದ ಆಶ್ವಯುಜ ಕಾರ್ತಿಕ ಮಾರ್ಗಶಿರ ಪುಷ್ಯ ಮಾಘ ಫಾಲ್ಗುಣ — the twelve lunisolar months

Writing: ಪ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಪ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ಪ in the ones that have it

ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ · ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ

- *Trace it:* ಪ three times, saying *pa* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ಪ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ಪ? What sound does it carry? (*pa.*)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 21

Dog and Cat

Modes: ⇆ voice (1) ⇆ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a dog and a cat in Kannada.

Say ನಾಯಿ, an unambiguously native Dravidian root, and ಬೆಕ್ಕು, a different ancient root from Tamil’s everyday cat word.

21.1 ನಾಯಿ, ಬೆಕ್ಕು — solid ground, and a genuine split

After a whole arc of mystery dog-words — Spanish’s *perro*, English’s *dog*, Hindi’s *kuttā* — here’s the opposite: a dog-word with absolutely no mystery attached.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನಾಯಿ (*nāyi*, “dog”) is a genuine, native **Proto-Dravidian** root — no debate, no substrate mystery, nothing like the *perro/dog/kuttā* pattern you’ve now seen across three unrelated language families. It’s the same root shared right across the Dravidian family.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಬೆಕ್ಕು (*bekku*, “cat”) is where things get honestly more complicated. It’s cognate with a **different** ancient Dravidian root — the same one behind Tamil and Malayalam’s word for “**wildcat**” or “**civet cat**” — not the same root as Tamil’s **everyday** word for cat. So unlike “dog,”

where Dravidian largely agrees on one shared root, “cat” genuinely **splits**: different Dravidian languages settled on different ancient roots for their everyday word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nāyi” — dog, solid native Dravidian, no mystery
- “bekku” — cat, a different Dravidian root than Tamil’s everyday word

Before you move on

Is ನಾಯಿ a mystery word, like Spanish’s *perro* or Hindi’s *kuttā*? (**No** — a solid, native Proto-Dravidian root.) Does ಬೆಕ್ಕು come from the same root as Tamil’s everyday cat-word? (**No** — a genuinely different ancient Dravidian root, related instead to the word for “wildcat.”)

Chapter 22

Green and Yellow

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🗋️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can name green and yellow in Kannada, on top of the four colours I already had.

Say ಹಸಿರು, a true cousin of Tamil paccai and Telugu pacca, then ಹಳದಿ, the turmeric-borrowing that is secretly a cousin of German gelb.

22.1 ಹಸಿರು, ಹಳದಿ — a real Dravidian family, and a borrowed cousin of gelb

Kannada’s green word belongs to a real Dravidian family you’ll meet again soon. Its yellow word isn’t native at all — and it turns out to be hiding the very same ancient root this whole arc keeps circling back to.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹಸಿರು (hasiru, “green”) comes from Old Kannada ಪಸಿರ್ (pasir), from Proto-Dravidian *pac-, “green” — the exact same root behind Tamil’s பச்சை (paccai) and Telugu’s పచ్చ (pacca). Kannada even keeps a doublet of its own, ಪಚ್ಚಿ (pacce), sitting right alongside hasiru. So unlike Kannada’s blue (ನೀಲಿ, borrowed from Sanskrit), green here is the real, deep, native Dravidian word — and this particular root resurfaces in Telugu’s, Malayalam’s, and Tamil’s own green words too.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹಳದಿ (*haḷadi*, “yellow”) is **not** Kannada’s native turmeric word — that’s ಅರಿಶಿನ (*ariśina*). Instead, *haḷadi* appears to be shaped by Sanskrit/Hindi हरिद्रा/हल्दी (*haridrā/haldī*, “turmeric”), the same word that gives “turmeric” across a huge swath of Indo-Aryan languages (Hindi/Urdu/Punjabi *haldi*, Bengali *holud*, Odia *haladi*) — and in some of these, like Bengali and Odia, that turmeric-word doubles as the everyday word for the color **yellow** itself, exactly as *haḷadi* does in Kannada (Hindi keeps the two separate: *haldī* stays “turmeric,” while “yellow” is the unrelated word *pīlā*). Here’s the part that closes a loop running through this whole arc: **haridrā** itself traces back to हरि (*hari*, “yellow, tawny”), from **Proto-Indo-European** **ǵʰelh₃-* — the **same ancient root** already behind Hindi’s own हरा (*harā*, “green”) and German’s **gelb** (“yellow”). So Kannada picked up its yellow word from a completely different language family, Indo-Aryan rather than Dravidian — and that borrowed word still lands on the exact same PIE root this arc has been tracing all along.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ಹಸಿರು” — green, a real Dravidian cousin of Tamil *pacca* and Telugu *pacca*
- “ಹಳದಿ” — yellow, borrowed, and secretly a cousin of *gelb*
- the contrast — *hasiru* is native Dravidian; *haḷadi* is a Sanskrit/ Hindi loan built on the turmeric word

Before you move on

What Proto-Dravidian root gives ಹಸಿರು (*hasiru*), and which two other Dravidian languages share it? (**pac-*, “green” — shared with **Tamil’s** *pacca* and **Telugu’s** *pacca*.) Is ಹಳದಿ (*haḷadi*) Kannada’s native word for turmeric? (**No** — that’s *ariśina*; *haḷadi* is a Sanskrit/Hindi loan.) What ancient PIE root connects **haḷadi**, through Sanskrit **hari**, to Hindi’s **harā** and German’s **gelb**? (**ǵʰelh₃-*, “to shine.”)

Chapter 23

Day

Modes: ⇌ voice (1) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can say “day” in Kannada and tell it apart from the native word for daytime.

Say ದಿನ, kept whole as a Sanskrit tatsama where Hindi’s दिन eroded, and set it against native ಹಗಲು, which means daytime rather than a day.

23.1 ದಿನ (dina) — “day,” Sanskrit kept whole

You’ve already met Sanskrit’s “middle” compounds for noon and midnight. Here’s the plain word for “day” itself — and a genuinely interesting twist on how borrowing works.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ದಿನ (dina) — “day” — is a Sanskrit **tatsama** word: borrowed **whole**, unchanged, the same way *madhyāhna*/*madhyarātri* were (Chapter 17). It’s Kannada’s ordinary, everyday word for “a day.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Here’s the honest twist: Kannada’s *dina* and Hindi’s दिन (*din*) trace to the **exact same** Sanskrit word, दिन (*dina*) — but they got there by **different routes**. Hindi’s *din* is a **tadbhava** form: Sanskrit *dina* wore down naturally over centuries, through Prakrit, losing its final vowel along the way. Kannada’s *dina*, by contrast, is a direct **tatsama**

borrowing — taken straight from Sanskrit, unworn, keeping the full shape. So Kannada’s *dina* and Hindi’s *din* look almost identical, but one is an unbroken **inheritance** (eroded), the other a **later borrowing** (kept whole) — genuinely different histories landing on nearly the same modern word.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Kannada does have a genuine **native Dravidian** word here too: ಹಗಲು (*hagalu*) — but be careful, it means specifically “**daytime**” (the daylight hours, as opposed to night), not “**a day**” as a calendar unit. It’s not a synonym for *dina*; it’s a different sense of “day” entirely.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “dina” — “day,” Sanskrit tatsama, kept whole
- the twist — *dina* and Hindi’s *din*, same Sanskrit source, but borrowing vs. natural erosion
- *hagalu* — native Dravidian, “daytime,” a different sense than *dina*

Before you move on

Is Kannada’s ದಿನ a tatsama borrowing or a tadbhava inheritance? (**Tatsama** — borrowed whole from Sanskrit.) How does this differ from Hindi’s दिन (*din*), even though both trace to the same Sanskrit word? (**Din is tadbhava** — naturally eroded through Prakrit — while Kannada’s *dina* was borrowed later, unworn.) What does ಹಗಲು (*hagalu*) mean, and is it a synonym for *dina*? (“**Daytime**” — a different sense, not “a day” as a calendar unit.)

Chapter 24

Night

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🖱️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can say “night” in Kannada and recognise it inside the midnight word I already knew.

Say ರಾತ್ರಿ, find it again inside ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ, and note that native ಇರುಳು lost its job where ಹಗಲು kept a different one.

24.1 ರಾತ್ರಿ (rātri) — “night,” and its native cousin, pushed aside

Last lesson’s *dina* had a living native partner, *hagalu*. This word’s native partner tells a different, more honest story — one of being pushed out, not living alongside.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ರಾತ್ರಿ (rātri) — “night” — is the same Sanskrit **tatsama** word already hiding inside ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ (*madhyarātri*, “midnight,” Chapter 17), now standing on its own as Kannada’s ordinary, everyday word for “night.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Kannada **does** have a genuine **native Dravidian** word for night: ಇರುಳು (*iruḷu*), from **Proto-Dravidian** **cirVl* — a real pan-Dravidian cognate, matching **Tamil**’s இருள் (*irul*), **Malayalam**’s ഇരുൾ (*irul*), and **Telugu**’s ఇరులు (*irulu*). But here’s the honest difference from last lesson’s *hagalu*: while *hagalu* is still a

living, everyday word (just for a different sense, “daytime”), *iruḷu* has been genuinely **pushed aside** by the Sanskrit loan — it now survives mainly in **older poetry**, carrying extra metaphorical weight (“darkness,” even “ignorance”), rather than in everyday speech. *Rātri* simply **won** the job of “night” in modern Kannada.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “rātri” — “night,” already met inside madhyarātri
- “iruḷu” — the real native word, now mostly archaic/poetic
- the honest contrast — hagalu still lives (different sense); iruḷu was pushed aside (same sense, lost the job)

Before you move on

Where have you already met ರಾತ್ರಿ before this lesson? (ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ, *madhyarātri*, “midnight.”) What genuine native Dravidian word for “night” does Kannada have, and what’s its status today? (ಇರುಳು, *iruḷu* — largely **archaic**, surviving mainly in older poetry.) How is *iruḷu*’s story different from *hagalu*’s, from last lesson? (**Hagalu still lives**, for a different sense [“daytime”]; **iruḷu was pushed aside** entirely by the Sanskrit loan, for the same sense [“night”].)

Chapter 25

Good Night

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🖐️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can wish someone good night in Kannada.

Say ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ — “auspicious night” — pairing the ರಾತ್ರಿ already learned with śubha, from a root meaning “to be beautiful.”

25.1 ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ (śubha rātri) — “good night,” auspicious to the end

You already have *rātri*. Pair it with one more Sanskrit word, and you have Kannada’s everyday “good night” — the same phrase, word for word, as Hindi’s.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ (śubha rātri) — “good night” — literally “auspicious night.” Both pieces are Sanskrit **tatsama**: ರಾತ್ರಿ (*rātri*, “night,” already met last lesson) plus ಶುಭ (*śubha*, “auspicious, good”).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಶುಭ (śubha) comes from the Sanskrit verbal root **śubh**, whose core sense is “to be beautiful, splendid” — traceable to a well-sourced **Proto-Indo-European** root, **kewb^h*- (“to be beautiful”). A further, more speculative connection to a root meaning “to shine” has also been proposed — but either way, the underlying idea is a familiar one:

auspiciousness imagined as a kind of radiance or beauty.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Here's the honest cross-language note: ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ, and Hindi's own शुभ रात्रि are, word for word, the **exact same phrase** — a Dravidian language and an Indo-Aryan language landing on an identical “good night.” The most likely explanation is **shared Sanskrit vocabulary**, not one language directly copying the phrase from the other — but be honest about the limits of that claim: “good night” as a farewell greeting is itself a **modern** convention across Indian languages, not an ancient one, so some degree of cross-language reinforcement (Hindi's wide reach as a pan-Indian media language, for instance) can't be ruled out either. Unlike Hindi, where *rātri* is the formal member of a live doublet against everyday *raat*, Kannada's *rātri* is simply the ordinary word (Chapter 24) — so this phrase draws on shared **Sanskrit vocabulary**, not a shared “formal-versus-everyday” register split the way it does in Hindi.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “śubha rātri” — “good night,” literally “auspicious night”
- śubha's own root — śubh, “to be beautiful” → “auspicious”
- the honest cross-language note — identical to Hindi's shubh rātri, most likely via shared Sanskrit vocabulary, though direct reinforcement can't be fully ruled out

Before you move on

What does ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ, literally mean? (“**Auspicious night.**”) What does ಶುಭ literally trace back to? (A root meaning “**to be beautiful, splendid.**”) Is Kannada's *śubha rātri* definitely borrowed directly from Hindi? (**Most likely not** — shared Sanskrit vocabulary is the more parsimonious explanation, though since “good night” as a farewell is itself a modern convention, some cross-language reinforcement can't be fully ruled out.)

Chapter 26

Morning

Modes: ⇄ voice (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can say “morning” in Kannada using the language’s own native word for it.

Say ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ, trace it to beḷagu (“to dawn”) and beḷaku (“light”), and contrast it with the Sanskrit dina, rātri and madhyāhna around it.

26.1 ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ (beḷagge) — the one time-word that’s genuinely Kannada’s own

Every everyday time-word you’ve met in Kannada so far — day, night, noon, midnight — has been Sanskrit, borrowed whole. This one breaks that pattern completely.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ (beḷagge) — “morning” — is **native Dravidian**, built on ಬೆಳಗು (beḷagu, “to shine, to become bright, to dawn”) and the related noun ಬೆಳಕು (beḷaku, “light”). Morning is, quite literally, “the shining,” “the dawning” — a transparent, homegrown metaphor, no borrowed vocabulary anywhere in it.

Why it’s said this way

Here’s what makes this lesson different from every other Kannada time-word lesson so far: ದಿನ (dina, “day”), ರಾತ್ರಿ (ratri, “night”), and ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (madhyāhna, “noon”) are all genuine **Sanskrit tatsama**

borrowings, taken whole, doing the plain everyday job in Kannada. ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ breaks that streak — it’s the one everyday time-word in this set that’s actually **Kannada’s own**, not a loan from anywhere. If you’d only met *dina*, *ratri*, and *madhyāhna*, you might start to assume every Kannada time-word is Sanskrit underneath. This one is the honest counter-example — though, matching the pattern already seen with *hagalu* and *irulu* (Chapters 23–24), a native compound for “noon” does technically exist too: ನಡುಹಗಲು (*naḍuhagalu*, “middle-of-daytime,” built from *naḍu*, “middle,” the same everyday word already met, plus *hagalu*). It just lost the everyday job to *madhyāhna*, the same way *hagalu* and *irulu* were pushed into narrower, or archaic, roles by their own Sanskrit competitors.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “beḷagge” — “morning,” native Dravidian
- the root — beḷagu, “to shine, to dawn,” and beḷaku, “light”
- the contrast — *dina*, *ratri*, *madhyāhna* are all Sanskrit; beḷagge is genuinely Kannada’s own

Before you move on

What native root does ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ come from, and what does it mean? (ಬೆಳಗು/ಬೆಳಕು — “to shine/dawn” and “light.”) Is ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ a Sanskrit tatsama, like *dina*, *ratri*, and *madhyāhna*? (**No** — genuinely native Dravidian, the odd one out among Kannada’s everyday time-words.)

Chapter 27

Evening

Modes: ⇌ voice (1) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can say “evening” in Kannada.

Say ಸಂಜೆ, follow it back through Maharashtri Prakrit to Sanskrit saṃdhyā, and set it beside Hindi’s साँझ, the same root down a different Prakrit road.

27.1 ಸಂಜೆ (sañje) — a Sanskrit word that arrived already worn down

ದಿನ, ರಾತ್ರಿ, and ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ all arrived in Kannada whole, unworn, straight from Sanskrit. This word took a very different route — and it lands somewhere genuinely surprising.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಸಂಜೆ (sañje) — “evening” — traces to Sanskrit ಸಂಧ್ಯಾ (saṃdhyā, “twilight,” literally “the junction of day and night”) — but it didn’t arrive in Kannada as a fresh, whole tatsama the way *dina*, *ratri*, and *madhyāhna* did. Instead, it came by way of **Maharashtri Prakrit ಸಂಜ್ಞಾ (sañjhā)** — Sanskrit’s word, already worn down by centuries of everyday Middle Indo-Aryan speech, *then* borrowed into Kannada in that already-eroded shape.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Here’s the genuinely surprising part: Hindi’s own evening word, साँझ (sāñjh), comes from the **exact same** Sanskrit संध्या — but by a **different** route. Hindi *inherited* it, generation to generation, through **Śauraseni Prakrit** (a different, sister Middle Indo-Aryan dialect than the Maharashtri Prakrit Kannada borrowed from). Two separate erosion paths — one an unbroken inheritance within the Indo-Aryan family, one a loan crossing into a completely different language family — and they land on nearly **identical-sounding** modern words, sañje and sāñjh, purely because they share the same Sanskrit starting point.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “sañje” — “evening,” from Sanskrit sandhyā via Maharashtri Prakrit
- the contrast with dina/ratri/madhyāhna — those arrived whole; sañje arrived already worn down
- the striking convergence — Hindi’s साँझ, same Sanskrit root, different Prakrit path, nearly the same sound today

Before you move on

Does ಸಂಜೆ arrive in Kannada as a fresh, whole Sanskrit tatsama, like *dina* and *ratri* did? (**No** — it arrived already worn down, via Maharashtri Prakrit ಸಂಯಾ.) What Hindi word shares ಸಂಜೆ’s exact Sanskrit root, and by what different path did it get there? (साँझ (sāñjh) — inherited via a different sister Prakrit, Śauraseni, rather than borrowed via Maharashtri.)

Chapter 28

Afternoon

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🖐️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can say “afternoon” in Kannada and keep it distinct from noon.

Say ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ, split it into *apara* (“latter”) + *ahna* (“day”), and match that -ahna against the one in ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ.

28.1 ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ (aparāhna) — the same “-ahna” pattern, a different first piece

You already know ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ, “noon” — “middle” plus “day.” This lesson’s word for “afternoon” uses the exact same building pattern, just with a different first piece.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ (aparāhna) — “afternoon” — is a genuine **Sanskrit tatsama**: ಅಪರ (apara, “latter, further”) + the same -ಅಹ್ನ (-ahna, “day”) suffix already hiding inside ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (madhyāhna, “noon,” Chapter 17). Same clean two-piece structure, same “day” ending — just swap *madhya* (“middle”) for *apara* (“latter, further along”) and you move from “noon” to “afternoon.” This distinction comes from a genuine, classical **five-part Sanskrit division of the day** — *prāta* (early morning), *saṅgava*, *madhyāhna* (noon), *aparāhna* (afternoon), *sāyāhna* (evening) — with *aparāhna* landing specifically as the fourth part, after noon and before evening.

Why it's said this way

Here's where this lesson needs real care: some sources describe ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ itself being stretched loosely in casual modern speech to cover the whole afternoon too — which would echo Hindi's own दोपहर, attested to have genuinely widened from “precisely noon” to “the whole afternoon.” But the evidence for Kannada is **much thinner** than what backed the Hindi finding — general dictionary listings rather than clear, independently-confirmed usage sources. Treat this as a plausible, hedged parallel, not a settled fact the way दोपहर's widening was. ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ remains the more precisely, formally correct word for “afternoon” specifically.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “aparāhna” — “afternoon,” apara + ahna
- the shared piece with madhyāhna — both end in “-ahna,” “day”
- the honest hedge — madhyāhna MAY also loosely cover “afternoon” in casual speech, but this is far less certain than Hindi's dopahar-widening story

Before you move on

What suffix does ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ share with ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ, and what does it mean? (-ಅಹ್ನ, -ahna, “day.”) What's the difference in their first pieces? (ಅಪರ, apara, “latter/further” vs. ಮಧ್ಯ, madhya, “middle.”) Is the claim that ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ also covers “afternoon” in casual speech as well-supported as Hindi's दोपहर-widening finding? (**No** — much more thinly sourced; treat it as a hedged possibility, not a settled fact.)

Chapter 29

Good Morning

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can wish someone good morning in Kannada and judge when it will sound too formal.

Say ಶುಭೋದಯ — śubha + udaya, “auspicious rising” — and note the formal/written skew that makes ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ the safer casual morning greeting.

29.1 ಶುಭೋದಯ (śubhōdaya) — “good morning,” a third root for morning

You already have ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ, the everyday word for “morning.” This greeting reaches for a completely different word for the same idea — and, honestly, this lesson’s twist is about how uncertain its own “everyday” status turns out to be, once you look closely.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಶುಭೋದಯ (śubhōdaya) — “good morning” — is built from ಶುಭ (śubha, “good, auspicious”) plus ಉದಯ (udaya, “rising, sunrise,” from Sanskrit ud- “up” + i “to go” — the same root behind ಸೂರ್ಯೋದಯ, sūryōdaya, “sunrise” itself). This is a **completely different word** from ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ (beḷagge, Chapter 26’s native “morning”) — Kannada now has (at least) two unrelated roots circling the idea of morning: one native (“the shining”), one Sanskrit (“the rising”).

Why it's said this way

Here's where this lesson needs real care. Some sources describe ಶುಭೋದಯ as the most common everyday way to say “good morning” in Kannada — but these are largely the same genre of generic phrasebook site whose claims about Hindi's सुप्रभात turned out, on closer inspection, to be overstated. A more careful source instead describes ಶುಭೋದಯ as reserved mainly for **formal or written** contexts — speeches, greeting cards, WhatsApp images — calling it “not as frequently used in daily conversations” as ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ/ನಮಸ್ತೆ, and at least one native-speaker account suggests casual spoken Kannada often reaches for **English** “good morning” instead of ಶುಭೋದಯ entirely. Taken together, this looks like the **same** formal/written skew already found for Hindi's सुप्रभात, not the genuine cross-language contrast a first pass at the sources might suggest. A native alternate, ಶುಭ ಮುಂಜಾನೆ (*śubha muñjāne*, using *muñjāne*, “the early morning, before sunrise”), also exists as a real, attested greeting construction — but its own register isn't independently confirmed here either.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “śubhōdaya” — “good morning,” śubha + udaya
- the root contrast — beḷagge is native “shining”; udaya is Sanskrit “rising”
- the honest note — sources conflict, but the more careful ones point to the same formal/written skew already found for Hindi

Before you move on

Does ಶುಭೋದಯ share a root with ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ? (No — ಉದಯ, “rising,” is a completely different Sanskrit root from native ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ's “shining.”) Is ಶುಭೋದಯ genuinely common in everyday casual Kannada speech? (**Unclear, and possibly not** — sources conflict; the more careful ones describe it skewing formal/written, with ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ/ನಮಸ್ತೆ covering casual mornings instead, and one native-speaker account suggests English “good morning” often gets used in casual speech instead of ಶುಭೋದಯ entirely.)

Chapter 30

Good Evening

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can wish someone good evening in Kannada.

Say ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ, correct the common claim that ಸಂಜೆ is native Dravidian, and keep ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ as the all-hours fallback.

30.1 ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ (śubha sañje) — formal, and correctly citing where ಸಂಜೆ comes from

You already have ಸಂಜೆ, “evening” — and you already know it’s a Sanskrit word that arrived in Kannada already worn down, via Prakrit. Keep that fact straight here, since it’s an easy one to second-guess.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ (śubha sañje) — “good evening” — pairs ಶುಭ (“good, auspicious”) with ಸಂಜೆ, the exact word from Chapter 27: Sanskrit ಸಂಧ್ಯಾ (saṃdhyā), borrowed into Kannada via **Maharashtri Prakrit** ಸಂಯಾ (sañjhā). You might run across a plausible-sounding claim elsewhere that ಸಂಜೆ is “native Dravidian” — it isn’t, and you already have the real answer from Chapter 27. Don’t let a claim that merely *sounds* plausible override something you’ve already verified.

Why it's said this way

Here's where this lesson needs to be careful about its own sourcing, not just the etymology's. General impressions lean toward ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ skewing **formal**, with the all-purpose ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ — or, among younger urban speakers, borrowed English “**hello**” — more likely to cover ordinary casual conversation. But the evidence for this specific register claim is genuinely **thin**: it's the same kind of impression that, for both Hindi's सुप्रभात and Kannada's own ಶುಭೋದಯ, needed real digging to confirm or correct, and here that deeper digging hasn't turned up anything more solid than a general leaning. Treat this as an open **question**, echoing the same one already raised for those two greetings, not a third confirmed data point — this lesson doesn't have strong enough sourcing to settle it either way.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “śubha sañje” — “good evening,” a genuinely Sanskrit-rooted pairing
- the correction — ಸಂಜೆ is Sanskrit-via-Prakrit, NOT native Dravidian, whatever a plausible-sounding claim elsewhere might say
- ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ — the likely all-purpose everyday alternative, though this greeting's own register remains an open question

Before you move on

Is ಸಂಜೆ native Dravidian? (**No** — Sanskrit ಸಂಧ್ಯಾ via Maharashtri Prakrit, already established in Chapter 27; be skeptical of any claim otherwise.) Is it settled that ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ is formal/rare in casual speech, the way सुप्रभात and ಶುಭೋದಯ turned out to be? (**Not settled** — the impression leans that way, with ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ likely covering casual use, but the sourcing here is too thin to call it confirmed.)

Chapter 31

Good Afternoon

Modes: 🗣️ voice (1) 🖱️ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can wish someone good afternoon in Kannada, and fall back on ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ when I want a greeting that fits any hour.

Say ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ — built on the “noon” word rather than ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ — and reach instead for ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ, the greeting confirmed to work at any time of day.

31.1 ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ — good afternoon

Two lessons ago you met a careful hedge: does ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ, “noon,” also loosely cover “afternoon”? This greeting hands you a real data point.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (śubha madhyāhna) — “good afternoon” — is the standard greeting for this concept. Notice which noun it actually reuses: ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (*madhyāhna*, “noon,” Chapter 17) — **not** ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ (*aparāhna*, the word Chapter 28 established as the more precisely “afternoon”-specific term). This is exactly the kind of concrete usage evidence that bears on Chapter 28’s own hedge: if the standard **greeting** for “good afternoon” reaches for *madhyāhna* rather than *aparāhna*, that’s a real (if still not fully conclusive) sign that *madhyāhna*’s job has genuinely stretched to cover the afternoon in everyday use, not just at noon itself.

Why it's said this way

Here's the useful discipline this lesson followed: checking a claim against an actual, directly fetched source page, not just trusting a search-engine's own summary of one. That check turned up **two** claims of very different strength. ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ's status as a genuinely **universal** greeting — suited to any time of day, any occasion — is independently confirmed across multiple fetched sources; that one's solid. The claim that ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ leans **formal or semi-formal** — workplaces, official meetings — traces back to just **one** source. It's a real, directly-verified data point, worth taking seriously — but it isn't cross-corroborated the way the ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ claim is, so treat it as a single well-checked impression, not a settled fact.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “śubha madhyāhna” — “good afternoon,” reusing the “noon” word, not “aparāhna”
- why that matters — real evidence for madhyāhna's meaning stretching to cover “afternoon”
- ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ — the confirmed universal, any-time-of-day greeting, cross-checked across multiple sources

Before you move on

Does ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ use ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (“noon”) or ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ (the more precise “afternoon” word)? (ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ — real evidence for its meaning stretching to cover “afternoon” too.) Is the “formal/workplace” register claim for ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ as solidly confirmed as ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ's universal status? (**No** — the workplace claim rests on a single directly-verified source, not cross-corroborated the way ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ's is.) What's the confirmed universal, any-time-of-day alternative? (ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ.)

Chapter 32

The Core Verbs

Modes: ⇄ voice (6) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can build a Kannada verb as stem plus tense plus person, swap the middle bead for the past, hear the p → h law that separates Kannada from its three sisters, and say why ಗೊತ್ತು carries no person at all.

Say ನನಗೆ ಗೊತ್ತು, name the three slots that built iruttēne, hōguttēne and nōḍuttēne, explain which slot ಗೊತ್ತು leaves empty and where its person went instead, and give the sound-law behind pōgu → hōgu.

32.1 ಇರು (iru) — “to be,” and the machine inside every Kannada verb

Thirty-one chapters of words. Now the engine room. Kannada builds a verb the way you thread beads on a string, and this first verb carries the whole string.

You’ll want to know: ಇರು

ಇರು — *iru* — to be, to exist, to stay, to live

It is native Dravidian, from an old root meaning “be, remain, stay put.” Tamil kept the very same word, இரு (*iru*), and Malayalam has ഇരിക്കുക (*irikkuka*); Telugu went its own way with ఉండు (*undu*).

Iru is about **existing** or **being somewhere**, not about linking two nouns: “I am in Bangalore” takes *iru*, but “I am a teacher” takes no verb at all.

The letters in this word

ಇ (the standing vowel *i*) + ರು (*ru*) → ಇರು. Both shapes turned up already in ಇಲ್ಲ (*illa*, “no”).

The form you hear most is ಇದ್ದೇನೆ (*iddēne*), “I am,” its ಧ್ವ held long — *id-dē-ne*. You have said it already, inside Chapter 3’s ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ (*cennāgiddēne*, “I’m well”).

Grammar Lens: stem, then tense, then person

English changes a verb by putting words **around** it: *I am, I was, I will be*. Kannada changes it by gluing pieces **onto the end** of it, always in the same order:

ಇರು + ಉತ್ತ + ಏನೆ → ಇರುತ್ತೇನೆ

iru (be) + *-utt-* (happening now) + *-ēne* (“I”) → *iruttēne*

Left to right: **be** — **present** — **I**, three slots welded into one word. Languages built this way are called **agglutinative**, from Latin *glutinare*, “to glue.”

Two payoffs at once. The last piece already means “I,” so *nānu* is optional. And nothing here belongs to *iru* alone: every verb in this chapter is the same three slots with a new first bead.

(*Iruttēne* is the regular build, “I stay, I will be”; *iddēne* is the same verb worn down onto its own past stem *idd-*, for “I am **right now**.”)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “iru” — be, exist, stay
- the three beads in order — “iru ... utt ... ēne”
- the sisters — Tamil “iru”, Malayalam “irikkuka”, Telugu “uṇḍu”

Before you move on

What are the three pieces of *iruttēne*, in order? (**Stem, tense, person** — *iru*, *-utt-*, *-ēne*.) Which piece carries “I”? (**The last one**, *-ēne* — which is why *nānu* can be dropped.) Which sister kept

the same verb unchanged, and which went its own way? (**Tamil** *iru*; **Telugu** *unḍu*.) Next: the sound-law that made Kannada sound unlike all three of its sisters.

32.2 ಹೋಗು (hōgu) — “to go,” and the law that made Kannada sound like Kannada

Keep the three beads and change only the first, and you have a new verb. But this first bead hides the single most useful sound-fact in the language.

You’ll want to know: ಹೋಗು

ಹೋಗು — *hōgu* — to go

ಹೋ (*ha* carrying the long-*ō* sign) + ಗು (*gu*). Thread the beads and you get ಹೋಗುತ್ತೇನೆ (*hōguttēne*), “I go” — *hōgu* + *-utt-* + *-ēne*, exactly the machine *iru* just handed you. The bare stem is already a command: *hōgu!*, “go!”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Tamil’s word for “go” is போ / போகு (*pō / pōgu*). Kannada’s is *hōgu*, and that *h* is **not** a different root. Around a thousand years ago Kannada softened every old word-initial *p-* to *h-* — and Kannada is the **only** one of the four literary Dravidian languages that did it. Once you know the law, whole shelves of vocabulary line up:

Tamil	Kannada	meaning
<i>pōgu</i>	<i>hōgu</i>	go
<i>pattu</i>	<i>hattu</i>	ten
<i>pāl</i>	<i>hālu</i>	milk
<i>peyar</i>	<i>hesaru</i>	name

You have met two of those already — *hattu* in Chapter 7, *hesaru* back in Chapter 2. One law, and both of them stop being coincidences. The other two sisters kept the *p*: Telugu పోవు (*pōvu*), పది (*padi*, “ten”), పాలు (*pālu*, “milk”); Malayalam പോകുക (*pōkuka*), പത്ത് (*pattu*), പാൽ (*pāl*). A whole stripe of the family vocabulary, explained by one change only Kannada made.

The proof is written down: **Old Kannada** still spells these words with ಪ (pa), and the modern *h* is the later step. Nor has the law finished — in casual speech many speakers drop the *h* too, so *hōgu* can come out as *ōgu*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “hōgu” — go — then “hōguttēne”, I go
- the three beads again — “hōgu ... utt ... ēne”
- the four pairs — “pōgu ... hōgu”, “pattu ... hattu”, “pāl ... hālu”, “peyar ... hesaru”
- the sisters that kept the p — Telugu “pōvu”, Malayalam “pōkuka”

Before you move on

Is Kannada’s *hōgu* a different root from Tamil’s *pōgu*? (**No** — the same old *p*, softened to *h*.) How many of the four sisters made that change? (**One** — Kannada alone.) Give two more pairs that follow the law. (*Pattu* / *hattu*, *pāl* / *hālu*, *peyar* / *hesaru*.) What do Old Kannada texts write instead of ಪ? (ಪ, *pa*.) Build “I go.” (*Hōguttēne*.)

32.3 ಬಾ (bā) — “come,” and the stem hiding underneath it

Every verb so far has been honest: the word you learn it by is the word the endings glue onto. This one is not — and Chapter 4’s goodbye has been quietly showing you why.

You’ll want to know: ಬಾ

ಬಾ — *bā* — come!

One letter and a vowel sign: ಬ (ba) with the long-*ā* stroke. As it stands it is a whole command — *bā!*, “come!” — the partner of *hōgu!* from Chapter 4.

But you cannot thread beads onto *bā*. Underneath, the verb’s working stem is *baru-* (*baru-*), and everything attaches to that:

baru- + *-utt-* + *-ēne* → *ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ* (*baruttēne*), “I come.”

Grammar Lens: two shapes, one verb

Most Kannada verbs have nothing to hide. *Iru* gives *iruttēne*, *hōgu* gives *hōguttēne*; the name of the verb is the stem. A small handful do not, and *bā* is the one you will meet daily: **call it *bā*, build on *baru-***. That is exactly what Chapter 4’s farewell was made of:

ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ — *hōgi baruttēne* — “having gone, I come”
— “I’ll go and come back.”

Hōgi is *hōgu* in its “having ...-ed” form; *baruttēne* is *baru-* with the present bead and the “I” bead. Kannada refuses a bare goodbye, so it promises the return instead — and needs both verbs to do it.

Tamil splits the same verb the same way: *வா* (*vā*) to call it by, *வரு-* (*varu-*) to build on; Malayalam has *വരുക* (*varuka*), Telugu *వచ్చు* (*vaccu*), whose command form is *రా* (*rā*).

And notice Kannada’s *b* against Tamil’s *v* — a second Kannada-only habit, sitting right beside the *p* → *h* law:

Tamil	Kannada	meaning
<i>vā</i>	<i>bā</i>	come
<i>vāy</i>	<i>bāyi</i>	mouth

Two laws, both at the front of the word, both Kannada’s own.

Between them they account for much of why Kannada does not sound like its sisters.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*bā*” — come! — then the stem, “*baru-*”
- “*baruttēne*” — I come
- the farewell, taken apart — “*hōgi ... baruttēne*”
- the two Kannada laws together — “*vā ... bā*” and “*pōgu ... hōgu*”

Before you move on

You call this verb *bā* — so what do the endings actually attach to? (ಬರು-, *baru-*.) Build “I come.” (*Baruttēne*.) What are the two halves of *hōgi baruttēne*? (“**H**aving gone” and “**I** come” — Kannada promises the return instead of saying goodbye.) Kannada has *bā* where Tamil has *vā*: what change is that? (**W**ord-initial *v*-became *b*-.) Next: the middle bead.

32.4 ತಿನ್ನು (tinnu) — “to eat,” and the bead that carries time

Hold the first and last beads still and swap only the middle one. That is almost the whole of Kannada tense — almost, because one of the three times you expect is missing.

You’ll want to know: ತಿನ್ನು

ತಿನ್ನು — *tinnu* — to eat

ತಿ (*ta* with the short-*i* sign) + ನ್ನು (a doubled *n* with *u*), the ನ್ನ held long — *tin-nu*.

It is Proto-Dravidian, an old root meaning simply “eat,” and here the family agrees: Telugu తిను (*tinu*), Malayalam തിന്നുക (*tinnuka*). Tamil has the root as தின் (*tin*) — but narrowed it to chewing and snacking, handing everyday eating to சாப்பிடு (*sāppidu*).

For a **full meal**, Kannada reaches instead for ಉಟ ಮಾಡು (*ūṭa māḍu*), “to do a meal” — the same noun-plus-*māḍu* trick that built *kelasa māḍu*, “to work,” in Chapter 5.

Grammar Lens: one bead for the past, and a future that never separated

Hold the stem *tinn-* and the person bead *-ēne* fixed, and let the middle piece do the work:

when	Kannada
now	<i>tinnuttēne</i>
already	<i>tinde</i>
tomorrow	<i>tinnuttēne</i> — again

The past bead is a **-d-**: *tin* + *-d-* + *-e* → ತಿಂದೆ (*tinde*), “I ate.” One consonant of difference between two pieces that never moved. English needs a whole new shape (*ate*); Kannada needs one bead. Now the surprise in the third row. Everyday Kannada keeps **no** separate future — the *-utt-* bead covers both:

ನಾಳೆ ತಿನ್ನುತ್ತೇನೆ — *nāḷe tinnuttēne* — “I’ll eat **tomorrow**.”

The time-word *nāḷe* does the work the verb declines to do. Kannada **has** a distinct future bead, *-uv-* — ತಿನ್ನುವೆನು (*tinnuvenu*) — but you will meet it in writing far more often than in conversation.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “tinnu” — eat — then “tinnuttēne”, I eat
- the past — “tinde”, I ate
- tomorrow, with the same present bead — “nāḷe tinnuttēne”
- the full meal instead — “ūṭa māḍu”

Before you move on

Which of the three beads changes for tense? (**The middle one.**) Say “I ate.” (*Tinde* — the past bead is a *-d-*.) How does everyday Kannada say “I will eat”? (**With the present bead**, *tinnuttēne*, plus a time-word like *nāḷe*.) Which sister narrowed this root away from everyday eating? (**Tamil** — *sāppiḍu* took over.) Next: the third slot, and a word where the four sisters genuinely part company.

32.5 ನೋಡು (nōḍu) — “to see,” and the last bead of all

First bead, the verb. Middle bead, the time. One slot is left — the one that lets Kannada drop “I,” “you” and “she” altogether.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನೋಡು — *nōḍu* — to see, to look

ನೋ (*na* with the long-*ō* sign) + ಡು (*ḍu*, tongue curled back — the retroflex *ḍ*, not an English *d*).

Nōḍu is native Dravidian, close kin to Tamil’s நோக்கு (*nōkku*, “to look”) — though the exact reconstruction is not fully settled.

What is settled is stranger. Every sister has a native Dravidian everyday word for “see,” and **no two chose the same one**: Kannada ನೋಡು (*nōḍu*), Tamil பார் (*pār*), Telugu చూడు (*cūḍu*), Malayalam കാണുക (*kāṇuka*). Four inherited roots, one meaning each — a genuine split, like the cat-word in Chapter 21.

And the passed-over roots did not vanish. Kannada still has ಕಾಣು (*kāṇu*) — Malayalam’s very root — with a different job: “to appear, to be visible.”

Grammar Lens: the third slot, and where gender lives

Hold *nōḍutt-* still and swap only the last bead:

who	Kannada
I	<i>nōḍuttēne</i>
you, familiar	<i>nōḍuttīya</i>
you, respectful	<i>nōḍuttīri</i>
he	<i>nōḍuttāne</i>
she	<i>nōḍuttāle</i>
they	<i>nōḍuttāre</i>

Six endings, and they are not *nōḍu*’s — they are the same six on every verb in this chapter. Learn them once and the other five come free.

Two things worth naming. **Gender lives only in the third person** — *-āne* he, *-āle* she; *nōḍuttēne* is the same word whoever says it. And **the respectful *-ttīri* is the plural ending**, the same plural-for-respect you met at *nīvu*, sitting inside Chapter 3’s ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? (*nīvu hēgiddīrā?*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*nōḍu*” — see — then “*nōḍuttēne*”, I see

- the six endings — “ēne ... īya ... īri ... āne ... āle ... āre”
- the four sisters’ four see-words — “nōḍu ... pār ... cūḍu ... kāṇuka”
- the same six beads on another verb — “hōguttēne ... hōguttāne ... hōguttāre”

Before you move on

Which slot does the last bead fill? (**Person** — which is why the pronoun can be dropped.) In which person does Kannada mark gender? (**The third** only.) Do the four sisters share an everyday word for “see”? (**No** — *nōḍu*, *pār*, *cūḍu*, *kāṇuka*, four different native roots.) What job does *kāṇu* do in Kannada? (“To **appear**.”) Next: a know-word with no beads at all.

32.6 ಗೊತ್ತು (gottu) — “known,” the word with no beads at all

Five verbs, every one ending on a bead that meant “I.” The last word of the chapter has no such bead — and Chapter 6 handed you the sentence it makes, whole, before you could take it apart.

You’ll want to know: ಗೊತ್ತು

ಗೊತ್ತು — *gottu* — **known**

ಗೊ (*ga* with the short-*o* sign) + ತ್ತು (a doubled *t* with *u*), the ತ್ತ held long — *got-tu*.

And here is the catch: *gottu* is **not a verb**. It is a noun-like word meaning “known, settled, fixed.” No stem slot, no tense bead, no person bead — and it never changes shape.

ನನಗೆ ಗೊತ್ತು. — *nanage gottu*. — literally “**to-me** [it is] **known**.”

Grammar Lens: no person slot, so the person moves out

Chapter 6 told you *nānu* was gone and the dative *nanage* stood in its place. Now you can see **why**: a person bead needs a verb to sit on, and *gottu* is not one. So the knower is pushed outside the word entirely:

- *nanage gottu* — known **to me**
- *ninage gottu* — known **to you**
- *avanige gottu* — known **to him**

Only the little dative word changes. That is the chapter’s closing symmetry: five verbs carried the person in the ending, so *nānu* could be dropped; here the ending carries no person, so the dative word is the one thing you **cannot** drop.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Kannada does have proper verbs for knowing, both native Dravidian. ತಿಳಿ (*tīli*, “to become clear”) takes all three beads — ತಿಳಿಯುತ್ತದೆ (*tīliyuttade*). ಅರಿ (*ari*, “to perceive”) survives mostly in writing. Both have cousins: *tīli* answers Tamil தெளி (*teḷi*) and Telugu తెలియ (*teḷiyu*), everyday form తెలుసు (*telusu*); *ari* answers Tamil அறி (*ari*) and Malayalam അറിയുക (*ariyuka*). Underneath, this family’s word for “know” usually means “**become clear**” — and all four sisters put the knower in the dative, exactly as Chapter 6’s table showed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “gottu” — known — then “nanage gottu”, I know
- the three knowers, one unchanged word — “nanage ... ninage ... avanige gottu”
- the five that carried the person — “iruttēne, hōguttēne, baruttēne, tinnuttēne, nōḍuttēne”

Before you move on

Is *gottu* a verb? (**No** — a noun-like word meaning “known, settled,” with none of the three beads.) So where does the knower go, and why? (**Into the dative**, *nanage* — there is no person slot for it.) Say “I know.” (*Nanage gottu*.) Name the three slots one last time. (**Stem, tense, person** — *nōḍu* + *-utt-* + *-ēne*.) And the law behind *pōgu* → *hōgu*? (**Initial p-** became **h-** — in Kannada alone.)

Chapter 33

Four Verbs of Mind and Page

Modes: ⇌ voice (4) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say I think, I understand, I read and I write in Kannada, name the suffix that turns a Sanskrit noun into a Kannada verb, use the ending that hands an action back to its doer, and give both of the front-of-the-word sound laws that separate Kannada from Tamil.

Say ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಬರೆಯುತ್ತೇನೆ, keep it apart from ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ one vowel away, explain the glide a vowel-final stem needs, take bare back to the Dravidian line-drawing root behind Tamil ಖರಾ, set the $v \rightarrow b$ law beside the $p \rightarrow h$ law, and count this chapter's four verbs onto Chapter 32's six to reach hattū.

33.1 ಯೋಚಿಸು (yōcisu) — “to think,” a borrowed word on a Kannada frame

Nanage gottu — “known to me,” a word with no beads at all, so the knower sat outside it. Now the opposite case: a verb with all three beads, whose stem is not Kannada.

You’ll want to know: ಯೋಚಿಸು

ಯೋಚಿಸು — *yōcisu* — to think

ನಾನು ಯೋಚಿಸುತ್ತೇನೆ. — *nānu yōcisuttēne*. — “I think.”

The pronoun is optional. The noun beside the verb is ಯೋಚನೆ (*yōcane*), “a thought.”

The letters in this word

ಯೋ is ಯ (ya) with the long-ō sign, then ಚಿ, then ಸು — three even beats, *yō-ci-su*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Chapter 9 built ಕ್ಷಮಿಸು (*kṣamisu*, “to forgive”) from the Sanskrit noun ಕ್ಷಮಾ (*kṣamā*) plus -ಇಸು (*-isu*), Kannada’s verb-making suffix. *Yōcisu* is the same machine: ಯೋಚಿಸು plus *-isu*.

And *yōcane* is itself Sanskrit — योजना (*yojanā*), “a joining, an arranging,” from the root युज् (*yuj*), “**to yoke**”: the root behind *yoga* and behind English **yoke**. Thinking, so told, is putting things together.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Kannada’s inherited think-word did not die. It changed jobs. ನೆನೆ (*nene*) is ordinary and alive, and means “**to call to mind, to remember**.”

The Dravidian dictionaries reconstruct that root as **nen-ay*, “**to think**” — and Tamil நினை (*ninai*) is the same word, doing Tamil’s everyday thinking. Two sisters divided one root’s work: Kannada thinks with a borrowed noun and remembers with the old verb; Tamil thinks with the old verb outright.

Grammar Lens: a borrowed stem, the native machine

Nothing of *yōcisu*’s origin shows in how it works:

yōcisu + *-utt-* + *-ēne* → ಯೋಚಿಸುತ್ತೇನೆ

Stem, tense, person — the three slots that built *iruttēne*, and the six person endings untouched: *yōcisuttīya*, *yōcisuttāne*, *yōcisuttāḷe*, *yōcisuttāre*. A word may come from anywhere; once *-isu* is on it, it is a Kannada verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “*yōcisu*” — think — then “*yōcisuttēne*”
- two builds, one suffix — “*kṣamā*, *isu* ... *yōcane*, *isu*”

- the old root’s two lives — “nene” ... Tamil “ninai”
- beadless, then three-bead — “nanage gottu ... yōcisuttēne”

Before you move on

Say “I think,” name the suffix that made it a verb, and name the Chapter 9 word built that way. (*Yōcisuttēne*; -ಇಸು; *kṣamisu*.) Which Sanskrit root sits inside *yōcane*, and what does it mean? (*Yuj* — “to yoke,” the root of *yoga*.) What does ನೆನೆ mean, and what is its Tamil cousin doing? (**To remember**; *ninai* is Tamil’s everyday “think.”) Why does ಗೊತ್ತು take no *-ēne*? (**It is not a verb** — no person slot, so its knower goes into the dative.)

33.2 ಅರ್ಥಮಾಡಿಕೊ (arthamāḍiko) — “to understand,” in three welded pieces

Yōcisuttēne was one borrowed noun with one Kannada suffix. The next verb is three separate words fused into one, and only the first is borrowed.

You’ll want to know: ಅರ್ಥಮಾಡಿಕೊ

ಅರ್ಥಮಾಡಿಕೊ — *arthamāḍiko* — **to understand**

ನಾನು ಅರ್ಥಮಾಡಿಕೊಳ್ಳುತ್ತೇನೆ. — *nānu arthamāḍikolluttēne*. — “I understand.”

Long, and worth saying slowly, because every piece has a name:

- ಅರ್ಥ (*artha*) — “**meaning**,” a Sanskrit noun taken in whole.
- ಮಾಡಿ (*māḍi*) — “**having done**,” from the native ಮಾಡು (*māḍu*, “to do”) of Chapter 5’s *kelasa māḍu*, “to work.”
- -ಕೊ (*-ko*) — “**and take it for yourself**.”

Meaning — made — taken back. That is the whole word.

The letters in this word

ಥೆ stacks a silent *r* over ಥ (*tha*, breathy), and the long form holds its ಳ್ಳ — *koḷ-ḷut-tē-ne*, the retroflex *ḷ* doubled.

Grammar Lens: -ಕೊ, the ending that gives the action back

-ಕೊ is a worn-down ಕೊಳ್ಳು (*koḷḷu*), a real verb meaning “to take **for oneself**.” Glued onto another verb it says: whatever this action produced, the doer keeps. Tamil கொள் (*koḷ*) and Telugu కొను (*konu*) are the same ancient word at the same job.

Kannada has a second way to say it, with no doer at all:

ನನಗೆ ಅರ್ಥವಾಯಿತು. — *nanage arthavāyitu*. — “to me it became meaning” — “**I understood.**”

That is Chapter 6’s dative subject, the frame that carried *nanage gottu*. So Kannada offers a choice: take the meaning yourself with *-ko*, or let it arrive at you in the dative.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Telugu builds understanding from the same parts: అర్థం చేసుకో (*artham cēsuko*) — *artham*, its own “do” verb, its own *-ko*. Tamil declines the loan for a native verb, புரிந்துகொள் (*purintukol*), yet keeps the *koḷ* — the same instinct that left Tamil’s everyday “think” as the inherited *ninai* while Kannada reached for a Sanskrit noun.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three pieces — “*artha ... māḍi ... ko*”
- “*arthamāḍikoḷḷuttēne*” — I understand
- the dative way — “*nanage arthavāyitu*”
- two datives together — “*nanage gottu ... nanage arthavāyitu*”
- this chapter so far — “*yōcisuttēne ... arthamāḍikoḷḷuttēne*”

Before you move on

Name the three pieces of ಅರ್ಥಮಾಡಿಕೊ and say which one is borrowed. (*Artha*, *māḍi*, *-ko*; **artha** is Sanskrit, the other two are native.) What does *-ko* do, and which verb is it worn down from? (**Hands the action back to its doer**; *koḷḷu*.) Give the other way to say “I understood,” and name the Chapter 6 sentence it matches. (*Nanage arthavāyitu*; *nanage gottu*.) Which sister keeps the ending but refuses the noun? (**Tamil** — *purintukol*.)

33.3 ಓದು (ōdu) — “to read,” and a warning about one letter

Arthamāḍikolluttēne — four syllables of ending. The next verb is two letters long, and the whole difficulty is keeping it apart from one you already have.

You’ll want to know: ಓದು

ಓದು — *ōdu* — **to read**, and also **to study**

ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಓದುತ್ತೇನೆ. — *nānu kannada ōduttēne*. — “I read Kannada.”

Say it beside Chapter 32’s ನೋಡು (*nōḍu*, “to see”). They differ by a single opening consonant and by which *d* they use:

Kannada	said	means
ಓದು	<i>ōdu</i> , plain <i>d</i>	read
ನೋಡು	<i>nōḍu</i> , curled <i>ḍ</i>	see

Ōdu also does the work English splits off as “study.” Kannada does not keep the two apart: the same verb covers reading a page and reading for a degree.

The letters in this word

ಓ is the independent long *ō*, a letter in its own right rather than a sign hung on a consonant. Then ದು (*du*) — tongue at the teeth, not curled back. That is the one contrast to guard: *nōḍu* curls, *ōdu* does not.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Ōdu is inherited, not borrowed. The Dravidian dictionaries reconstruct **ōtu*, “to recite, to read,” and list the sisters: Tamil ஒது (*ōtu*) and Malayalam ഓതുക (*ōtuka*).

Notice the meaning that comes first in that gloss. The old sense is **reciting aloud** — reading in a world where you always said the words out loud — and Tamil’s word stayed there, narrowing to the chanting of sacred verse. Tamil’s everyday “read” became a different word, படி (*paṭi*); Telugu’s is చదువు (*caduvu*).

So Kannada is the sister that left the inherited word in its ordinary job. That is the reverse of what happened with thinking, where Kannada took the loan and Tamil kept the old root as *ninai*. Neither language borrows on principle; each word made its own bargain.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the pair, slowly — “ōdu ... nōḍu”
- “nānu kannāḍa ōduttēne” — I read Kannada
- the sisters’ read-words — “ōdu ... ōtu ... paṭi ... caduvu”
- the chapter so far — “yōcisuttēne, arthamāḍikoḷḷuttēne, ōduttēne”

Before you move on

Say “I read Kannada,” then say “I see” — and name what separates the two verbs. (*Nānu kannāḍa ōduttēne*; *nōḍuttēne*; the opening *n-* and a **curled ḍ** against a **plain d**.) What did the old root mean before it meant reading? (**Reciting aloud** — and Tamil’s *ōtu* stayed there.) Which sister keeps the inherited word for everyday reading? (**Kannada**.) And which one keeps the inherited word for everyday thinking? (**Tamil**, with *ninai*.)

33.4 ಬರೆ (bare) — “to write,” which began as scratching a line

Ōduttēne, “I read.” Its partner sits one vowel from a verb you have had since Chapter 32.

You’ll want to know: ಬರೆ

ಬರೆ — *bare* — **to write**, equally **to draw**

ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಬರೆಯುತ್ತೇನೆ. — *nānu kannada bareyuttēne*. — “I write Kannada.”

The trap: ಬರು (*baru*) is the come-stem under *bā*.

Kannada	means
ಬರೆಯುತ್ತೇನೆ <i>bareyuttēne</i>	I write
ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ <i>baruttēne</i>	I come

Chapter 20’s weather line takes the second — ಮಳೆ ಬರುತ್ತಿದೆ (*maḷe barut-tide*), “rain is coming.

Grammar Lens: the glide a vowel-final stem needs

Why *bare-y-uttēne*? The stem ends in a vowel, and Kannada will not let two vowels collide, so it slips a ಯ (*y*) between:

$bare + y + -utt- + -ēne \rightarrow ಬರೆಯುತ್ತೇನೆ$

Stems in *-u* need none: *ōdu* gives *ōduttēne* straight off. Stems in *-e* or *-i* take the glide. The six person endings are unchanged: *bareyuttīri*, *bareyuttāne*, *bareyuttāre*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Bare is inherited, from a root reconstructed as **warV-*, “**to scratch, to draw lines**.” Every sister still means **draw** as readily as **write** — Tamil வரை (*varai*), Malayalam വരയ്ക്കുക (*varaykkuka*), Telugu రాయ (*rāyu*).

Now the front of those words: Tamil *v-*, Kannada *b-* — Chapter 32’s law, the one that gave ಬಾ (*bā*) for *vā*. Kannada has two such laws:

law	Tamil or older	Kannada
$p \rightarrow h$	<i>pattu, pasir</i>	<i>hattu, hasiru</i>
$v \rightarrow b$	<i>vā, varai</i>	<i>bā, bare</i>
Between them they explain much of Kannada's distinctive sound.		

What you've built: four more verbs, and ten in all

Chapter 32 handed you ಆರು (*āru*) verbs: *iru, hōgu, baru, tinnu, nōḍu, gottu*. Four more makes ಹತ್ತು (*hattu*), ten, and none needed a new machine. What they added was history: *yōcisu* a Sanskrit noun on a Kannada suffix, *arthamāḍiko* one welded to two native verbs, *ōdu* and *bare* inherited outright.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nānu kannāḍa bareyuttēne” — I write Kannada
- the pair that must not merge — “bareyuttēne ... baruttēne ... maḷe baruttide”
- the root across the sisters — “bare ... varai ... rāyu”
- the two laws — “pattu, hattu; pasir, hasiru; vā, bā; varai, bare”
- the four, then the count — “yōcisuttēne, arthamāḍikoḷuttēne, ōduttēne, bareyuttēne ... āru, hattu”

Before you move on

Say “I write Kannada,” then “I come.” (*Nānu kannāḍa bareyuttēne; baruttēne* — **one vowel** apart.) Why the *y*? (**The stem ends in a vowel**; *ōdu* needs none.) What did **warV-* mean, and what is Tamil's form? (**To scratch a line**; *varai*, its *v* against Kannada's *b*.) Run the chapter's four and count them onto Chapter 32's six. (*Yōcisuttēne, arthamāḍikoḷuttēne, ōduttēne, bareyuttēne* — *āru* plus four is *hattu*.)

Chapter 34

Four Verbs Between People

Modes: ⇄ voice (4) ✍ pen (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 4 of 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say I take, I ask and I help in Kannada, say I like Kannada in a sentence with no verb in it, place it beside the two other dative sentences I have built, and show that the frame it uses was Kannada’s own before any Sanskrit word moved into it.

Say ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಇಷ್ಟ and unpack it as “to me, Kannada, a liking” with no verb at all; line it up against ನನಗೆ ಗೊತ್ತು and ನನಗೆ ಬೇಕು; show that the inherited *bēku* takes the same dative and answers Tamil *vēṇṭum* by the *v* → *b* law; and trace *iṣṭa* to the Indo-European root behind English *ask*, unrelated to the *kēḷu* of the same chapter.

34.1 ತೆಗೆದುಕೊ (tegeduko) — “to take,” in two verbs rather than one

Bareyuttēne, with its glide. The last chapter ended on writing. This one opens on the plainest thing a person does — taking something — and Kannada needs two verbs to say it.

You’ll want to know: ತೆಗೆದುಕೊ

ತೆಗೆದುಕೊ — *tegeduko* — to take

ನಾನು ತೆಗೆದುಕೊಳ್ಳುತ್ತೇನೆ. — *nānu tegedukolluttēne*. — “I take it.”

The ending is one you have already met. -ಕೊ is Chapter 33's -ko, the worn *koḷḷu*, “take for oneself” — the very ending inside *arthamādikolḷuttēne*. What is new is the verb underneath it:

- ತೆಗೆ (*tege*) — “to pull, to draw towards oneself, to remove.”
- ತೆಗೆದು (*tegedu*) — the same verb as “having pulled it out.”
- ತೆಗೆದು + ಕೊ — having pulled it out, keep it.

English has one flat word, *take*. Kannada narrates the whole gesture: the pulling, then the keeping.

The letters in this word

ತೆ-ಗೆ-ದು runs light and even — *te-ge-du*, all short. Then the ending lands heavy, its ಳ್ಳ held long: *koḷ-ḷut-tē-ne*. Light, light, light, then weight.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Both halves are old, and the dictionaries file each with its cousins. ತೆಗೆ sits in one entry with Telugu తీయు (*tīyu*), “to pull, to draw, to take.” ಕೊಳ್ಳು sits in another with Tamil கொள் (*koḷ*) and Telugu కొను (*konu*). Put them together and the sisters line up:

language	“take”	built from
Kannada	<i>tegeduko</i>	<i>tege + ko</i>
Telugu	<i>tīsuko</i>	<i>tīsi + ko</i>
Tamil	<i>eṭuttukkoḷ</i>	<i>eṭuttu + koḷ</i>

Kannada and Telugu share **both** roots. Tamil shares only the second: its first verb is எடு (*eṭu*), a different word altogether.

That cuts against the family tree, where Kannada stands with Tamil and Malayalam and Telugu sits one branch over. A tree records descent, not the fate of every word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the gesture in order — “tege ... tegedu ... tegedukolḷuttēne”
- the two verbs sharing an ending — “arthamādikolḷuttēne ... tegedukolḷuttēne”

- the sisters’ take-words — “tegeduko ... tīsuko ... eṭuttukkoḷ”
- with and without the glide — “bareyuttēne ... ōduttēne”

Before you move on

Say “I take it,” then name the two verbs inside it. (*Nānu tegedukolluttēne*; *tege*, “to pull out,” and *kollu*, “to keep for oneself.”) Which other verb of yours carries the same ending? (*Arthamāḍikolluttēne*.) Which sister matches Kannada on both roots, and which on only one? (**Telugu** on both; **Tamil** on the second, with its own *eṭu* in front.) And why is that mildly surprising? (**The family tree** puts Kannada with Tamil, not with Telugu — descent does not decide every word.)

34.2 ಕೇಳು (kēḷu) — one verb for “ask” and for “hear”

Tegedukolluttēne took two verbs to say one English word. Now the opposite bargain: one Kannada verb covering two English ones.

You’ll want to know: ಕೇಳು

ಕೇಳು — *kēḷu* — to ask — and to hear, to listen

ನಾನು ಕೇಳುತ್ತೇನೆ. — *nānu kēḷuttēne*. — “I ask.” Or: “I hear.”

Both readings are correct. Kannada is not being vague; it files the two acts under one verb. The stem ends in *-u*, so no glide.

The letters in this word

ಕೇ is ಕ (*ka*) with the long-*ē* sign; ಳು carries the retroflex ಳ of *ēḷu*, “seven.” Hold that *ē*: *kē-ḷu*, not *ke-ḷu*.

Grammar Lens: how you tell which job it is doing

What settles the meaning is what stands beside the verb. Put a **person** next to it and it asks them; put a **sound** next to it and it hears that sound. Nothing in *kēḷuttēne* changes.

The polite imperative is the plain one you already build: ಕೇಳಿ (*kēḷi*) — “ask,” or “listen,” with the bare -^೨ ending of *kṣamisi*. And if you must be unambiguous, ಪ್ರಶ್ನೆ ಕೇಳು (*praśne kēḷu*) is “to ask a question.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Not a Kannada quirk. The Dravidian dictionaries reconstruct the root with **both senses at once** — “to hear, to ask” — and the sisters carry the pair: Tamil கேள் (*kēḷ*), Malayalam കേൾക്കുക (*kēḷkkuka*), Tulu *kēḷuni*.

Telugu is the odd one out. It splits the work between విను (*vinu*), “to hear,” and అడుగు (*aḍugu*), “to ask.”

Be careful how much that carries. Kannada, Tamil and Malayalam do sit on one branch of the family and Telugu on the next one over, so the split looks tidy. But the root reaches Telugu’s own branch-mates Gondi and Kui: Telugu **dropped** a word its neighbours kept. Chapter 7 found the identical pattern in the numbers, where eight and nine are where Telugu wanders off.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “kēḷuttēne” — as “I ask”, then as “I hear”
- the polite form — “kēḷi”
- the sisters who keep both senses — “kēḷu ... kēḷ ... kēḷkkuka”
- the sister who splits them — “vinu ... aḍugu”
- three inherited verbs of yours — “ōduttēne, bareyuttēne, kēḷuttēne”

Before you move on

Give the two meanings of *kēḷuttēne*, and say what decides between them. (**I ask** and **I hear**; whatever stands **beside the verb** — a person or a sound.) Is the double job Kannada’s own invention? (**No** — the root is reconstructed with both senses, and Tamil and Malayalam carry the pair too.) Which sister splits them, and what is the honest wording? (**Telugu**, *vinu* against *aḍugu* — it **dropped**

the old word, since Gondi and Kui still have it.) Say “please ask.”
(*Kēḷi*.)

34.3 ಸಹಾಯ ಮಾಡು (sahāya māḍu) — “to help,” a noun and a verb

Kēḷi — “ask,” or “listen.” Now the sentence you would most want a stranger to understand, and it is built on a pattern Chapter 5 already gave you.

You’ll want to know: ಸಹಾಯ ಮಾಡು

ಸಹಾಯ ಮಾಡು — *sahāya māḍu* — **to help**, literally “**help-do**”

ನಾನು ಸಹಾಯ ಮಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ. — *nānu sahāya māḍuttēne*. — “I help.”

ಸಹಾಯ ಮಾಡಿ. — *sahāya māḍi*. — “**Please help.**”

The second of those is the one to keep loaded. It is the same bare -ಃ imperative that gave you *kēḷi*, sitting on the same *māḍu* that Chapter 5 used for ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡು (*kelasa māḍu*), “to work.” Kannada builds a great many verbs this way: a noun in front, *māḍu* behind.

The letters in this word

ಸಹಾಯ has its weight in the middle — *sa-hā-ya* — and that ಹ is a real, breathed *h*, not a swallowed one. Then ಮಾಡು with its own long *ā* and the curled ಡ: *sa-hā-ya mā-ḍu*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಸಹಾಯ is Sanskrit सहाय, and the standard analysis splits it into सह (*saha*, “with”) plus अय (*aya*, “going”) — “one who goes with.” A helper, at root, is a companion on the road. That *saha* reaches back further, to an Indo-European root **sem-*, “one, together” — the root behind English **same** and Latin *simul*. Now the layering. *Sahāya* is Sanskrit; *māḍu* is native Dravidian; the two live in one Kannada verb. Chapter 20’s ಹವಾಮಾನ (*havāmāna*) was the same trick with different parts, Persian *hava* welded to Sanskrit

māna. Kannada does not keep its vocabularies in separate rooms — and the choice is per word, not per topic: helping came in from Sanskrit while asking stayed inherited, *kēlu* arriving with both its senses already attached.
And the native word for help did not leave: *ನೆರವು* (*neravu*), “help, aid,” is ordinary Kannada, and *ನೆರವಾಗು* (*neravāgu*) means “to be of help.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the one to keep loaded — “*sahāya māḍi*”
- “*nānu sahāya māḍuttēne*” — I help
- two imperatives, one ending — “*kēli ... sahāya māḍi*”
- two hybrids — “*havāmāna*” then “*sahāya māḍu*”
- the native word beside it — “*neravu*”
- this chapter so far — “*tegedukolluttēne, kēluttēne, sahāya māḍuttēne*”

Before you move on

Say “please help,” then “I help.” (*Sahāya māḍi; nānu sahāya māḍuttēne*.) What are the two pieces of *sahāya*, and what did they mean? (*Saha*, “with,” and *aya*, “going” — “**one who goes with.**”) Which piece of *sahāya māḍu* is Sanskrit and which is native, and what earlier word was layered the same way? (*Sahāya* **Sanskrit**, *māḍu* **native**; *havāmāna*, Persian plus Sanskrit.) Name Kannada’s own native word for help. (*ನೆರವು*, *neravu*.)

34.4 ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಇಷ್ಟ — “I like Kannada,” with no verb in it

Tegedukolluttēne, kēluttēne, sahāya māḍuttēne — each ending on the bead for “I.” The chapter’s last sentence has no verb.

You'll want to know: the sentence

ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಇಷ್ಟ. — *nanage kannada iṣṭa*. — “to me — Kannada
— a liking.”

ಇಷ್ಟ is a **noun**: “a liking, a thing desired.” No *is*, no *like*. ಗೊತ್ತು behaved so too — a noun-like word with no person slot — so only the front word moves: *nanage*, *ninage*, *avanige*.

The letters in this word

ಷ್ಟ stacks ಷ (*ṣa*) over ಟ (*ṭa*), both retroflex.

Grammar Lens: the frame is native even where the word is not

Three sentences, one design, all from Chapter 6's dative subject:

to me ...	it is
<i>nanage gottu</i> , known	a fact
<i>nanage kannada iṣṭa</i> , a liking	a taste
<i>nanage bēku</i> , wanted	a need

These **happen to you**, so the person sits in the dative and nothing acts.

The third settles a question the second raises. If *iṣṭa* is borrowed, is the frame? No. ಬೇಕು (*bēku*, “is wanted”) is inherited Dravidian, takes the same dative, and answers Tamil வேண்டும் (*vēṇṭum*) by the *v* → *b* law behind *bā* and *bare*. Sanskrit only filled a slot.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಇಷ್ಟ is Sanskrit इष्ट, past participle of इष् (*iṣ*), “to desire,” from an Indo-European root whose English descendant is So the chapter holds two unrelated asking-words: the inherited *kēlu*, with its double job, and this loan — as *sahāya* was borrowed and the take-word was not. Tamil takes no loan: எனக்குத் தமிழ் பிடிக்கும் (*enakkut tamīl piḍikkum*) rests on native பிடி (*piḍi*), “to grasp.” Telugu borrowed: నాకు తెలుగు ఇష్టం (*nāku telugu iṣṭam*).

Kannada's company here is not its family. Spanish says **me gusta el kannada**, “Kannada pleases me,” with the liker in the dative; Italian says **mi piace**. Romance and Dravidian borrowed nothing from each other. They arrived at one shape independently.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nanage kannāḍa iṣṭa” — to me, Kannada, a liking
- three likers, one unchanged word — “nanage ... ninage ... avanige”
- the three datives, then the Tamil cousin — “gottu ... iṣṭa ... bēku ... vēṇṭum”
- the chapter — “tegedukolluttēne, kēluttēne, sahāya māḍuttēne, iṣṭa”

Before you move on

Say “I like Kannada,” and how many verbs it holds. (*Nanage kannāḍa iṣṭa*; **none**.) Name the three datives. (*Nanage gottu*, a **fact**; *nanage kannāḍa iṣṭa*, a **taste**; *nanage bēku*, a **need**.) Is the frame borrowed with the word? (**No** — inherited *bēku* uses it, answering *vēṇṭum* by the *v* → *b* law.) Which English word is *iṣṭa*’s cousin? (**Ask** — and *kēlu* is no relation.)

34.5 ಓ — one character, met inside a word you already say

Before the new one: ಷ — what sound does it carry?

One character this time, and it is the last of the twenty-four this book drizzles in. It waited this long for a reason worth knowing.

Script you’ll notice: ಓ

ಓ — *ō*.

It is an **independent vowel**: the shape a vowel takes when it stands at the start of a word with no consonant in front of it. You have already met its other half, the vowel *sign* ಓ, which is what the same sound looks like when it rides on a consonant.

So the same vowel has two shapes, and which one you see tells you where in the word you are:

- ಓ — standing alone, at the beginning.

- ಫೀ — attached, riding on the consonant before it.

The word you already say that opens with it:

- ಓದು *ōdu* — to read, to study

Why this one came last. Every other character in this sequence was introduced once a word containing it was already in your mouth. ಓ had to wait until ಓದು was taught, because until then there was nothing to find it inside — and a character shown without a word to hold it is a character you will not keep.

Writing: ಓ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ಓ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two, and say which one begins with the independent vowel

ಓದು · ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ

- *Trace it:* ಓ three times, saying *ō* as you finish each one
- *Look:* at ಓ and ಫೀ side by side, and say which one stands alone

Before you move on

Which character is this — ಓ? What sound does it carry? (*ō*.) What is the difference between ಓ and ಫೀ? (One stands alone at the start of a word; the other rides on a consonant.)

Chapter 35

Family and Friends

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 2 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name my family as a group in Kannada and name a friend, and say which of the two words is native and which is a Sanskrit loan.

Say ಇದು ನನ್ನ ಕುಟುಂಬ and ಇವನು ನನ್ನ ಸ್ನೇಹಿತ, trace kuṭumba and snēhita back to Sanskrit, and set snēhita beside the native pair ಗೆಲೆಯ/ಗೆಲತಿ.

35.1 ಕುಟುಂಬ (kuṭumba) — “family,” the word the household words never needed

Nanage kannada iṣṭa closed the last chapter on a sentence built from nothing but nouns. This chapter opens on the plainest nouns of all: the words for the people you would actually say that sentence to.

You’ll want to know: ಕುಟುಂಬ

ಕುಟುಂಬ — *kuṭumba* — family

ಇದು ನನ್ನ ಕುಟುಂಬ. — *idu nanna kuṭumba*. — “This is my family.”

Nanna, “my,” has been yours since Chapter 2.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಕುಟುಂಬ is Sanskrit कुटुम्ब (*kuṭumba*), “family, household,” carried into Kannada whole — the same kind of loan as ಇಷ್ಟ and ಸಹಾಯ. Chapter 12 gave you six words: ಅಪ್ಪ, ಅಮ್ಮ, and the four age-graded siblings ಅಣ್ಣ/ತಮ್ಮ, ಅಕ್ಕ/ತಂಗಿ. Every one is native Dravidian, and not one of them means “family” — each names a single specific person. Kannada never inherited a word for the group itself, so when it needed one, it reached for Sanskrit. The people came first, and stayed native; the collective came later, and came borrowed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “idu nanna kuṭumba” — this is my family
- the six named people, then the borrowed group word — “appa, amma, aṇṇa, tamma, akka, tangi ... kuṭumba”
- “nanage kannada iṣṭa” — once more, no verb in it

Before you move on

Say “this is my family.” (*Idu nanna kuṭumba.*) Is *kuṭumba* native Dravidian or a loan? (**A Sanskrit loan**, like *iṣṭa* and *sahāya*.) Name Chapter 12’s six family words. (*Appa, amma, aṇṇa, tamma, akka, tangi.*) Which of those six means “family” as a group? (**None of them** — that’s exactly the gap *kuṭumba* fills.)

35.2 ಸ್ನೇಹಿತ (snēhita) — “friend,” built out of the word for oil

Kuṭumba named the people you are born into. Not every important person in your life is one of them.

You’ll want to know: ಸ್ನೇಹಿತ

ಸ್ನೇಹಿತ — *snēhita* — **friend** (a woman friend is ಸ್ನೇಹಿತೆ, *snēhite*)

ಇವನು ನನ್ನ ಸ್ನೇಹಿತ. — *ivanu nanna snēhita.* — “He is my friend.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಸ್ನೇಹಿತ is Sanskrit स्नेहित (*snēhita*), built on स्नेह (*snēha*). *Snēha*’s **first** meaning is not “affection” at all — it is “**oil, unctuousness, smoothness.**” Only from there did it stretch to “fondness, love”: a substance that makes things slide smoothly together became the word for whatever binds two people the same way.

Kannada also holds an inherited word for the same idea, and it did not retire when the Sanskrit one arrived: ಗೆಲೆಯ (*geḷeya*, a male friend) and ಗೆಲತಿ (*geḷati*, a female friend) are ordinary, everyday Dravidian words, sitting right beside *snēhita* the way ನೆರವು sits beside *sahāya*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ivanu nanna snēhita” — he is my friend
- the loan, then the native pair — “snēhita ... geḷeya, geḷati”
- oil, then affection — “snēha: oil ... snēha: love”
- family, then friend — “kuṭumba ... snēhita”

Before you move on

Say “he is my friend.” (*Ivanu nanna snēhita*.) What did *snēha* mean before it meant “affection”? (**Oil, smoothness.**) Name Kannada’s native word for a friend. (ಗೆಲೆಯ *geḷeya*, or ಗೆಲತಿ *geḷati* for a woman.) Is *kuṭumba* the people you choose, or the people you’re born into? (**Born into** — *snēhita* is who you choose.)

Chapter 36

One Root, Three Endings

Modes: ⇄ voice (3) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say child, son and daughter in Kannada, and show how one shared root with three different endings does the job Chapter 12 needed four separate words for.

Line up ಮಗು, ಮಗ and ಮಗಳು against Proto-Dravidian maka, and contrast gender-by-ending here with Chapter 12’s four unrelated age-graded sibling words.

36.1 ಮಗು (magu) — “child,” before it picks a gender

Snēhita and *geḷeya* were two words for one idea. This word is the opposite kind of pair-maker: one word that the next two lessons will split in two.

You’ll want to know: ಮಗು

ಮಗು — *magu* — baby, child (no gender specified)

ಇದು ನನ್ನ ಮಗು. — *idu nanna magu.* — “This is my child.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಮಗು goes back to Proto-Dravidian ***maka**, “child” — a plain root with no gender marked on it at all. Hold that root in mind: the next lesson adds one ending to it and gets “son”; the one after adds a

different ending and gets “daughter.” Chapter 12 solved the parallel problem — telling siblings apart — with four completely separate words. This root solves a smaller problem the opposite way: one shape, several endings.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “idu nanna magu” — this is my child
- the root to hold onto — “maka”
- friend, then child — “snēhita ... magu”

Before you move on

Say “this is my child.” (*Idu nanna magu.*) Does *magu* specify a gender? (**No.**) What is the Proto-Dravidian root underneath it, and what happens to it next? (**maka* — the next two lessons put different endings on it for “son” and “daughter.”)

36.2 ಮಗ (maga) — “son,” the same root with one vowel doing the work

Maga, magu — hold the root steady and change almost nothing.

You’ll want to know: ಮಗ

ಮಗ — *maga* — son

ಇವನು ನನ್ನ ಮಗ. — *ivanu nanna maga.* — “He is my son.”

Set beside *magu*: ಮಗು *magu* → ಮಗ *maga*. The same three letters, minus the length on the final vowel — the plain, inherent *-a* now standing for “male.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Maga descends from the same Proto-Dravidian ***maka** as *magu*. The sisters carry a longer form for “son” — reconstructed as ***magan** — and Kannada is the branch that wore the ending down to a single open vowel. Tamil keeps more of the shape: **மகன்** (*makan*), “son.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ivanu nanna maga” — he is my son
- the near pair — “magu ... maga”
- Kannada’s worn form, then Tamil’s fuller one — “maga ... makan”

Before you move on

Say “he is my son.” (*Ivanu nanna maga*.) How does *maga* differ from *magu*? (**One vowel** — the plain *-a* standing for “male.”) What does Tamil’s fuller form for “son” look like? (**மகன்** *makan* — Kannada wore the ending down to just the vowel.)

36.3 ಮಗಳು (magalu) — “daughter,” one more ending on the same root

Magu gave you the plain root, *maga* the male ending. One more ending closes the set.

You’ll want to know: ಮಗಳು

ಮಗಳು — *magalu* — daughter

ಇವಳು ನನ್ನ ಮಗಳು. — *ivalu nanna magalu*. — “She is my daughter.”

Grammar Lens: gender by ending, not by a new word

Line the three up:

Kannada	means
ಮಗು <i>magu</i>	child, no gender
ಮಗ <i>maga</i>	son
ಮಗಳು <i>magalu</i>	daughter

One root, three endings. Chapter 12 solved a different split — **older** against **younger** sibling — the opposite way, with **four unrelated words**, ಅಣ್ಣ/ತಮ್ಮ and ಅಕ್ಕ/ತಂಗಿ sharing no root at all. Gender here rides on a suffix; age there needed a whole new word every time.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Magalu continues Proto-Dravidian ***makaḷ**, “daughter.” Tamil மகள் (*makaḷ*) and Malayalam മകൾ (*makaḷ*) are close to identical to Kannada’s own form — this branch of the family barely touched the word at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ivaḷu nanna magalu” — she is my daughter
- the set of three — “magu ... maga ... magalu”
- one root three endings, then four words no root — “maga, magalu ... aṇṇa, tamma, akka, tangi”
- the sisters, near-identical — “magalu ... makaḷ ... makaḷ”

Before you move on

Say “she is my daughter.” (*Ivaḷu nanna magalu*.) Name the three words built on *maka* and what each means. (*Magu* — child; *maga* — son; *magalu* — daughter.) How does that differ from how Chapter 12 split siblings by age? (**Chapter 12 used four unrelated words**; this set uses **one root and different endings**.) How close is Tamil’s word for daughter? (**Nearly identical** — *makaḷ*.)

Chapter 37

Four Words on the Face

Modes: ⇄ voice (4) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name my eye, ear, nose and mouth in Kannada, and say which of the four the Dravidian family agrees on closely and which one splits.

Name ಕಣ್ಣು, ಕಿವಿ, ಮೂಗು and ಬಾಯಿ, and finally explain ಬಾಯಿ — the word this book already used twice, unglossed, as proof of the $v \rightarrow b$ law behind ಬಾ and ಬರೆ.

37.1 ಕಣ್ಣು (kaṇṇu) — “eye,” the same word across four languages

Tale, kai — Chapter 13’s head and hand, and nothing more of the body since. This chapter adds four words to that short list, starting above the nose.

You’ll want to know: ಕಣ್ಣು

ಕಣ್ಣು — kaṇṇu — eye

ನನ್ನ ಕಣ್ಣು. — nanna kaṇṇu. — “My eye.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಕಣ್ಣು continues Proto-Dravidian *kaṇ, “eye.” Tamil கண் (kaṇ) and Malayalam കണ്ണ് (kaṇṇu) sit close beside it — and Telugu కన్ను (kannu) sits closest of all, nearly identical letter for letter. Four

languages that otherwise pull apart on nearly everything — tense, the $p \rightarrow h$ law, half their vocabulary — agree almost completely on this one, the same closeness the last chapter found between Kannada’s *magaḷu* and Tamil and Malayalam’s own *makaḷ*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nanna kaṇṇu” — my eye
- the four sisters, nearly one word — “kaṇṇu ... kaṇ ... kaṇṇũ ... kannu”
- two more near-matches — “magaḷu, makaḷ ... kaṇṇu, kaṇ”
- three body words now — “tale, kai, kaṇṇu”

Before you move on

Say “my eye.” (*Nanna kaṇṇu*.) Which sister matches Kannada’s word almost exactly? (**Telugu** — *kannu*.) Which earlier word showed this same closeness with Tamil and Malayalam? (*ಮಗಲು*, *magaḷu*.) Name the body words you have now. (*Tale*, head; *kai*, hand; *kaṇṇu*, eye.)

37.2 ಕಿವಿ (kivi) — “ear,” where Tamil’s everyday word actually diverges

Kaṇṇu matched all three sisters closely. This one is honest about matching only some of them.

You’ll want to know: ಕಿವಿ

ಕಿವಿ — *kivi* — ear

ನನ್ನ ಕಿವಿ. — *nanna kivi*. — “My ear.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಕಿವಿ continues Proto-Dravidian ***kewi**, “ear.” Telugu’s everyday word చెవి (*cevi*) is the same root, and so is Tamil’s — but only in its **literary** register: செவி (*cevi*) shows up in poetry and formal speech, while ordinary spoken Tamil reaches for an unrelated word instead, காது (*kātu*). It is the same honest split Chapter 34 found in கேள்/*kēl* against Telugu’s *vinu* and *aḍugu*: a shared root can go on living in one register of a language while everyday speech moves on to something else.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nanna kivi” — my ear
- the shared root’s two lives — “cevi, literary ... kātu, everyday”
- eye, then ear — “kaṇṇu ... kivi”

Before you move on

Say “my ear.” (*Nanna kivi.*) Does everyday spoken Tamil use the same root as *kivi*? (**No** — it uses *kātu*; the shared root *cevi* survives mostly in literary Tamil.) Which earlier Kannada word split the same way? (ಕೇಲ್/*kēlu* — kept by three sisters, dropped in Telugu’s everyday speech.)

37.3 ಮೂಗು (*mūgu*) — “nose,” where Telugu is the one that drifts

Kivi split the family down a register line. This word splits it a different way.

You’ll want to know: ಮೂಗು

ಮೂಗು — *mūgu* — nose

ನನ್ನ ಮೂಗು. — *nanna mūgu.* — “My nose.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಮೂಗು continues Proto-Dravidian ***mūnk(k)u**, “nose.” Tamil மூக்கு (*mūkku*) and Malayalam മുക്ക് (*mūkkū*) sit close beside Kannada’s own form. Telugu is the outlier this round: ముక్కు (*mukku*) is treated as a slightly irregular reflex, likely blended with a separate word for “face.” Ear put Telugu with the group and split Tamil’s registers; nose does the opposite — Telugu drifts, and Tamil and Malayalam hold the line.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nanna mūgu” — my nose
- the close sisters, then the drifting one — “mūkku, mūkkū ... mukku”
- ear, then nose — “kivi ... mūgu”

Before you move on

Say “my nose.” (*Nanna mūgu*.) Which sister drifts from the shared root this time? (**Telugu** — *mukku*, likely blended with its word for “face.”) Which two sisters hold the root closely? (**Tamil and Malayalam** — *mūkku*, *mūkkū*.)

37.4 ಬಾಯಿ (bāyi) — “mouth,” a word you’ve already met twice

Bā, come; *bare*, write. Both chapters used one more word in passing, to prove the same sound law, and neither one told you what it meant.

You’ll want to know: ಬಾಯಿ

ಬಾಯಿ — *bāyi* — **mouth**

ನನ್ನ ಬಾಯಿ. — *nanna bāyi*. — “My mouth.”

Four body words now: *tale*, *kai*, *kaṇṇu*, *kivi*, *mūgu*, *bāyi* — six.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಬಾಯಿ answers Tamil வாய் (*vāy*), “mouth,” through the exact law Chapter 32 gave you: word-initial Tamil *v*- becomes Kannada *b*-. You have already seen this pair once, sitting quietly inside Chapter 32’s etymology note for ಬಾ, and again inside Chapter 33’s for ಬರಿ — both times as a worked example, neither time explained. Here is what it means:

Tamil	Kannada	meaning
<i>vā</i>	<i>bā</i>	come
<i>varai</i>	<i>bare</i>	write, draw
<i>vāy</i>	<i>bāyi</i>	mouth

Three clean proofs of one law, and this lesson finally cashes in the third.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nanna *bāyi*” — my mouth
- the three proofs — “*vā*, *bā* ... *varai*, *bare* ... *vāy*, *bāyi*”
- all six body words — “*tale*, *kai*, *kaṇṇu*, *kivi*, *mūgu*, *bāyi*”

Before you move on

Say “my mouth.” (*Nanna bāyi*.) Which two earlier chapters already used this exact word, without explaining it? (**Chapter 32’s** *bā* note and **Chapter 33’s** *bare* note.) Give the law it proves, and its other two examples. (**Word-initial *v*- becomes *b*-** — *vā* → *bā*, *varai* → *bare*.)

Chapter 38

The Heart

Modes: 👁 eyes (1) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can name my heart in Kannada and say why it is a genuine Indo-European cousin of the English word, not just a resemblance.

Say ನನ್ನ ಹೃದಯ, read the vocalic-r sign ್ರ against Chapter 14's independent ಋ, and trace hrdaya to the same Proto-Indo-European root as English heart, Latin cor and Greek kardía.

38.1 ಹೃದಯ (hrdaya) — “heart,” a real cousin of the English word

Six body words so far, all Dravidian. This one is Sanskrit — and it hides the closest kinship to English that this whole book has found.

You'll want to know: ಹೃದಯ

ಹೃದಯ — hrdaya — heart

ನನ್ನ ಹೃದಯ. — nanna hrdaya. — “My heart.”

The letters in this word

(Skip this if you already read Kannada.) ಹೃ is ಹ (ha) carrying a sign you have not met: ್ರ, the **vocalic-r** vowel sign, said ʀ — a short, tapped “ri.” Chapter 14 taught this same sound as a full **independent** letter, ಋ, at

the front of ಋತು (*ṛtu*, “season”), because a word can only open with the independent form. Here the sound falls in the middle of a word, so it rides on a consonant as the small sign ೠ instead: ಹ + ೠ = ಹೃ, *hr̥*. Same sound, two different shapes, depending only on where in the word it lands.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹೃದಯ is Sanskrit हृदय (*hr̥daya*), from Proto-Indo-European ***kērd-**. That root also gave English **heart**, Latin **cor** (behind English *courage* and *cordial*), and Greek **kardía** (behind *cardiac*). Every earlier cross-family match in this book — *iṣṭa* and *ask*, *sahāya* and *same*, Spanish’s *me gusta* — was two languages landing on the same idea by accident, unrelated in ancestry. This one is different: Sanskrit and English are both **Indo-European**, so *hr̥daya* and *heart* are not a coincidence. They are real cousins, descended from the very same word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “nanna hr̥daya” — my heart
- the vocalic-*r*, word-middle and word-initial — “hr̥ ... ṛtu”
- the real cousins — “hr̥daya ... heart ... cor ... kardía”
- seven body words now — “tale, kai, kaṇṇu, kivi, mūgu, bāyi, hr̥daya”

Before you move on

Say “my heart.” (*Nanna hr̥daya*.) Where else have you seen the vocalic-*r* sound, and in what shape? (**Chapter 14’s** *ṛtu* — as the **independent** letter ಋ, word-initially.) Is *hr̥daya*’s match with English *heart* an accident, like *iṣṭa* and *ask*? (**No** — Sanskrit and English are both **Indo-European**; this is real shared ancestry.) Name two other English words from the same root. (**Cardiac**, from Greek; **courage** or **cordial**, from Latin.)

Chapter 39

Tea, Coffee, Milk

Modes: ⇄ voice (2) 👁 eyes (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 3 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can politely ask for tea, coffee or milk in Kannada, and trace each word along the road it travelled to get here.

Ask ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು ಚಹಾ, ಕಾಫಿ or ಹಾಲು, follow chā through Persian and kāphi through five languages, then explain hālu — the word Chapter 32 already recited unglossed as proof of the $p \rightarrow h$ law.

39.1 ಚಹಾ (cahā) — “tea,” which walked to Kannada rather than sailed

Seven body words done. Now the drink you would politely ask for first, in any Karnataka home.

You’ll want to know: ಚಹಾ

ಚಹಾ — cahā — tea

ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು ಚಹಾ. — dayaviṭṭu cahā. — “Tea, please.”

Dayaviṭṭu has been yours since Chapter 8.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಚಹಾ goes back to Northern Chinese **chá**, carried overland along Central Asian trade routes into Persian چای (*chāy*), and from Persian into Kannada and most of North and South India alike. That is the

very same road — Chinese into Persian, Persian into Kannada — that Chapter 20’s ಹವಾಮಾನ took for its own first half, *hava*.
Tea that instead reached Europe by **sea** kept a different Chinese form, from the southern coast, which is why English says **tea** and French says *thé* — one word, two roads, “chai” by land and “tea” by sea.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “dayaviṭṭu cahā” — tea, please
- the road — “chá ... chāy ... cahā”
- two Persian loans — “hava ... cahā”
- land against sea — “chai ... tea”

Before you move on

Say “tea, please.” (*Dayaviṭṭu cahā*.) Name the three languages *cahā* passed through, in order. (**Chinese**, then **Persian**, then **Kannada**.) Which earlier Kannada word took the same Persian road? (ಹವಾಮಾನ, weather.) Why does English say “tea” instead of “chai”? (**It arrived by sea**, carrying a different Chinese form.)

39.2 ಕಾಫಿ (kāphi) — “coffee,” the longest chain of loans in this book

Cahā crossed two languages to reach Kannada. This drink crossed four.

You’ll want to know: ಕಾಫಿ

ಕಾಫಿ — *kāphi* — coffee

ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು ಕಾಫಿ. — *dayaviṭṭu kāphi*. — “Coffee, please.”

The letters in this word

(Skip this if you already read Kannada.) ಫ (pha) is new: ಪ (pa) with an aspirated puff of breath added, the same relationship ಕ/ಖ and ತ/ಥ already carry. You met plain ಪ back in Chapter 20's ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು (*ippattu*, “twenty”) — one of the rare places a native word still opens with *p*, since most word-initial *p*'s became *h*. ಫ never went through that law at all: it shows up almost only in borrowed words like this one, holding the foreign sound steady.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಕಾಫಿ traces to Arabic قهوة (*qahwa*), into Ottoman Turkish **kahve**, into Dutch **koffie**, into English **coffee**, into Kannada **kāphi** — five languages deep, the longest chain of loans in this book, longer even than *cahā*'s three-language road through China and Persia. South India's filter-coffee tradition is comparatively recent, arriving through colonial-era sea trade — the newer drink, on the older-sounding name.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “dayaviṭṭu kāphi” — coffee, please
- plain and aspirated — “pa ... pha”
- the chain — “qahwa ... kahve ... koffie ... coffee ... kāphi”
- two drinks, two roads — “cahā, three languages ... kāphi, five”

Before you move on

Say “coffee, please.” (*Dayaviṭṭu kāphi*.) Where did you meet plain ಪ before, and what makes ಫ different? (**Chapter 20's** *ippattu*; ಫ adds a puff of breath and shows up mostly in loanwords.) Name the chain of languages *kāphi* passed through. (**Arabic, Turkish, Dutch, English, Kannada** — five deep.) Which drink's name travelled further, *cahā*'s or *kāphi*'s? (***Kāphi***'s — five languages against three.)

39.3 ಹಾಲು (hālu) — “milk,” a word you’ve already recited without knowing it

Two borrowed drinks in a row. This one is native — and it has been sitting inside a sentence you already said, back in Chapter 32, without anyone telling you what it meant.

You’ll want to know: ಹಾಲು

ಹಾಲು — *hālu* — milk

ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು ಹಾಲು. — *dayaviṭṭu hālu*. — “Milk, please.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹಾಲು continues Old Kannada *pālu*, from Proto-South-Dravidian **pāl*, “milk.” Tamil keeps the *p* untouched: பால் (*pāl*).

Chapter 32 already gave you this exact pair. Teaching *hōgu*, it listed four proofs of the *p* → *h* law and asked you to say all four aloud:

pōgu ... hōgu, pattu ... hattu, pāl ... hālu, peyar ... hesaru

You have said *pāl ... hālu* before. Nobody told you then that it meant “milk” — exactly the gap Chapter 37 found with *bāyi*.

Hālu is not only a drink on its own: turmeric stirred into warm milk, ಅರಿಶಿನ ಹಾಲು (*ariśina hālu*), is an everyday Karnataka drink, its color Chapter 22’s other word, ಹಳದಿ.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “dayaviṭṭu hālu” — milk, please
- Chapter 32’s four pairs again — “pōgu, hōgu ... pattu, hattu ... pāl, hālu ... peyar, hesaru”
- turmeric milk, and its color — “ariśina hālu ... haḷadi”
- three drinks now — “cahā, kāphi, hālu”

Before you move on

Say “milk, please.” (*Dayaviṭṭu hālu.*) Where did you already say *pāl* ... *hālu*, before knowing what it meant? (**Chapter 32’s** *hōgu* lesson, reciting the four *p* → *h* pairs.) Name all four pairs. (*Pōgu/ hōgu*, *pattu/hattu*, *pāl/hālu*, *peyar/hesaru*.) What is *ariśina hālu*, and which earlier chapter’s color names it? (**Turmeric milk** — Chapter 22’s ಹಳದಿ, yellow.)

Chapter 40

A Meal

Modes: 👁 eyes (1) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 1 lesson.

By the end of this chapter: I can say I am having a meal in Kannada, using the word Chapter 32 used once and never explained, and place it at the hour of two greetings I already know.

Say ಊಟ ಮಾಡು, explain *ūṭa* against everyday *tinnu*, read the independent vowel ಊ, and place the word at the hour of ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ and before ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ.

40.1 ಊಟ (ūṭa) — “a meal,” the word that closes this chapter’s table

Chapter 32 taught you *tinnu*, “to eat,” and then, in a single line, reached for a different word for a **full** meal — without ever teaching that word. Fourteen chapters later, here it is.

You’ll want to know: ಊಟ

ಊಟ — *ūṭa* — a meal

ಊಟ ಮಾಡು. — *ūṭa māḍu*. — “to have a meal” (literally, “meal-do”)

The letters in this word

(Skip this if you already read Kannada.) ಊ is the **independent** long-*ū* vowel — the shape a word uses when it *opens* with this sound, the way ಮು

opened *ṛtu* back in Chapter 14. Every other long-*ū* you have read so far rode on a consonant as the small sign ು; here, with no consonant in front of it to carry, the vowel stands alone in its full independent form.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಊಟ is native Dravidian, a root Tulu keeps as its own everyday word for food, *ūṭa*. Chapter 32 used the phrase ಊಟ ಮಾಡು to mark a **full** meal, set against everyday ತಿನ್ನು — the same verb Tamil narrowed down to chewing and snacking — but the book left *ūṭa* itself unexplained until today.

A meal keeps close company with greetings you already own. ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ is wished at the very hour of the midday *ūṭa*; ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ is wished once the evening one is over. Two greetings that name the hour; one word for what fills it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ūṭa māḍu” — to have a meal
- everyday against full — “tinnuttēne ... ūṭa māḍu”
- the hour and the meal — “śubha madhyāhna ... ūṭa”
- the meal and the goodnight after it — “ūṭa ... śubha rātri”
- this chapter’s three drinks, once more — “cahā, kāphi, hālu”

Before you move on

Say “to have a meal.” (*Ūṭa māḍu*.) Which chapter used that exact phrase already, without explaining *ūṭa*? (**Chapter 32’s** *tinnu* lesson.) How does *ūṭa* differ from *tinnu*? (*Tinnu* is **everyday eating**; *ūṭa* is a **full meal**.) Name the two greetings that keep company with mealtimes, and which meal each marks. (ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ, the midday meal; ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ, after the evening one.)

Chapter 41

Pointing, and Asking

Modes: ⇆ voice (7) ⇆ Hands-free start: all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can point at something in Kannada and ask who or where it is — and I can say what the six words have in common.

Say the near word, the far word and the question word in a row, and name the part that changed.

41.1 ಇದು (idu) — this one — the thing near me

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You’ll want to know: ಇದು

ಇದು — *idu* — this one — the thing near me.

Say it, and point while you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever your finger is on.

Its partner is ಅದು *adu*, which you will meet in a moment. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **i-** for near — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ಇದು” three times, pointing at something different each time

- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *idu*? (this one — the thing near me.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**i-** — near.)

41.2 ಅದು (adu) — that one — the thing over there

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: ಅದು

ಅದು — *adu* — that one — the thing over there.

Say it, and point while you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever your finger is on.

Its partner is ಇದು *idu*, which you will meet just now. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **a-** for far — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ಅದು” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *adu*? (that one — the thing over there.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**a-** — far.)

41.3 ಇಲ್ಲಿ (illi) — here — where I am

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: ಇಲ್ಲಿ

ಇಲ್ಲಿ — *illi* — here — where I am.

Say it, and point while you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever your finger is on.

Its partner is ಅಲ್ಲಿ *alli*, which you will meet in a moment. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **i-** for near — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ಇಲ್ಲಿ” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *illi*? (here — where I am.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**i-** — near.)

41.4 ಅಲ್ಲಿ (alli) — there — where I am not

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: ಅಲ್ಲಿ

ಅಲ್ಲಿ — *alli* — there — where I am not.

Say it, and point while you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever your finger is on.

Its partner is ಇಲ್ಲಿ *illi*, which you will meet just now. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **a-** for far — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ಅಲ್ಲಿ” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *alli*? (there — where I am not.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**a-** — far.)

41.5 ಯಾರು (yāru) — who? — asking about a person

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: ಯಾರು

ಯಾರು — *yāru* — who? — asking about a person.

Say it, and point while you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever your finger is on.

Its partner is ಎಲ್ಲಿ *elli*, which you will meet in a moment. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **e-** for ask — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ಯಾರು” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *yāru*? (who? — asking about a person.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**e-** — ask.)

41.6 ಎಲ್ಲಿ (elli) — where? — asking about a place

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: ಎಲ್ಲಿ

ಎಲ್ಲಿ — *elli* — where? — asking about a place.

Say it, and point while you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever your finger is on.

Its partner is ಯಾರು *yāru*, which you will meet just now. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **e-** for ask — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ಎಲ್ಲಿ” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *elli*? (where? — asking about a place.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**e-** — ask.)

41.7 i- / a- / e- — six words, one machine

Say the six words from this chapter out loud, in order. Listen to how they begin.

Grammar lens: one slot changes

You did not learn six words. You learned **three beginnings** and reused them.

meaning	word
near	ಇಲ್ಲಿ <i>illi</i>
far	ಅಲ್ಲಿ <i>alli</i>
question	ಎಲ್ಲಿ <i>elli</i>

Kannada's place words are the shortest of the four: ಇಲ್ಲಿ, ಅಲ್ಲಿ, ಎಲ್ಲಿ. Change the front, and the meaning walks from **near** to **far** to **a question**. Nothing else in the word moves.

The same three beginnings run the thing-words too: ಇದು *idu* and ಅದು *adu* start exactly like the first two rows. This chapter did not teach you the matching question word for things — that one arrives later, and when it does you will already know what it has to start with. This is worth more than the six words are. When you meet a new word in this family later, you will not have to be taught all three of it — you will be taught one and work out the others.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the near word, then the far word, then the question word
- *Say it:* them again for place, not for things
- *Notice:* the part that did NOT change

Before you move on

Which beginning means near? (**i-**) Far? (**a-**) And which one turns the word into a question? (**e-**)

Chapter 42

Describing Things

Modes: ⇆ voice (6) ⇆ Hands-free start: all 6 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can point at something in Kannada and ask who or where it is — and I can say what the six words have in common.

Say the near word, the far word and the question word in a row, and name the part that changed.

42.1 ದೊಡ್ಡ (doḍḍa) — big

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: ದೊಡ್ಡ

ದೊಡ್ಡ — *doḍḍa* — big.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ದೊಡ್ಡ” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *doḍḍa*? (**big.**) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

42.2 ಚಿಕ್ಕ (cikka) — small

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: ಚಿಕ್ಕ

ಚಿಕ್ಕ — *cikka* — small.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met ದೊಡ್ಡ *doḍḍa* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ಚಿಕ್ಕ” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *cikka*? (**small.**) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

42.3 ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ (olleya) — good

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ

ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ — *olleya* — good.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met ಚಿಕ್ಕ *cikka* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *olleya*? (**good.**) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

42.4 ಹೊಸ (hosa) — new

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: ಹೊಸ

ಹೊಸ — *hosa* — new.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ *olleya* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ಹೊಸ” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *hosa*? (**new.**) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

42.5 ಹಳೆಯ (haḷeya) — old — of a thing, not of a person

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You’ll want to know: ಹಳೆಯ

ಹಳೆಯ — *haḷeya* — old — of a thing, not of a person.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met ಹೊಸ *hosa* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ಹಳೆಯ” three times, pointing at something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *haḷeya*? (**old — of a thing, not of a person.**) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

42.6 before the noun, unchanged — five words, one rule

Say the five words from this chapter out loud, then say each one in front of a noun you already know.

Grammar lens: where an adjective goes

You did not learn five separate words. You learned **where an adjective goes**, and five words that go there.

meaning	word
big	ದೊಡ್ಡ <i>doḍḍa</i>
small	ಚಿಕ್ಕ <i>chikka</i>
good	ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ <i>olḷeya</i>

They sit in front of the noun and stay exactly as they are.
This is worth more than the five words are. Every noun you already know — your name, the house, the water, the day — can now take any of them in front, and every adjective you meet from here goes in the same place.

Your turn

- *Say it:* each of the five in front of a noun you already know
- *Say it:* two of them with the same noun, one after the other
- *Notice:* whether the adjective changed shape when the noun did

Before you move on

Where does an adjective go in this language? (**In front of the noun.**) Does it change shape to match the noun? (unchanged.)

Chapter 43

More Everyday Verbs

Modes: 🗣️ voice (4) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can tell someone to come, sit, stand and give in Kannada.

Complete KA-C43-give and say all four verbs in order.

43.1 ಬಾ (bā) — come

A short run of everyday verbs, one at a time.

You'll want to know: ಬಾ

ಬಾ (bā) — “come”.

One syllable, and a whole sentence. The commonest thing said at a doorway.

What you've built

One more everyday action. Three more follow, and each reuses the ones before it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- bā
- it again, to someone standing in a doorway

Before you move on

What does ಬಾ mean? (“come”.) Say it once more.

43.2 ಕುಳಿತುಕೋ (kūlitukō) — sit

Before the new one: what did *bā* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಕುಳಿತುಕೋ

ಕುಳಿತುಕೋ (*kūlitukō*) — “sit”.

Longer than it looks: the *-ko* on the end is a reflexive, so it is closer to ‘seat yourself’ than to a bare order.

What you’ve built

One more everyday action. Three more follow, and each reuses the ones before it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kūlitukō*
- it again, to someone standing in a doorway
- it after *bā*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does ಕುಳಿತುಕೋ mean? (“sit”.) Say it once more.

43.3 ನಿಲ್ಲು (nillu) — stand

Before the new one: what did *kūlitukō* mean?

You'll want to know: ನಿಲ್ಲು

ನಿಲ್ಲು (*nillu*) — “stand”.

The pair to sitting, and the bare stem again — Kannada asks for nothing extra to make a command.

What you've built

One more everyday action. Three more follow, and each reuses the ones before it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nillu*
- it again, to someone standing in a doorway
- it after *kulitukō*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does ನಿಲ್ಲು mean? (“stand”.) Say it once more.

43.4 ಕೊಡು (koḍu) — give

Before the new one: what did *nillu* mean?

You'll want to know: ಕೊಡು

ಕೊಡು (*koḍu*) — “give”.

The everyday ‘give’. Politeness is added with a separate word, not by altering this one.

What you've built

One more everyday action. That closes the run: four everyday actions, each met on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *koḍu*
- it again, to someone standing in a doorway
- it after *nillu*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does ಕೊಡು mean? (“give”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 44

Verbs of Seeing and Saying

Modes: 🗣️ voice (4) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can tell someone to look, listen, speak and write in Kannada.

Complete KA-C44-write and say all four verbs in order.

44.1 ನೋಡು (nōḍu) — look

Four verbs for taking things in and putting them out, one at a time.

You'll want to know: ನೋಡು

ನೋಡು (nōḍu) — “look”.

Also 'to see' and, in the right sentence, 'to look after'. One stem covering watching, seeing and caring for is common across the Dravidian languages.

What you've built

One more. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- nōḍu
- it once more, slowly

Before you move on

What does ನೋಡು mean? (“look”.) Say it once more.

44.2 ಕೇಳು (kēḷu) — listen

Before the new one: what did *nōḍu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಕೇಳು

ಕೇಳು (*kēḷu*) — “listen”.

And ‘to ask’. Kannada uses the same stem for taking in words and for requesting them, which is less strange than it sounds — both are aimed at what someone else knows.

What you’ve built

One more. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kēḷu*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *nōḍu*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does ಕೇಳು mean? (“listen”.) Say it once more.

44.3 ಮಾತಾಡು (mātāḍu) — speak

Before the new one: what did *kēḷu* mean?

You'll want to know: ಮಾತಾಡು

ಮಾತಾಡು (*mātāḍu*) — “speak”.

Built from *māta*, ‘word’ — itself from Sanskrit — plus *āḍu*, ‘to play’. To speak is to play with words.

What you've built

One more. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mātāḍu*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *kēḷu*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does ಮಾತಾಡು mean? (“speak”). Say it once more.

44.4 ಬರೆಯಿ (bare) — write

Before the new one: what did *mātāḍu* mean?

You'll want to know: ಬರೆಯಿ

ಬರೆಯಿ (*bare*) — “write”.

An old Dravidian stem, unrelated to the Sanskrit words for writing. It is the same root behind *baraha*, ‘writing’.

What you've built

That closes the run: look, listen, speak, write.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bare*

- it once more, slowly
- it after *mātāḍu*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does བཅོ་ mean? (“write”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 45

The Older Generation

Modes: 🗣️ voice (4) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name four more family and people words in this language.

Complete KA-C45-wife and say all four words in order.

45.1 அಜ்ஜ (ajja) — grandfather

Before the new one: what did *bare* mean?

You'll want to know: அஜ்ஜ

அஜ்ஜ (*ajja*) — “grandfather”.

A native Dravidian word of the short, doubled shape that small children’s mouths reach for first, and it carries respect well past the family: an unrelated old man can be *ajja* too. The *-a* closing it is the masculine ending.

What you’ve built

The first of four words for the generation above you and the one beside you. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ajja*

- it once more, slowly
- it after *bare*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does ಅಜ್ಜ mean? (“grandfather”.) Say it once more.

45.2 ಅಜ್ಜಿ (ajji) — grandmother

Before the new one: what did *ajja* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಅಜ್ಜಿ

ಅಜ್ಜಿ (*ajji*) — “grandmother”.

The same stem as the last word, with the ending swapped: *-i* where *ajja* had *-a*. The son-and-daughter pair built ಮಗಳು out of ಮಗ by that same trick, one stem carrying two endings, and this pair is tidier still — only the final vowel moves.

What you’ve built

Two of the four, and a pattern you have now seen twice in this book.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ajji*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *ajja*, and hear only the last vowel move

Before you move on

What does ಅಜ್ಜಿ mean? (“grandmother”.) Say it once more.

45.3 ಗಂಡ (gaṇḍa) — husband

Before the new one: what did *ajji* mean?

You'll want to know: ಗಂಡ

ಗಂಡ (*gaṇḍa*) — “husband”.

The everyday word, and a native one. Its own stem also gives ಗಂಡು (*gaṇḍu*), ‘male’, so what it names is a man of the house rather than anything about the wedding. Formal Kannada keeps the Sanskrit *pati* alongside it for writing and ceremony.

What you've built

Three of the four. The last one is built the same way, from the other half of the pair.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *gaṇḍa*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *ajji*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does ಗಂಡ mean? (“husband”.) Say it once more.

45.4 ಹೆಂಡತಿ (*heṇḍati*) — wife

Before the new one: what did *gaṇḍa* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹೆಂಡತಿ

ಹೆಂಡತಿ (*heṇḍati*) — “wife”.

Built on ಹೆಣ್ಣು (*heṇṇu*), ‘female’, with a *-ti* ending. And *heṇṇu* carries the sound change you already met in ಹೋಗು: where its sisters keep an old *p*-, Kannada has *h*-. So Tamil *peṇ*, ‘woman’, and this *heṇ*- are one word wearing two faces.

What you've built

That closes the run: grandfather, grandmother, husband, wife.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *heṇḍati*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *gaṇḍa*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does ಹೆಂಡತಿ mean? (“wife”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 46

Things You Ask For

Modes: ⇄ voice (4) 👁 eyes (1) ⇄ Hands-free start: first 4 of 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five everyday things I might ask someone for in Kannada, and say which of them Kannada has always had and which arrived from elsewhere.

Complete KA-C46-book and say all five words in order.

46.1 ಹಣ್ಣು (haṇṇu) — a fruit

Before the new run of words: what did *heṇḍati* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹಣ್ಣು

ಹಣ್ಣು (*haṇṇu*) — “a fruit”.

Behind it there is a verb: ಹಣ್ಣಾಗು, to ripen. The fruit is named for what happened to it — the ripened thing — and Kannada saw no need to invent a second noun for the object itself.

Proto-Dravidian ***pāl**, ‘to ripen, to grow old’, is the source, and the sound law this book keeps returning to is at work in the very first letter. Tamil kept பழம் (*palam*); Telugu has పండు (*paṇḍu*); Kannada turned that *p-* into *h-* and arrived at ಹಣ್ಣು. It is the same law that made milk ಹಾಲು here and left it *pāl* next door.

What you’ve built

The first of five things you might ask someone for.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *haṇṇu*
- it once more, slowly
- *haṇṇu*, then *dayaviṭṭu haṇṇu koḍi* — “please give a fruit”

Before you move on

What does ಹಣ್ಣು mean? (“a fruit”.) Say it once more.

46.2 ಬಟ್ಟೆ (baṭṭe) — cloth

Before the new one: what did *haṇṇu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಬಟ್ಟೆ

ಬಟ್ಟೆ (*baṭṭe*) — “cloth”.

ಬಟ್ಟೆ is the plain word for cloth: the bolt on the shelf, the washing on the line, the rag in your hand.

Sanskrit has *paṭṭa*, ‘a strip of cloth, a bandage’, and here the borrowing most likely ran the unusual way — out of Dravidian and into Sanskrit, rather than the direction this book has shown so often. The same strip reached English by another road: Hindi *paṭṭī*, a wrapping, is the soldier’s *puttee*.

Older Kannada also used ಬಟ್ಟೆ for a road — the way you go — a sense the modern language has quietly let go of.

What you’ve built

Two: a fruit and a cloth.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *baṭṭe*
- it once more, slowly
- *haṇṇu*, then *baṭṭe*, and ask for each one with *dayaviṭṭu*

Before you move on

What does ಬಟ್ಟೆ mean? (“cloth”.) Say it once more.

46.3 ದೀಪ (dīpa) — a lamp

Before the new one: what did *batṭe* mean?

You’ll want to know: ದೀಪ

ದೀಪ (*dīpa*) — “a lamp”.

Sanskrit *dīpa*, from a root meaning to blaze, to shine. Kannada took it whole and wore not one letter off it.

Put it beside *āvali*, ‘a row’, and you have *Dīpāvali* — a row of lamps — a festival whose name explains itself the moment the seam is visible.

Kannada has a word of its own as well, ಹಣತೆ (*haṇate*), and it means something narrower: the small clay saucer with a wick lying in it. The borrowed word covers every lamp; the native one names a particular thing you can hold in one hand.

What you’ve built

Three, and one of them came from Sanskrit.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *dīpa*
- it once more, slowly
- all three so far, and say which of them a potter makes

Before you move on

What does ದೀಪ mean? (“a lamp”.) Say it once more.

46.4 ಉಪ್ಪು (uppu) — salt

Before the new one: what did *dīpa* mean?

You'll want to know: ಉಪ್ಪು

ಉಪ್ಪು (*uppu*) — “salt”.

Proto-Dravidian ***uppu**, and the whole family kept it very nearly untouched: Tamil உப்பு, Telugu ఉప్పు, Malayalam ഉപ്പ്.

There is a *p* sitting in the middle of this word, and it did not become *h*. That is worth stopping over, because the law that made ಹಣ್ಣು out of an older *p*-word only ever reached the FIRST sound of a word. Inside one, the *p* stays where it was put.

What you've built

Four. Salt, and the fruit, and the cloth, and the lamp.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *uppu*
- it once more, slowly
- *uppu*, then *hanṇu*, and hear the *p* survive in one and vanish from the other

Before you move on

What does ಉಪ್ಪು mean? (“salt”.) Say it once more.

46.5 ಪುಸ್ತಕ (pustaka) — a book

Before the new one: what did *uppu* mean?

You'll want to know: ಪುಸ್ತಕ

ಪುಸ್ತಕ (*pustaka*) — “a book”.

Sanskrit *pustaka* is the source, but the trail behind it leaves India altogether. Middle Persian *post* meant ‘hide, skin’ — the thing written on before there was paper.

Now look at its first letter. ಪುಸ್ತಕ opens with *p*-, and that *p*- stayed. So did the *p*- of every other word Kannada took in from Sanskrit. The law that

turned inherited *p*- into *h*- had finished its work before these words walked in, and it left them alone.

Two of these five came from outside; three were here already.

What you've built

Five things you might ask for: a fruit, a cloth, a lamp, salt, a book.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *pustaka*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then sort them into the inherited and the borrowed

Before you move on

What does ಪುಸ್ತಕ mean? (“a book”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 47

The Leg and the Tooth

Modes: ⇐ voice (4) ◉ eyes (1) ⇐ Hands-free start: first 2 of 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five more parts of the body in Kannada, and point to the two regular sound exchanges that separate them from their Tamil and Telugu cousins.

Complete KA-C47-stomach and say all five words in order.

47.1 ಕಾಲು (kālu) — leg, foot

Before the new run: what did *pustaka* mean, and what did *uppu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಕಾಲು

ಕಾಲು (*kālu*) — “leg, foot”.

Proto-Dravidian **kāl*, and every sister kept it nearly whole: Tamil ಕால், Telugu కాలు, Malayalam കാൽ.

Set that beside ಕೈ, the hand-word, which wore down so far that the family resemblance is hard to see at all. Two body words of the same age; one held its shape and one did not, and nothing about the meaning predicts which.

ಕಾಲು covers the whole limb, foot and leg together. It also names a quarter — a fourth of anything — so ಕಾಲು ಗಂಟೆ is a quarter of an hour. Nothing joins the leg to the fraction but an accident of sound, and context is the only fix, which is what context is for.

What you've built

The first of five more body words.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kālu*
- it once more, slowly
- *kālu*, then *tale*, so the top and the bottom sit together

Before you move on

What does ಕಾಲು mean? (“leg, foot”.) Say it once more.

47.2 ಹಲ್ಲು (hallu) — a tooth

Before the new one: what did *kālu* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹಲ್ಲು

ಹಲ್ಲು (*hallu*) — “a tooth”.

Proto-Dravidian ***pal**. Tamil kept பல்; Telugu took a third road and came out with పన్ను; Kannada applied its own law and got ಹಲ್ಲು, the *p*-turned to *h*- exactly where the chapter before said to watch for it.

That makes ಹಣ್ಣು and ಹಲ್ಲು a matched pair: two inherited words, one *h* apiece, and a *p* at the front of both a thousand years ago.

What you've built

Two: a leg and a tooth.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hallu*
- it once more, slowly
- *kālu*, then *hallu*, and say which of the two also names a fraction

Before you move on

What does ಹಲ್ಲ mean? (“a tooth”.) Say it once more.

47.3 ಕೂದಲು (kūdalu) — hair

Before the new one: what did *hallu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಕೂದಲು

ಕೂದಲು (*kūdalu*) — “hair”.

ಕೂದಲು is the hair on a head, counted as a mass rather than strand by strand. Tamil’s கூந்தல் (*kūntal*) is the same inherited word.

Look at what it finishes on. ಕಾಲು, ಹಲ್ಲ, ಕಣ್ಣು and ಹಣ್ಣು all end on a small *-u* as well. Kannada dislikes leaving a word standing on a bare consonant and sets a light vowel behind it — a prop, carrying no meaning of its own. Tamil tolerates the bare consonant and writes பல் and ಕால் with nothing after them at all.

Careful Kannada also has ಕೇಶ (*kēśa*), straight from Sanskrit, for the barber’s signboard and the poem.

What you’ve built

Three: a leg, a tooth, and hair.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kūdalu*
- it once more, slowly
- all three, and listen for the little *-u* at the end of each

Before you move on

What does ಕೂದಲು mean? (“hair”.) Say it once more.

47.4 ಬೆರಳು (beraḷu) — a finger

Before the new one: what did *kūḍalu* mean?

You'll want to know: ಬೆರಳು

ಬೆರಳು (*beraḷu*) — “a finger”.

Tamil has **ವಿರಳ** (*virāḷ*), Malayalam **വിരൽ**, Telugu **వేలు** (*vēlu*) — and Kannada opens the word with *b*- where its sisters have *v*-.

That is the second regular exchange this book has shown you, the one already visible in **ಬರೆ**, ‘to write’, where the sisters again have a *v*. One family, two swaps: *p*- for *h*-, *v*- for *b*-. Between them they account for a great many words that look unrelated at first glance and are nothing of the kind.

What you've built

Four. A leg, a tooth, hair, a finger.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *beraḷu*
- it once more, slowly
- *beraḷu*, then *bare*, and hear the same *b* at the front of both

Before you move on

What does **ಬೆರಳು** mean? (“a finger”.) Say it once more.

47.5 ಹೊಟ್ಟೆ (hoṭṭe) — the stomach, the belly

Before the new one: what did *beraḷu* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹೊಟ್ಟೆ

ಹೊಟ್ಟೆ (*hoṭṭe*) — “the stomach, the belly”.

Telugu has **ಪొಟ್ಟ** (*poṭṭa*) for the same thing, the *p* being the older shape and Kannada's *h* the newer one. Tamil went its own way here and reaches

for **ವಯಿರು** (*vayiru*), a word from another root entirely — a reminder that the sisters agree often, not invariably.

Five body words, and three of them — **ಹಲ್ಲು**, **ಹೊಟ್ಟೆ**, and the fruit from the chapter before — carry the same *h* into the same first slot.

What you've built

Five more body words: a leg, a tooth, hair, a finger, the belly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hoṭṭe*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then the three that begin with *h*

Before you move on

What does **ಹೊಟ್ಟೆ** mean? (“the stomach, the belly”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 48

Naming Who Someone Is

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say what someone’s role is in Kannada — teacher, student, doctor, farmer, guest — and name the root that two of those words share.

Complete KA-C48-guest and say all five words in order.

48.1 ಶಿಕ್ಷಕ (śikṣaka) — a teacher

Before the new run: what did *hoṭṭe* mean, and what did *beraḷu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಶಿಕ್ಷಕ

ಶಿಕ್ಷಕ (*śikṣaka*) — “a teacher”.

Sanskrit *śikṣaka*, ‘one who teaches’, on a root that covers learning and training alike; the same root gives ಶಿಕ್ಷಣ (*śikṣaṇa*), education.

The formal word is not what a Kannada child shouts across a classroom. That is ಮೇಷ್ಟ್ರು (*mēṣṭru*), which is the English *master* worn smooth by a century of Kannada mouths — a schoolroom loan that arrived with the schoolroom.

What you’ve built

The first of five ways to say who someone is.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *śikṣaka*
- it once more, slowly
- *śikṣaka*, then ask *nimma hesaru ēnu?* as though meeting one

Before you move on

What does ಶಿಕ್ಷಕ mean? (“a teacher”.) Say it once more.

48.2 ವಿದ್ಯಾರ್ಥಿ (vidyārthi) — a student

Before the new one: what did *śikṣaka* mean?

You’ll want to know: ವಿದ್ಯಾರ್ಥಿ

ವಿದ್ಯಾರ್ಥಿ (*vidyārthi*) — “a student”.

Two Sanskrit pieces: *vidyā*, knowledge, and *arthin*, one who seeks a thing. A student is a knowledge-seeker, said straight out.

vidyā rests on a root meaning ‘to know’, and that root is among the oldest things in this book. It is the *wit* of English, the *vidēre* of Latin, and the first syllable of *vision*. A word for a schoolchild in Bengaluru and a word for eyesight in Rome are one word with three thousand years between them.

What you’ve built

Two: a teacher and a student.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *vidyārthi*
- it once more, slowly
- *śikṣaka*, then *vidyārthi*, and say which of the two is doing the seeking

Before you move on

What does ವಿದ್ಯಾರ್ಥಿ mean? (“a student”.) Say it once more.

48.3 ವೈದ್ಯ (vaidya) — a doctor

Before the new one: what did *vidyārthi* mean?

You’ll want to know: ವೈದ್ಯ

ವೈದ್ಯ (*vaidya*) — “a doctor”.

Here is the seeker’s root a second time. *vaidya* is built directly on *vidyā*: ‘one versed in the knowledge’. Which knowledge is left unsaid, because for the people who coined the word there was only one worth naming that way — the knowledge of medicine.

So the student and the doctor are the same word twice over, once for the one still looking and once for the one who has found. ವೈದ್ಯ carries the older physician of the herb-books with it; the doctor at the clinic is more often ಡಾಕ್ಟರ್.

What you’ve built

Three, and two of the three are the same root wearing different clothes.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *vaidya*
- it once more, slowly
- *vidyārthi*, then *vaidya*, and hear *vid-* survive in both

Before you move on

What does ವೈದ್ಯ mean? (“a doctor”.) Say it once more.

48.4 ರೈತ (raita) — a farmer

Before the new one: what did *vaidya* mean?

You'll want to know: ರೈತ

ರೈತ (*raita*) — “a farmer”.

ರೈತ came the long way round. Arabic *ra'īyat*, ‘the flock, the governed people’, travelled through Persian into the administrative language of the Deccan and came out the other side as the word for the man who works the land and pays the revenue on it. English took the same word from the same offices and spelled it *ryot*.

Kannada has an older and homelier word beside it — ಒಕ್ಕಲಿಗ (*okkaliga*), from *okkalu*, a household that farms — but ರೈತ is what a newspaper prints.

What you've built

Four. A teacher, a student, a doctor, a farmer.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *raita*
- it once more, slowly
- all four, and say which one did not come from Sanskrit

Before you move on

What does ರೈತ mean? (“a farmer”.) Say it once more.

48.5 ಅತಿಥಿ (atithi) — a guest

Before the new one: what did *raita* mean?

You'll want to know: ಅತಿಥಿ

ಅತಿಥಿ (*atithi*) — “a guest”.

Sanskrit *atithi*, and the traditional reading of it is *a-tithi*: ‘one without a date’. A guest, on that reading, is exactly the person who sent no word ahead — who arrives on no appointed day and must be fed regardless. The old formula *atithi devo bhava*, ‘let the guest be as a god to you’, is built on that idea and has outlived the grammar that produced it.

Five ways to say who someone is. Four came from Sanskrit, one from Arabic by way of Persian, and two of the four Sanskrit ones are the same root twice.

What you've built

Five roles: a teacher, a student, a doctor, a farmer, a guest.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *atithi*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then name the two that share a root

Before you move on

What does **ಅತಿಥಿ** mean? (“a guest”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 49

Answering With More Than Yes

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can answer in Kannada with more than yes and no — true, enough, certainly, perhaps, just so — and see the three-vowel grid running under ಇದು, ಅದು and ಹೇಗೆ.

Complete KA-C49-just-so and say all five words in order.

49.1 ನಿಜ (nija) — true

Before the new run: what did *atithi* mean, and what did *raita* mean?

You'll want to know: ನಿಜ

ನಿಜ (*nija*) — “true”.

Sanskrit *nija* began as ‘one’s own, innate, born in’ — what belongs to a thing by nature rather than by accident.

Kannada and Telugu both took that and turned it toward truth, and you can watch the turn happen inside the word: what is true of a thing is what the thing is in itself, as against what is merely said about it. Said alone, ನಿಜ does the work of a whole sentence — ‘true’, ‘that’s right’.

What you’ve built

The first of five replies that do more than agree or refuse.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nija*
- it once more, slowly
- *nija*, then *haudu*, and hear how much more the first one claims

Before you move on

What does ನಿಜ mean? (“true”.) Say it once more.

49.2 ಸಾಕು (sāku) — enough

Before the new one: what did *nija* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಸಾಕು

ಸಾಕು (*sāku*) — “enough”.

ಸಾಕು is a complete sentence with one word in it. Held up over a plate while someone is ladling rice, it means ‘that’s enough’ and stops the ladle.

No Sanskrit anywhere in it — ಸಾಕು is Kannada’s own, resting on an inherited verb for sufficing. It covers a whole English shelf on its own: enough, plenty, stop, that will do. Kannada is content to let the situation and the tone sort out which.

What you’ve built

Two: true, and enough.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *sāku*
- it once more, slowly
- *sāku* over an imaginary plate, then *nija* to something just said

Before you move on

What does ಸಾಕು mean? (“enough”.) Say it once more.

49.3 ಖಂಡಿತ (khaṇḍita) — certainly

Before the new one: what did *sāku* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಖಂಡಿತ

ಖಂಡಿತ (*khaṇḍita*) — “certainly”.

Sanskrit *khaṇḍita* means ‘broken, cut off’ — a piece severed from the rest.

The road from there to ‘certainly’ is worth walking. A matter that has been cut is a matter that has been settled: nothing left hanging, no remainder to argue over. English does the very same thing with *decide*, which is Latin for cutting off, and with a *clear-cut* answer. Two languages, no contact between them, one metaphor.

What you’ve built

Three: true, enough, certainly.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *khaṇḍita*
- it once more, slowly
- *khaṇḍita* as an answer to an invitation, then *nija* as an answer to a claim

Before you move on

What does ಖಂಡಿತ mean? (“certainly”.) Say it once more.

49.4 ಬಹುಶಃ (bahuśaḥ) — perhaps

Before the new one: what did *khaṇḍita* mean?

You'll want to know: ಬಹುಶಃ

ಬಹುಶಃ (*bahuśaḥ*) — “perhaps”.

Sanskrit *bahuśas*, ‘in many ways, in many instances’, from *bahu*, ‘much, many’. If a thing can fall out in many ways then no one of them is settled, and the word slid quietly from ‘in many ways’ to ‘probably, perhaps’. It is the exact opposite journey to the one ಖಂಡಿತ took.

Notice the last mark: ಃ, the *visarga*, a light breath let out at the end of a word. It is uncommon in everyday Kannada, and this is one of the few ordinary words that carries it.

What you've built

Four, and the fourth one takes back what the third one promised.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bahuśaḥ*
- it once more, slowly
- *khaṇḍita*, then *bahuśaḥ*, and hear the certainty drain out

Before you move on

What does ಬಹುಶಃ mean? (“perhaps”.) Say it once more.

49.5 ಹಾಗೆ (hāge) — that way, just so

Before the new one: what did *bahuśaḥ* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹಾಗೆ

ಹಾಗೆ (*hāge*) — “that way, just so”.

ಹಾಗೆ means ‘that way, like that’, and offered on its own it agrees: ‘just so’. ಹಾಗೇ ಆಗಲಿ — let it be that way.

Now set it beside ಹೇಗೆ, the question word for ‘how’ that this book gave you early on. They differ in one vowel. Supply the third and the shape is complete:

ಹೀಗೆ — this way. ಹಾಗೆ — that way. ಹೇಗೆ — which way?

That is the same three-way grid as ಇದು, ಅದು and ಎಲ್ಲಿ: ಇ- for what is near, ಅ- for what is away, ಎ- for what is being asked about. Kannada builds a great many of its small words on those three vowels, and once you can hear them you stop learning such words one at a time.

What you've built

Five replies: true, enough, certainly, perhaps, just so.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hāge*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *hāge*, *hāge*, *hēge* as one run

Before you move on

What does ಹಾಗೆ mean? (“that way, just so.”) Say it once more.

Chapter 50

Taking Your Leave

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can take my leave in Kannada and say when I will be back, and explain why the word for the farewell itself is built on the verb for giving.

Complete KA-C50-farewell and say all five words in order.

50.1 ಈಗ (īga) — now

Before the new run: what did *hāge* mean, and what did *bahuśaḥ* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಈಗ

ಈಗ (īga) — “now”.

ಈಗ is ‘now’, and it stands on the same ಇ- of nearness the chapter before ended on. ಆಗ (āga) is its partner: ‘then, at that time’, carrying the ಅ- of distance.

So Kannada names this moment and that moment by the same means it names this thing and that thing. Time is handled as one more place to point at.

What you’ve built

The first of five words for going.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *īga*
- it once more, slowly
- *īga*, then *āga*, and point at the near one and the far one

Before you move on

What does ಈಗ mean? (“now”.) Say it once more.

50.2 ನಾಡಿದ್ದು (nāḍiddu) — the day after tomorrow

Before the new one: what did *īga* mean?

You’ll want to know: ನಾಡಿದ್ದು

ನಾಡಿದ್ದು (*nāḍiddu*) — “the day after tomorrow”.

English needs four words for this. Kannada needs one, and keeps a matching one running the other way: ಮೊನ್ನೆ (*monne*), the day before yesterday.

You can hear ನಾಳೆ, ‘tomorrow’, at the front of ನಾಡಿದ್ದು — the two belong together, one step out and two steps out. A language that sows and marries by the calendar finds it worth keeping single words this far from today.

What you’ve built

Two: now, and the day after tomorrow.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nāḍiddu*
- it once more, slowly
- *īga*, *nāḷe*, *nāḍiddu* — today’s moment, then one day out, then two

Before you move on

What does ನಾಡಿದ್ದು mean? (“the day after tomorrow”.) Say it once more.

50.3 ಪ್ರಯಾಣ (prayāṇa) — a journey

Before the new one: what did *nāḍiddu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಪ್ರಯಾಣ

ಪ್ರಯಾಣ (*prayāṇa*) — “a journey”.

Sanskrit *pra-yāṇa*: *pra*, ‘forth, forward’, laid on a root meaning to go. A going-forth.

That *pra*- is very old and very widely travelled. It is the *pro*- of Latin, the *pro*- of Greek and the *forth* of English, one prefix that four languages inherited rather than borrowed from one another. Wish someone ಶುಭ ಪ್ರಯಾಣ, a good journey, and half the phrase is a word this book taught you on a quite different errand.

What you’ve built

Three: now, the day after tomorrow, a journey.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *prayāṇa*
- it once more, slowly
- *śubha prayāṇa* to someone leaving, then *prayāṇa* on its own

Before you move on

What does ಪ್ರಯಾಣ mean? (“a journey”.) Say it once more.

50.4 ಹೊರಡು (horaḍu) — to set out

Before the new one: what did *prayāṇa* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹೊರಡು

ಹೊರಡು (*horaḍu*) — “to set out”.

ಹೊರಡು is to set out, to start off, to leave a place with somewhere else in mind — not merely to go, for which Kannada already handed you a word.

Its front half is ಹೊರ (*hora*), ‘outside’. To set out is to go outward. And ಹೊರ is one more inherited word with an *h* where Tamil has a *p*: புறம் (*puram*) is the outside there. The law turns up again in the middle of an ordinary travelling verb.

What you've built

Four. Now, the day after tomorrow, a journey, and setting out on it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *horaḍu*
- it once more, slowly
- *horaḍu*, then *hōgu*, and say which of the two has a destination in it

Before you move on

What does ಹೊರಡು mean? (“to set out”.) Say it once more.

50.5 ಬೀಳ್ಕೊಡುಗೆ (*bīlkoḍuge*) — a send-off, a farewell

Before the new one: what did *horaḍu* mean?

You'll want to know: ಬೀಳ್ಕೊಡುಗೆ

ಬೀಳ್ಕೊಡುಗೆ (*bīlkoḍuge*) — “a send-off, a farewell”.

Take it apart and something you already own falls out of it. ಬೀಳ್ಕೊಡು is ‘to see someone off’, and the ಕೊಡು sitting in the middle of it is the plain verb ‘give’ from the chapter of commands. The ending *-ge* turns the whole action into a thing: a send-off.

Notice whose act it is. Kannada makes the leave-taking belong to the one who stays: the host gives the departure away. The traveller only walks.

Five words for going: now, the day after tomorrow, a journey, to set out, and the send-off at the end of it.

What you've built

Five words for going, and a way to end a visit without repeating yourself.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bīlkoḍuge*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *bīlkoḍuge* and the *koḍu* hiding inside it

Before you move on

What does ಬೀಳ್ಕೊಡುಗೆ mean? (“a send-off, a farewell”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 51

Courtesy Words

Modes: ⇌ voice (5) ⇌ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can be polite in Kannada beyond thank you — gratitude, a good turn, respect, a blessing, a salutation — and name the piece that a blessing shares with the thanks I learned first.

Complete KA-C51-salutation and say all five words in order.

51.1 ಕೃತಜ್ಞತೆ (kṛtajñate) — gratitude

Before the new run: what did *bīlkoḍuge* mean, and what did *horaḍu* mean?

You'll want to know: ಕೃತಜ್ಞತೆ

ಕೃತಜ್ಞತೆ (*kṛtajñate*) — “gratitude”.

Two Sanskrit pieces once more: *kṛta*, ‘done’, and *jñā*, ‘knowing’. Gratitude is knowing-what-was-done — the condition of a person who has not forgotten the favour.

jñā is a very old root, and English holds it too. The *know* of English, the *nōscere* of Latin, the *gnosis* of Greek and this *jñā* all come down from one ancestor. Saying ಕೃತಜ್ಞತೆ is saying *know* with three thousand years of Indian weather on it.

What you’ve built

The first of five courtesies.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kr̥tajñate*
- it once more, slowly
- *kr̥tajñate*, then *dhanyavāda*, and say which of the two you would write rather than speak

Before you move on

What does ಕೃತಜ್ಞತೆ mean? (“gratitude”). Say it once more.

51.2 ಉಪಕಾರ (upakāra) — a good turn, a favour

Before the new one: what did *kr̥tajñate* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಉಪಕಾರ

ಉಪಕಾರ (*upakāra*) — “a good turn, a favour”.

upa, ‘near, toward’, and *kāra*, ‘a doing’ — a doing-toward-someone. Its mirror image exists and is just as plain: ಅಪಕಾರ (*apakāra*), a harm done.

And the *kāra* here rests on *kr̥*, ‘to do’, which is the same *kr̥* inside the *kr̥ta* of the word before. Sanskrit builds like this constantly, from a small stock of roots and a small stock of prefixes, and the compounds explain themselves the moment the seams are visible.

What you’ve built

Two: gratitude, and a good turn.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *upakāra*
- it once more, slowly
- *upakāra*, then *kr̥tajñate*, and name the piece they share

Before you move on

What does ಉಪಕಾರ mean? (“a good turn, a favour”.) Say it once more.

51.3 ಗೌರವ (gaurava) — respect

Before the new one: what did *upakāra* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಗೌರವ

ಗೌರವ (*gaurava*) — “respect”.

Sanskrit *guru* means ‘heavy’. Stretch its first vowel, which is a standard Sanskrit way of making an abstract noun, and you have *gaurava*: heaviness, and so weight, consequence, dignity, respect.

The teacher is called *guru* by the same logic — the weighty one. And *guru* is a true relative of Latin *gravis*, so the English *grave* and *gravity* are this word arriving by another road. Kannada had already given it to you once, sitting quietly in the name of a weekday.

What you’ve built

Three: gratitude, a good turn, respect.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *gaurava*
- it once more, slowly
- *gaurava*, then the weekday that carries *guru* in it

Before you move on

What does ಗೌರವ mean? (“respect”.) Say it once more.

51.4 ಆಶೀರ್ವಾದ (āśīrvāda) — a blessing

Before the new one: what did *gaurava* mean?

You'll want to know: ಆಶೀರ್ವಾದ

ಆಶೀರ್ವಾದ (*āśīrvāda*) — “a blessing”.

āśis, ‘a wish, a prayer’, and *vāda*, ‘a speaking’. A blessing is the speaking-out of a wish.

Now look hard at the second half. ವಾದ is the same *-vāda* this book handed you on its very first page, inside ಧನ್ಯವಾದ — the speaking of ‘worthy’. Thanks and a blessing come from one carpenter: take a good word, set ‘speaking’ behind it, and you have named the act of saying it aloud.

What you've built

Four, and the fourth one is built exactly like the first word of this book.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *āśīrvāda*
- it once more, slowly
- *āśīrvāda*, then *dhanyavāda*, and hear *-vāda* close both

Before you move on

What does ಆಶೀರ್ವಾದ mean? (“a blessing”). Say it once more.

51.5 ವಂದನೆ (vandane) — a salutation

Before the new one: what did *āśīrvāda* mean?

You'll want to know: ವಂದನೆ

ವಂದನೆ (*vandane*) — “a salutation”.

vand- is a Sanskrit root meaning to praise, to salute, to bow to. ವಂದನೆ is the act itself, and ವಂದನೆಗಳು — the plural — is how a speaker closes a speech from a platform.

Set it beside ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ, the first word this book taught. That one stands on *nam-*, which also means to bow. Sanskrit kept two separate roots for bending toward another person and Kannada kept them both: one became the everyday hello, the other stayed the formal thanks-and-farewell.

Five courtesies: gratitude, a good turn, respect, a blessing, a salutation.

What you've built

Five courtesies, and two words for one gesture.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *vandane*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *vandane* and *namaskāra*, the two bows

Before you move on

What does ವಂದನೆ mean? (“a salutation”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 52

Welcoming a Guest

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the five things a Kannada welcome puts between the street and the guest, from the pattern on the ground to the garland.

Complete KA-C52-garland and say all five words in order.

52.1 ಬಾಗಿಲು (bāgilu) — a door

Before the new run: what did *vandane* mean, and what did *āśīrvāda* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಬಾಗಿಲು

ಬಾಗಿಲು (bāgilu) — “a door”.

ಬಾಗಿಲು is the door and the doorway at once — the opening quite as much as the plank that shuts it.

Beside it sits Tamil வாயில் (*vāyil*), a gateway, and that word is transparently built on வாய், ‘mouth’, which is ಬಾಯಿ here with the *b* standing in for the *v*. Whether ಬಾಗಿಲು is that same word with a consonant grown in its middle, or a separate formation on ಬಾಗು, ‘to bend’, is not settled. What is beyond doubt is that a Dravidian house has been known to name its opening after a face.

What you’ve built

The first of the five things a welcome puts in a guest’s way.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bāgīlu*
- it once more, slowly
- *bāgīlu*, then *bāyi*, and hear the *b* and the *v* trade places

Before you move on

What does ಬಾಗಿಲು mean? (“a door”.) Say it once more.

52.2 ಕುರ್ಚಿ (kurci) — a chair

Before the new one: what did *bāgīlu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಕುರ್ಚಿ

ಕುರ್ಚಿ (*kurci*) — “a chair”.

Arabic *kursī*, a seat or a throne, carried into India by Persian and handed on to half the languages of the subcontinent — Hindi कुर्सी, Marathi खुर्ची, and this.

The word was borrowed because the object was. A Kannada household ate, and to a fair degree still eats, sitting on the floor; the chair came in as furniture and brought its name along. You already know how to tell a guest to sit. Now there is something to sit on.

What you’ve built

Two: a door and a chair.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kurci*
- it once more, slowly
- *kulitukō*, then *kurci* — the command, then the thing it needs

Before you move on

What does ಕುರ್ಚಿ mean? (“a chair”.) Say it once more.

52.3 ರಂಗೋಲಿ (rangōli) — the pattern drawn at a doorway

Before the new one: what did *kurci* mean?

You’ll want to know: ರಂಗೋಲಿ

ರಂಗೋಲಿ (*rangōli*) — “the pattern drawn at a doorway”.

White rice-flour, drawn freehand on swept ground in front of the door, at first light, before anyone has arrived.

The name is *raṅga*, ‘colour’, and *āvalī*, ‘a row’: a row of colour. That *āvalī* is the same one behind the festival of lamps whose name came apart a few chapters back — a row of lamps there, a row of colour here. Kannada also calls the thing ರಂಗವಲ್ಲಿ (*raṅgavallī*), which is the same compound less worn down.

What you’ve built

Three: a door, a chair, and the pattern on the ground before both.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *rangōli*
- it once more, slowly
- *rangōli*, then *dīpa*, and name the row inside each

Before you move on

What does ರಂಗೋಲಿ mean? (“the pattern drawn at a doorway”.) Say it once more.

52.4 ಹೂವು (hūvu) — a flower

Before the new one: what did *raṅgōli* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹೂವು

ಹೂವು (*hūvu*) — “a flower”.

Proto-Dravidian ***pū**, one syllable, and one syllable is what it stayed nearly everywhere: Tamil பூ, Malayalam പൂവ്, Telugu పువ్వు.

Kannada's ಹೂವು shows the law at its very clearest. There is almost nothing else in the word — no root to hide behind, no ending to distract you — only the one sound, *p* across the family and *h* here.

What you've built

Four. A door, a chair, the pattern, a flower.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hūvu*
- it once more, slowly
- *hūvu*, then *haṇṇu* and *hallu*, three inherited words with one *h* each

Before you move on

What does ಹೂವು mean? (“a flower”.) Say it once more.

52.5 ಹೂಮಾಲೆ (hūmāle) — a garland

Before the new one: what did *hūvu* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹೂಮಾಲೆ

ಹೂಮಾಲೆ (*hūmāle*) — “a garland”.

ಹೂ, the flower from the lesson before, and ಮಾಲೆ (*māle*), from Sanskrit *mālā*, a garland or any row of strung things.

So the last word of the run carries both halves of Kannada in it: a Dravidian syllable some thousands of years old, and a Sanskrit one that

arrived later and settled in. Nearly every page here has turned on one of those two layers. This word declines to choose.

Five things a Kannada welcome puts between the street and the guest: the door, the chair, the pattern on the ground, the flower, the garland.

What you've built

Five, and the last of them is half inherited and half borrowed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hūmāle*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *hūvu* and *hūmāle* one after the other

Before you move on

What does ಹೂಮಾಲೆ mean? (“a garland”). Say it once more.

Chapter 53

The Sky

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five things overhead in Kannada, and say which of them Kannada borrowed and which it has always had.

Complete KA-C53-cloud and say all five words in order.

53.1 ಆಕಾಶ (ākāśa) — the sky

Before the new run: what did *hūvu* mean, and what did *hūmāle* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಆಕಾಶ

ಆಕಾಶ (ākāśa) — “the sky”.

Sanskrit *ākāśa*, built on a piece meaning “to shine, to be visible”. The sky is named for being the open lit place where a thing can be seen at all, rather than for being a lid over the world.

Kannada holds an inherited word for the same overhead space, ಬಾನು (*bānu*), which owes Sanskrit nothing. The two divide the work: ಆಕಾಶ does the ordinary shift and turns up in weather talk, while ಬಾನು keeps to songs and poetry. A borrowed word taking the daily job and leaving the old one the ceremony is an arrangement you have watched before, at the ಬಾಗಿಲು.

ākāśa travelled as well. Traders carried it east, and Malay and Indonesian still say *angkasa* for the sky.

What you've built

The space the rest of this chapter hangs in.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ākāśa*
- it once more, slowly
- *ākāśa*, then *namaskāra*, as you would greet somebody out of doors

Before you move on

What does ಆಕಾಶ mean? (“the sky”.) Say it once more.

53.2 ಬಿಸಿಲು (bisilu) — sunshine, the sun's heat

Before the new one: what did *ākāśa* mean?

You'll want to know: ಬಿಸಿಲು

ಬಿಸಿಲು (*bisilu*) — “sunshine, the sun's heat”.

Under it sits ಬಿಸಿ (*bisi*), “hot” — the word on a cup of ಚಹಾ that has just been poured. ಬಿಸಿಲು is the hot thing that falls out of the sky, and Kannada built it the plain way, from the heat rather than from the star.

That is worth pausing on. English talks about the weather by naming the sun; Kannada reaches first for what the sun does to you standing in it. A Bengaluru sentence about the afternoon is far more likely to be about ಬಿಸಿಲು than about any sun-word at all.

Kannada has two sun-words even so. ನೇಸರು (*nēsaru*) is its own, kept alive mostly in verse and in names; the borrowed one you have already had a piece of, inside the sunrise word the good-morning lesson took apart.

What you've built

Two: the sky, and what comes down out of it by day.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bisilu*
- it once more, slowly
- *bisi*, then *bisilu*, and hear the shorter word standing inside the longer one

Before you move on

What does ಬಿಸಿಲು mean? (“sunshine, the sun’s heat”.) Say it once more.

53.3 ಚಂದ್ರ (candra) — the moon

Before the new one: what did *bisilu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಚಂದ್ರ

ಚಂದ್ರ (*candra*) — “the moon”.

Sanskrit *candra* means “shining, bright”. Kannada took it whole, the way it took ಆಕಾಶ, and it is the word a newsreader says.

Kannada’s own moon-word is ತಿಂಗಳು (*tingalu*), and that word also means a month. One shape for the moon and for the stretch of time it measures — the moon being the oldest calendar there is, and Kannada keeping that fact inside a single word. The twelve month-names you met are Sanskrit; ತಿಂಗಳು is what a Kannada speaker actually counts in.

candra went a long way west too. It shares an ancestor with the Latin piece behind English *candle* and *incandescent*: a very old root for burning white.

What you’ve built

Three, and two of them borrowed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *candra*
- it once more, slowly
- *ākāśa*, then *candra*, and say which of the two is the container

Before you move on

What does ಚಂದ್ರ mean? (“the moon”.) Say it once more.

53.4 ಚುಕ್ಕಿ (cukki) — a star; a dot

Before the new one: what did *candra* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಚುಕ್ಕಿ

ಚುಕ್ಕಿ (*cukki*) — “a star; a dot”.

ಚುಕ್ಕಿ is inherited, and it carries the star and the dot on one shape. Anything small and round and separate can be a ಚುಕ್ಕಿ.

Which is why it belongs to the ರಂಗೋಲಿ as much as to the night. The pattern at the doorway is set out first as a grid of ಚುಕ್ಕಿ, points of rice flour placed at even spacing, and the lines are drawn around and between them afterwards. A woman saying she is putting down ಚುಕ್ಕಿ in the morning is talking about her doorstep.

The borrowed word for a star is ನಕ್ಷತ್ರ (*nakṣatra*), and that is the one an astrologer reaches for. ಚುಕ್ಕಿ is the one a child points with.

What you’ve built

Four, and this one reaches back down to the doorstep.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *cukki*
- it once more, slowly
- *cukki*, then *raṅgōli*, and say how the two meet on the ground

Before you move on

What does ಚುಕ್ಕಿ mean? (“a star; a dot”.) Say it once more.

53.5 ಮೋಡ (mōḍa) — a cloud

Before the new one: what did *cukki* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಮೋಡ

ಮೋಡ (mōḍa) — “a cloud”.

ಮೋಡ is inherited and quite plain: the grey thing standing between you and the ಬಿಸಿಲು. ಮೋಡ ಇದೆ — there is cloud — is a whole weather report, and it is the one Kannada speakers give each other most of the year.

Weather words stretch, and this one has. ಮೋಡ also describes a face that has gone dull and closed, and a mood that will not lift. English went the same way with *clouded* and *overcast*, from the far side of the world and with no contact at all. When two unrelated languages reach for the same picture, the picture is doing the work rather than any borrowing.

With that, the sky is furnished.

What you’ve built

Five: ಆಕಾಶ, ಬಿಸಿಲು, ಚಂದ್ರ, ಚುಕ್ಕಿ, ಮೋಡ. You can say what is overhead.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- mōḍa
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then say which two of them Kannada borrowed

Before you move on

What does ಮೋಡ mean? (“a cloud”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 54

The Tree

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a tree and its parts in Kannada, from the seed it started as to the branch at the top.

Complete KA-C54-seed and say all five words in order.

54.1 ಮರ (mara) — a tree

Before the new run: what did *cukki* mean, and what did *mōḍa* mean?

You'll want to know: ಮರ

ಮರ (*mara*) — “a tree”.

Two syllables, and one of the oldest words the family has. Tamil says *maram*, Malayalam *maram*, and Kannada let the closing *-m* fall away, as it has a habit of doing.

ಮರ is the standing tree and equally the wood it is cut into. A carpenter and a forester reach for the same word, and Kannada has felt no need to split them — the thing and the material are one item as far as the language is concerned.

It is also the first word of this chapter for a plain reason: everything else here is a part of it.

What you've built

The thing the next four words belong to.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *marā*
- it once more, slowly
- *doḍḍa marā* — “a big tree” — with the describing word in front, where Kannada keeps it

Before you move on

What does ಮರ mean? (“a tree”.) Say it once more.

54.2 ಕೊಂಬೆ (kombe) — a branch

Before the new one: what did *marā* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಕೊಂಬೆ

ಕೊಂಬೆ (*kombe*) — “a branch”.

Beside it stands ಕೊಂಬು (*kombu*), a horn, and the two are the same word wearing different endings. A branch is what a ಮರ has on its head, and the language saw an animal’s horn and a tree’s limb as one shape: something hard that grows outward and forks.

That picture is not a Kannada peculiarity. Tamil keeps *kombu* doing both jobs as well, so the joining is old — older than any of the four sisters.

English does the reverse trick and puts the tree onto the animal, calling the branched horns of a stag its antlers and its crown. The picture travels in whichever direction a language happens to take it.

What you’ve built

Two: the tree, and what comes out of it sideways.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kombe*

- it once more, slowly
- *mara*, then *kombe*, and say which one holds the other up

Before you move on

What does ಕೊಂಬೆ mean? (“a branch”.) Say it once more.

54.3 ಎಲೆ (ele) — a leaf

Before the new one: what did *kombe* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಎಲೆ

ಎಲೆ (*ele*) — “a leaf”.

Inherited, and close to its sisters: Tamil *ilai*, Malayalam *ila*. Telugu is the one that walked off, using *āku* instead.

The everyday weight of ಎಲೆ is heavier than “leaf” suggests. Say it on its own in a Kannada house and you are usually talking about the betel leaf — ಎಲೆ ಅಡಿಕೆ, leaf and areca nut, handed to a guest at the end of an *ūṭa* and at the end of a welcome. The ಬಾಗಿಲು, the ಕುರ್ಚಿ, the ರಂಗೋಲಿ and the ಹೂಮಾಲೆ each had their moment; the ಎಲೆ is what the visitor is holding on the way out.

The other big ಎಲೆ is the plantain leaf a meal is served on, which is a plate you do not wash.

What you’ve built

Three, and this one is handed to people.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ele*
- it once more, slowly
- *hasiru ele* — “a green leaf” — and *ele*, *kombe*, *mara* upward in order

Before you move on

What does ಎಲೆ mean? (“a leaf”.) Say it once more.

54.4 ಬೇರು (bēru) — a root

Before the new one: what did *ele* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಬೇರು

ಬೇರು (*bēru*) — “a root”.

Tamil says *vēr*, Malayalam says *vēr*, Telugu says *vēru* — and Kannada says ಬೇರು. That opening *b* against everybody else’s *v* is the trade you have watched at the ಬಾಗಿಲು and again in ಬರೆ, and here it is once more with the letters lined up so plainly that you can hear the law rather than be told about it.

Two sound laws now separate Kannada from its sisters, and both of them are visible in a single chapter: the *p* that became *h* in ಹಣ್ಣು and ಹೂವು, and the *v* that became *b* in this word.

ಬೇರು also does the figurative work English gives *roots*: where a family comes from, what a word descends from. Both languages dug the same hole.

What you’ve built

Four, and the lowest one shows the law.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bēru*
- it once more, slowly
- *bēru*, then *bāgīlu*, and hear the same *b* opening both

Before you move on

What does ಬೇರು mean? (“a root”.) Say it once more.

54.5 ಬೀಜ (bīja) — a seed

Before the new one: what did *bēru* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಬೀಜ

ಬೀಜ (*bīja*) — “a seed”.

Four inherited words, and then this one, straight out of Sanskrit and unaltered. The chapter closes on a borrowing, which is a fair picture of the language: the tree is Dravidian from the ಬೇರು up, and the word for what starts it came from elsewhere.

Kannada kept its own word for the act, though. ಬಿತ್ತು (*bittu*) is to sow, and it is as native as ಮರ. So a ರೈತ sows with an inherited word and names what he is sowing with a borrowed one, in the same breath and without noticing.

ಬೀಜ also does the abstract job — the seed of a quarrel, the seed of an idea — in Kannada exactly as in English, and it was doing it in Sanskrit long before either.

What you’ve built

Five: ಮರ, ಕೊಂಬೆ, ಎಲೆ, ಬೇರು, ಬೀಜ. A tree from the ground up, and the thing it began as.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bīja*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then say which one of them Kannada borrowed

Before you move on

What does ಬೀಜ mean? (“a seed”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 55

River and Road

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the water, the ground and the road around a Kannada village, and ask my way with them.

Complete KA-C55-path and say all five words in order.

55.1 ನದಿ (nadi) — a river

Before the new run: what did *bēru* mean, and what did *bīja* mean?

You’ll want to know: ನದಿ

ನದಿ (*nadi*) — “a river”.

Sanskrit *nadī*, and under it a root *nad-* meaning “to roar, to sound”. A river is named for the noise it makes. That is a word coined by somebody who heard one before they ever saw one, in the dark, in the rain.

Kannada’s own river-word is ಹೊಳೆ (*hole*), and it opens with the *h* you have learned to read as an old *p*. ಹೊಳೆ is the water you can walk to — the stream behind the village. ನದಿ is the ಕಾವೇರಿ. The borrowed word took the big rivers and left the small ones to the inherited one, which is the opposite of what usually happens.

What you’ve built

The first of five things you would have to name to ask your way.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nadi*
- it once more, slowly
- *nadi elli?* — “where is the river?” — with the asking word at the end

Before you move on

What does ನದಿ mean? (“a river”.) Say it once more.

55.2 ಕೆರೆ (kere) — a tank, a reservoir

Before the new one: what did *nadi* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಕೆರೆ

ಕೆರೆ (*kere*) — “a tank, a reservoir”.

English has no comfortable word for this, which is why the Indian English one is *tank*. A ಕೆರೆ is not a lake. It is built: an earth bund thrown across a shallow valley so the ಮಳೆಗಾಲ water stands instead of running away, and so a ರೈತ downstream still has ನೀರು in the dry months.

The Deccan is dry and the rain arrives all at once, so this is the thing the land needed most, and Karnataka has thousands of them, many of them eight or nine hundred years old and still in use. Bengaluru’s own neighbourhoods are named after the ones it has built over.

ಕೆರೆ is inherited, and it is one of those words that tells you what its speakers were doing.

What you’ve built

Two: water that runs, and water somebody stopped.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kere*

- it once more, slowly
- *nadi*, then *kere*, and say which one of them people made

Before you move on

What does ಕೆರೆ mean? (“a tank, a reservoir”.) Say it once more.

55.3 ಬೆಟ್ಟ (beṭṭa) — a hill

Before the new one: what did *kere* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಬೆಟ್ಟ

ಬೆಟ್ಟ (*beṭṭa*) — “a hill”.

Inherited, and it opens with the *b* the previous chapter set beside everybody else’s *v*, so you can hear which layer of the language it belongs to before you know anything else about it.

Kannada distinguishes sizes here where English shrugs. ಗುಡ್ಡ (*guḍḍa*) is the small rise you would walk up without planning to; ಬೆಟ್ಟ is the one that has a temple on top and a name on the map. ನಂದಿ ಬೆಟ್ಟ north of Bengaluru and ಚಾಮುಂಡಿ ಬೆಟ್ಟ above Mysuru are both ಬೆಟ್ಟ, and nobody would call either a ಗುಡ್ಡ.

A hill with a name is a hill people climb for a reason, and in Karnataka the reason is usually at the summit.

What you’ve built

Three, and the first of them that stands up.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *beṭṭa*
- it once more, slowly
- *doḍḍa beṭṭa*, then *cikka guḍḍa*, and hear the size words doing the sorting

Before you move on

What does ಬೆಟ್ಟ mean? (“a hill”.) Say it once more.

55.4 ಹಳ್ಳಿ (halli) — a village

Before the new one: what did *betṭa* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಹಳ್ಳಿ

ಹಳ್ಳಿ (*halli*) — “a village”.

The *h* tells you what happened: an older *palli* stands behind it, worn down by the same law that turned the fruit-word and the flower-word into ಹಣ್ಣು and ಹೂವು.

What makes this one worth stopping for is that the older shape did not disappear — it is written on road signs across the state. Hundreds of Karnataka place names end in *-halli*, and hundreds more across the border end in *-palli* and *-pally*. Same word, one of them having passed through the Kannada law and the other not. A learner who can hear that ending can read a map as a record of a sound change.

Tamil kept *palli* too and steered it a different way, toward a place of rest and then toward a school.

What you’ve built

Four, and this one is signposted the length of the state.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *halli*
- it once more, slowly
- *haṇṇu*, then *halli*, and hear the one law opening both

Before you move on

What does ಹಳ್ಳಿ mean? (“a village”.) Say it once more.

55.5 ದಾರಿ (dāri) — a way, a path

Before the new one: what did *halli* mean?

You'll want to know: ದಾರಿ

ದಾರಿ (*dāri*) — “a way, a path”.

This is the word that turns the other four into directions. ಕಿರಗಿ ದಾರಿ — the way to the tank — and you already have the little *-ge* that hangs on the end of the place you are heading for.

Kannada keeps a second word for the same thing, ಹಾದಿ (*hādi*), and speakers use the two close to interchangeably, though ಹಾದಿ leans a little toward the worn track and ದಾರಿ a little toward the route you choose.

Put ದಾರಿ with the polite word you already have and you have the sentence a stranger needs most: ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು ದಾರಿ ಹೇಳಿ — please tell me the way. Notice that nothing in it names you. Kannada lets the asking be the request.

What you've built

Five: ನದಿ, ಕೆರೆ, ಬೆಟ್ಟ, ಹಳ್ಳಿ, ದಾರಿ. Four landmarks and the thread between them.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *dāri*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *dayaviṭṭu dāri hēḷi*

Before you move on

What does ದಾರಿ mean? (“a way, a path”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 56

In the House

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five ordinary things in a Kannada house, and say which two of them arrived with borrowed names.

Complete KA-C56-box and say all five words in order.

56.1 ಚಾಪೆ (cāpe) — a mat

Before the new run: what did *halli* mean, and what did *dāri* mean?

You'll want to know: ಚಾಪೆ

ಚಾಪೆ (cāpe) — “a mat”.

The woven mat that gets unrolled on the floor: for sitting on, for eating on, for sleeping on, and for putting away against the wall in the morning.

The ಕುರ್ಚಿ arrived from outside with its Persian name, and it arrived late. The ಚಾಪೆ was already there. A Kannada house has for a very long time sat and eaten and slept at floor level, and the ಚಾಪೆ is the piece of furniture that arrangement needs — one object doing what a chair, a table and a bed do elsewhere, then rolling up to occupy nothing.

Offering a guest a ಚಾಪೆ is the older form of the courtesy the ಕುರ್ಚಿ now performs, and in a ಹಳ್ಳಿ it is still the usual one.

What you've built

The first of five things a Kannada house keeps to hand.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *cāpe*
- it once more, slowly
- *kulitukō*, then *cāpe*, and say who is offered which

Before you move on

What does ಚಾವೆ mean? (“a mat”.) Say it once more.

56.2 ಬುಟ್ಟಿ (buṭṭi) — a basket

Before the new one: what did *cāpe* mean?

You'll want to know: ಬುಟ್ಟಿ

ಬುಟ್ಟಿ (*buṭṭi*) — “a basket”.

Woven, usually from bamboo, and carried on the hip or the head rather than in the hand. ಹಣ್ಣಿನ ಬುಟ್ಟಿ is a basket of fruit; a ಹೂವಿನ ಬುಟ್ಟಿ is what flowers come to the door in.

The little *-ina* in the middle of those is the joining piece Kannada slips between two names to say the second belongs to the first. Fruit-of basket. You can build the same shape with anything you already have.

ಬುಟ್ಟಿ shares its ending with the ಚಾವೆ's world rather than the ಕುರ್ಚಿ's: another light, cheap, repairable thing made from what grows nearby, and one that a house replaces every few years without thinking about it.

What you've built

Two: a thing to sit on, and a thing to carry with.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *butṭi*
- it once more, slowly
- *haṇṇina butṭi*, then *hūvina butṭi*, and hear the joining piece in the middle

Before you move on

What does ಬುಟ್ಟಿ mean? (“a basket”.) Say it once more.

56.3 ಚಾಕು (cāku) — a knife

Before the new one: what did *butṭi* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಚಾಕು

ಚಾಕು (*cāku*) — “a knife”.

Persian *chāqū*, a small knife, carried down into the subcontinent along the same road that delivered the ಕುರ್ಚಿ, and handed on to Hindi, Marathi, Telugu and this. Two objects in two chapters, both borrowed, both arriving by the north.

The borrowing did not push anything out. Kannada’s own blade is ಕತ್ತಿ (*katti*), and it is the big one — the household and field blade, the one a ರೈತ works with. ಚಾಕು is the small one: the pocket knife, the paring knife, the thing that cuts a ಹಣ್ಣು.

The pattern is the one the chair showed. When a language borrows a word for a thing it already has, the borrowed word usually takes a narrower job and the old word keeps the wider one.

What you’ve built

Three, and the second of them arrived by the northern road.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *cāku*
- it once more, slowly
- *kurci*, then *cāku*, and say what the two of them have in common

Before you move on

What does ಚಾಕು mean? (“a knife”.) Say it once more.

56.4 ಪಾತ್ರೆ (pātre) — a vessel, a cooking pot

Before the new one: what did *cāku* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಪಾತ್ರೆ

ಪಾತ್ರೆ (*pātre*) — “a vessel, a cooking pot”.

Sanskrit *pātra*, and it began by meaning a drinking or eating vessel. Then it did something quietly remarkable: it moved from the container to the person. A *pātra* is also one fit to receive — a worthy recipient of a gift, of teaching, of trust.

From there it took one more step, and the *pātra* of a play is a character, a part, a role. The same word holds the pot, the deserving person and the actor’s part, because all three are shapes that something is poured into.

Kannada carries the whole set. ಪಾತ್ರೆ in the kitchen is the vessel; ಪಾತ್ರ on the stage is the role. One Sanskrit word, and the ending tells you which of its lives is being lived.

What you’ve built

Four, and this one keeps three meanings in one shape.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *pātre*
- it once more, slowly
- *pātre*, then *nāru*, and say which one holds the other

Before you move on

What does ಪಾತ್ರೆ mean? (“a vessel, a cooking pot”.) Say it once more.

56.5 ಪೆಟ್ಟಿಗೆ (petṭige) — a box

Before the new one: what did *pātre* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಪೆಟ್ಟಿಗೆ

ಪೆಟ್ಟಿಗೆ (*petṭige*) — “a box”.

All four sisters have this word and it is nearly the same in each: Tamil *petṭi*, Malayalam *petṭi*, Telugu *petṭe*, and Kannada ಪೆಟ್ಟಿಗೆ. Only Kannada carries the extra closing syllable, which is a habit you have now seen a few times — Kannada tends to be the long one.

A ಪೆಟ್ಟಿಗೆ is the wooden or tin chest a household keeps its papers and its good ಬಟ್ಟೆ in, standing in a corner with a padlock on it. It is also the word that stretched to cover a suitcase, a jewellery box and the case a musical instrument travels in.

Notice how much of this chapter is containers. The ಬುಟ್ಟಿ carries, the ಪಾತ್ರೆ cooks, the ಪೆಟ್ಟಿಗೆ keeps. A house is largely a set of things for putting other things into.

What you’ve built

Five: ಚಾಪೆ, ಬುಟ್ಟಿ, ಚಾಕು, ಪಾತ್ರೆ, ಪೆಟ್ಟಿಗೆ. You can furnish a room.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *petṭige*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then say which three of them hold something

Before you move on

What does ಪೆಟ್ಟಿಗೆ mean? (“a box”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 57

More of the Body

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five more parts of a person in Kannada, and say where it hurts.

Complete KA-C57-bone and say all five words in order.

57.1 ಕುತ್ತಿಗೆ (kuttige) — the neck

Before the new run: what did *pātre* mean, and what did *petṭige* mean?

You'll want to know: ಕುತ್ತಿಗೆ

ಕುತ್ತಿಗೆ (*kuttige*) — “the neck”.

The everyday word, and the one a ವೈದ್ಯ uses. Kannada has a second, ಕೊರಳು (*koraḷu*), and the two divide by what is being done to the neck rather than by which part of it is meant: ಕೊರಳು is the neck a ಹೂಮಾಲೆ goes around and the neck a voice comes out of, while ಕುತ್ತಿಗೆ is the neck that aches.

So a singer's is a ಕೊರಳು and a patient's is a ಕುತ್ತಿಗೆ, and the same piece of a person is both, depending on why you brought it up.

This chapter picks up where the leg and the tooth left off, and the run gets less obvious as it goes.

What you've built

The first of five more pieces of a person.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kuttige*
- it once more, slowly
- *nanna kuttige* — “my neck” — with the possessing word in front

Before you move on

What does ಕುತ್ತಿಗೆ mean? (“the neck”.) Say it once more.

57.2 ಬೆನ್ನು (bennu) — the back

Before the new one: what did *kuttige* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಬೆನ್ನು

ಬೆನ್ನು (*bennu*) — “the back”.

Inherited, and it opens with the *b* that has now turned up in ಬಾಗಿಲು, ಬೇರು and ಬೆಟ್ಟ. Four words in four chapters, and by this point you should be reading that first letter as a small piece of history rather than as a sound.

ಬೆನ್ನು is the part of a person that faces away, so the language uses it for anything behind you. ಬೆನ್ನ ಹಿಂದೆ, behind the back, is where things are said about you that would not be said in front.

And ಬೆನ್ನು ತಟ್ಟು, to pat the back, means to praise or encourage — the same gesture English named the same way, with no contact between the two languages at any point. Some pictures are simply what bodies do.

What you’ve built

Two, and this one has a hand on it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bennu*
- it once more, slowly
- *bennu*, then *bēru*, then *beṭṭa*, and hear the one letter they share

Before you move on

What does ಬೆನ್ನು mean? (“the back”.) Say it once more.

57.3 ತುಟಿ (tuṭi) — a lip

Before the new one: what did *bennu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ತುಟಿ

ತುಟಿ (*tuṭi*) — “a lip”.

Two syllables, inherited, and here the four sisters go four different ways. Tamil, Malayalam and Telugu each reach for something quite unlike ತುಟಿ and unlike each other. For a family this close that is unusual, and it usually means the part in question got renamed after the family split, several times over, by whichever picture each language happened to prefer.

ತುಟಿ sits directly on the ಬಾಯಿ you already have. The mouth is the opening; the ತುಟಿ is its edge.

And it is the piece of the face that Kannada uses for keeping quiet. To say nothing at all is to not move the ತುಟಿ — a phrase built out of a body part rather than out of a word for silence, which is how a great many everyday expressions in this language are put together.

What you’ve built

Three, and this one edges a word you already had.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *tuṭi*
- it once more, slowly
- *bāyi*, then *tuṭi*, and say which one is the edge of the other

Before you move on

What does ತುಟಿ mean? (“a lip”.) Say it once more.

57.4 ಭುಜ (bhuja) — the shoulder

Before the new one: what did *tuti* mean?

You'll want to know: ಭುಜ

ಭುಜ (*bhuja*) — “the shoulder”.

Sanskrit *bhuja*, and behind it *bhuj-*, “to bend”. The shoulder is named for being the joint that folds — the limb described by what it does rather than by where it sits. Sanskrit built a good many body words that way.

Kannada’s own word here is ಹೆಗಲು (*hegalu*), and the division between the two is worth having. ಹೆಗಲು is the shoulder you carry a load on, the flat top of it; ಭುಜ leans toward the joint and toward strength — the arm-and-shoulder of somebody who can lift things.

That opening ಭ is a letter Kannada mostly uses in borrowed words. Meeting one is a fair hint that the word came from Sanskrit before you know anything else about it.

What you’ve built

Four, and this is the run’s borrowed one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bhuja*
- it once more, slowly
- *bhuja*, then *kuttige*, and say which of the two the ಹೂಮಾಲೆ passes

Before you move on

What does ಭುಜ mean? (“the shoulder”.) Say it once more.

57.5 ಮೂಳೆ (mūḷe) — a bone

Before the new one: what did *bhuja* mean?

You'll want to know: ಮೂಳೆ

ಮೂಳೆ (*mūḷe*) — “a bone”.

Here Kannada is the odd one out. Tamil says *elumbu*, Malayalam says *eluvu*, Telugu says *emuka* — three sisters plainly holding the same old word between them, and Kannada holding ಮೂಳೆ, which is not it.

That happens. A language drops an inherited word and promotes another one, and afterwards the family tree looks broken at exactly one branch. The ear-word and the nose-word each showed you a version of this earlier, with a different sister standing apart each time. Which one is the odd one out changes from word to word, and that is the whole point: these are four separate languages, not four accents.

ಮೂಳೆ closes the body run, and it is the piece of you that outlasts the rest.

What you've built

Five: ಕುತ್ತಿಗೆ, ಬೆನ್ನು, ತುಟಿ, ಭುಜ, ಮೂಳೆ. Enough to say where it hurts.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mūḷe*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then say which of them is the odd one in the family

Before you move on

What does ಮೂಳೆ mean? (“a bone”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 58

More Short Replies

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can answer an offer in Kannada five ways, from a little to no thank you.

Complete KA-C58-thats-all and say all five words in order.

58.1 ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ (svalpa) — a little, a bit

Before the new run: what did *bhuja* mean, and what did *mūle* mean?

You'll want to know: ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ

ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ (*svalpa*) — “a little, a bit”.

Sanskrit, and it comes apart cleanly: *su-*, “well, nicely”, on *alpa*, “small”. Nicely small. The same *su-* that opens the good-morning word you already have.

But the useful thing about ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ is not its size. It is what it does to whatever follows it. Ask for something flat and you are instructing; put ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ in front and you are asking. ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ ನೀರು ಕೊಡಿ leaves the other person room to move in a way that ನೀರು ಕೊಡಿ does not.

The word measures a quantity in the dictionary and a manner in the mouth. English does the same thing with “just” and “a bit”, and neither of those measures much any more either.

What you've built

A word that softens the next one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *svalpa*
- it once more, slowly
- *nīru koḍi*, then *svalpa nīru koḍi*, and hear how much softer the second one is

Before you move on

What does ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ mean? (“a little, a bit”.) Say it once more.

58.2 ಹೆಚ್ಚು (heccu) — more, a lot

Before the new one: what did *svalpa* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹೆಚ್ಚು

ಹೆಚ್ಚು (*heccu*) — “more, a lot”.

Inherited, and the opening *h* puts it in the same layer as ಹಣ್ಣು and ಹಳ್ಳಿ. The borrowed word softened your request; this one is Kannada's own, and it does the opposite job.

ಹೆಚ್ಚು is both “more” and “much”. It answers a question about quantity all by itself, and it goes in front of whatever it is measuring: ಹೆಚ್ಚು ಹಣ್ಣು, more fruit. It is also the word for a comparison, so ಹೆಚ್ಚು is how a Kannada speaker says one thing outweighs another without needing a separate word for “than”.

Held against ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ it gives you a scale you can answer with. ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ when a little will do; ಹೆಚ್ಚು when it will not.

What you've built

Two, and they point in opposite directions.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *heccu*
- it once more, slowly
- *svalpa hālu*, then *heccu hālu*, and hear the amount change in front

Before you move on

What does ಹೆಚ್ಚು mean? (“more, a lot”) Say it once more.

58.3 ಕಡಿಮೆ (kaḍime) — less, fewer

Before the new one: what did *heccu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಕಡಿಮೆ

ಕಡಿಮೆ (*kaḍime*) — “less, fewer”.

Underneath sits ಕಡಿ (*kaḍi*), to cut, to reduce. ಕಡಿಮೆ is the cut-down amount — a quantity named for the act that produced it, which is the same move Kannada made with the fruit-word, where the ripening gave the ripe thing its name.

ಹೆಚ್ಚು and ಕಡಿಮೆ travel together as a pair, and the pair has its own life. ಹೆಚ್ಚು ಕಡಿಮೆ, said as one phrase, means “more or less, roughly” — two opposites put side by side to make a hedge. English builds “more or less” out of exactly the same two pieces, and Kannada leaves out the “or”.

That is three of the five now, and none of them names a thing. This chapter is about the words that adjust everything else.

What you’ve built

Three, and two of them make a phrase together.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kaḍime*

- it once more, slowly
- *heccu kaḍime*, and say what the pair means when it travels as one

Before you move on

What does ಕಡಿಮೆ mean? (“less, fewer”.) Say it once more.

58.4 ಬೇಡ (bēḍa) — no thank you, I don’t want it

Before the new one: what did *kaḍime* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಬೇಡ

ಬೇಡ (bēḍa) — “no thank you, I don’t want it”.

This is the refusal a guest actually needs, and it is not the ಇಲ್ಲ you learned on the first page. ಇಲ್ಲ denies that something exists or is so. ಬೇಡ declines it.

It is the negative twin of ಬೇಕು (bēku), “wanted, needed” — the word that turns up in the sort of sentence Kannada builds with nothing doing at all. ಬೇಕು and ಬೇಡ answer the same question in opposite directions, and neither of them bothers to name who is doing the wanting. The offer is made, and one word settles it.

At a Kannada table you will be offered more food several times after you are finished. ಬೇಡ, said once and pleasantly, is the whole of the reply. Adding ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ in front turns it into “just a little”, which is the answer that gets you served anyway.

What you’ve built

Four, and this one is the polite way out.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bēḍa*
- it once more, slowly
- *bēḍa*, then *illa*, and say which one refuses and which one denies

Before you move on

What does ಬೇಡ mean? (“no thank you, I don’t want it”.) Say it once more.

58.5 ಅಷ್ಟೇ (aṣṭē) — that’s all, just that

Before the new one: what did *bēḍa* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಅಷ್ಟೇ

ಅಷ್ಟೇ (*aṣṭē*) — “that’s all, just that”.

Two pieces. ಅಷ್ಟು (*aṣṭu*) is “that much”, and it belongs to the pointing family you already have — the *a-* of ಅದು and ಅಲ್ಲಿ, the one that means away from the speaker. Then the long *-ē* on the end, which Kannada hangs on a word to mean “and nothing besides”.

So ಅಷ್ಟೇ is “that much, and no more”. It closes a list, ends an order, and stops a question. Asked what else you would like: ಅಷ್ಟೇ.

That closing *-ē* is worth keeping. Put it on almost anything and you get “only that one”: ಇಲ್ಲಿಯೇ, right here and nowhere else. One small sound doing the work English needs a whole separate word for.

What you’ve built

Five: ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ, ಹೆಚ್ಚು, ಕಡಿಮೆ, ಬೇಡ, ಅಷ್ಟೇ. You can answer an offer five ways.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *aṣṭē*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *aṣṭē*, as though closing a list

Before you move on

What does ಅಷ್ಟೇ mean? (“that’s all, just that”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 59

Weather and Ground

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name the weather and the ground under it in Kannada, from the wind to the fire.

Complete KA-C59-fire and say all five words in order.

59.1 ಗಾಳಿ (gāḷi) — wind, air

Before the new run: what did *bēḍa* mean, and what did *aṣṭē* mean?

You'll want to know: ಗಾಳಿ

ಗಾಳಿ (*gāḷi*) — “wind, air”.

Inherited, and it holds the moving wind and the still air on one shape. ಗಾಳಿ ಬರುತ್ತಿದೆ is a breeze coming up; ಗಾಳಿ ಇಲ್ಲ in a shut room is that there is no air in it.

Now put it beside the weather-word you already have. ಹವಾಮಾನ was built from a Persian piece meaning air and a Sanskrit piece meaning measure — a borrowed air-word for the forecast on the radio. ಗಾಳಿ is the air on your face. The formal report and the thing itself ended up in different layers of the language, and a Kannada speaker moves between them without noticing.

ಗಾಳಿ also carries rumour, the way English talks about something being in the air.

What you've built

The first of five things the weather does to the ground.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *gāḷi*
- it once more, slowly
- *gāḷi*, then *havāmāna*, and say which of the two you can feel

Before you move on

What does ಗಾಳಿ mean? (“wind, air”.) Say it once more.

59.2 ಮಂಜು (mañju) — mist, fog, frost

Before the new one: what did *gāḷi* mean?

You'll want to know: ಮಂಜು

ಮಂಜು (*mañju*) — “mist, fog, frost”.

One word for cold water in the air, however it arrives: the fog on a ಬೆಟ್ಟ before sunrise, the mist in a valley, the frost on a leaf at dawn. Kannada did not think the difference worth a second word, which tells you something about the climate it grew up in — the state has hill country and coast and dry plain, and none of it has much use for a snow vocabulary.

The Kodagu and Chikkamagaluru hills are where this word lives hardest. Coffee country sits high enough that ಮಂಜು is what the mornings are made of for months at a stretch.

Held up beside ಮೋಡ the pair is tidy: the ಮೋಡ is the water overhead, the ಮಂಜು is the same water come down to stand among the trees.

What you've built

Two, and the second is the first one's water at ground level.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mañju*
- it once more, slowly
- *mōḍa*, then *mañju*, and say which of them you can walk into

Before you move on

What does ಮಂಜು mean? (“mist, fog, frost”.) Say it once more.

59.3 ಮರಳು (maraḷu) — sand

Before the new one: what did *mañju* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಮರಳು

ಮರಳು (*maraḷu*) — “sand”.

Read it slowly and you will see ಮರ standing at the front of it. Do not trust that. The tree-word and the sand-word are separate items that happen to begin alike, and a learner who joins them has invented an etymology. Kannada has plenty of real ones; this is not one, and knowing when to stop is part of the skill.

What ಮರಳು genuinely does share is a shape with a doing-word. ಮರಳು also means to turn back, to return — so the same run of letters is both the sand on a river bed and the act of going home. In a chapter about taking your leave that is a happy accident and nothing more, but it is the kind of accident worth noticing, because the two are told apart by nothing except what sits around them.

The ಮರಳು you meet most is on the bank of a ನದಿ, where the river drops what it has been carrying.

What you’ve built

Three, and one warning about reading too much into a spelling.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *maralu*
- it once more, slowly
- *marā*, then *maralu*, and say why they are not relatives

Before you move on

What does ಮರಳು mean? (“sand”.) Say it once more.

59.4 ಕೆಸರು (kesaru) — mud

Before the new one: what did *maralu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಕೆಸರು

ಕೆಸರು (*kesaru*) — “mud”.

Inherited, and unavoidable. From June onward the ಮಳೆಗಾಲ turns every ದಾರಿ that is not paved into ಕೆಸರು, and a ಹಳ್ಳಿ measures the season by how much of it there is between the house and the road.

It is also the mud a rice field wants. Paddy is planted into standing water and soft ground, so ಕೆಸರು is not a complaint in a farmer’s mouth the way it is in a city one — the ರೈತ needs it, and a dry season without it is the bad outcome.

Then, as everywhere, it goes figurative. To throw ಕೆಸರು at somebody is to smear their name, and Kannada arrived at that picture on its own, from a place where mud is genuinely at hand for half the year.

What you’ve built

Four, and this one the season makes.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kesaru*

- it once more, slowly
- *maralu*, then *kesaru*, and say which one the rain makes

Before you move on

What does ಕೆಸರು mean? (“mud”.) Say it once more.

59.5 ಬೆಂಕಿ (benki) — fire

Before the new one: what did *kesaru* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಬೆಂಕಿ

ಬೆಂಕಿ (*benki*) — “fire”.

Kannada’s own, and once again it stands apart from its sisters: Tamil reaches for *neruppu*, Telugu for *manṭa*, and Kannada for ಬೆಂಕಿ. The bone-word did this to you a chapter ago. Being close relatives has never obliged four languages to agree.

The ದೀಪ from the asking-chapter needs this word before it is any use, and so does the ಬಿಸಿ under ಬಿಸಿಲು. Fire is the thing the ಗಾಳಿ feeds and the ಕೆಸರು puts out.

And with ಬೆಂಕಿ the run closes the way it opened, on something you can point at. ಆಕಾಶ was overhead and out of reach; this one is on the floor of the kitchen, close enough to warm your hands at.

What you’ve built

Five: ಗಾಳಿ, ಮಂಜು, ಮರಳು, ಕೆಸರು, ಬೆಂಕಿ. Air, water, ground and the thing that undoes all three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *benki*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *dīpa* and *benki*, and say which one needs the other

Before you move on

What does ဃိဝံဒိ mean? (“fire”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 60

Animals of the House

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five animals a Kannada household lives with, from the cow to the bird.

Complete KA-C60-bird and say all five words in order.

60.1 ಹಸು (hasu) — a cow

Before the new run: what did *kesaru* mean, and what did *benki* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹಸು

ಹಸು (*hasu*) — “a cow”.

ಹಸು is inherited, and it is the animal a Karnataka household is built around. The ಹಾಲು you met in the drinks chapter comes out of it, and most of what a Kannada kitchen makes begins with what comes out of it.

It belongs to the ರೈತ before it belongs to anybody, and in a ಹಳ್ಳಿ it is tied in the yard rather than kept in a shed, close enough to the ಬಾಗಿಲು that you step around it going in.

What you've built

The first of five animals.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hasu*
- it once more, slowly
- *hasu*, then *hālu*, and say which one comes out of the other

Before you move on

What does ಹಸು mean? (“a cow”.) Say it once more.

60.2 ಮೇಕೆ (mēke) — a goat

Before the new one: what did *hasu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಮೇಕೆ

ಮೇಕೆ (*mēke*) — “a goat”.

ಮೇಕೆ is shared right across the family — Telugu says it almost exactly the same way — and it names the animal that goes where the ಹಸು does not.

A ಹಸು is walked to flat ground. A ಮೇಕೆ is let up a ಬೆಟ್ಟ, and it will strip the ಎಲೆ off a low ಕೊಂಬೆ standing on its back legs to reach. That difference is the whole reason a household keeps both.

What you’ve built

Two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mēke*
- it once more, slowly
- *hasu*, then *mēke*, and say which one climbs

Before you move on

What does ಮೇಕೆ mean? (“a goat”.) Say it once more.

60.3 ಕೋಳಿ (kōḷi) — a hen

Before the new one: what did *mēke* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಕೋಳಿ

ಕೋಳಿ (*kōḷi*) — “a hen”.

ಕೋಳಿ is the domestic fowl, hen or cock alike; the word does not divide them, and where the difference matters a second word goes in front of it.

It is also the clock of the ಹಳ್ಳಿ. A ಕೋಳಿ wakes a house before ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ is properly under way, which is a large part of why nobody there needed a ಗಂಟೆ to do the same job.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kōḷi*
- it once more, slowly
- *kōḷi*, then *beḷagge*, and say which one comes first

Before you move on

What does ಕೋಳಿ mean? (“a hen”.) Say it once more.

60.4 ಕಾಗೆ (kāge) — a crow

Before the new one: what did *kōḷi* mean?

You'll want to know: ಕಾಗೆ

ಕಾಗೆ (*kāge*) — “a crow”.

ಕಾಗೆ is an imitation word: the bird is named for the noise it makes, and the same trick produced the crow-word in each of the sister languages. Once you hear one you have the etymology.

Of all the birds in this chapter it is the one a household actually deals with day to day. Cooked rice set out on a step at the back of the house is put there for the ಕಾಗೆ, and it arrives within the minute.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kāge*
- it once more, slowly
- *kāge*, then *kōli*, and say which one is kept and which one turns up

Before you move on

What does ಕಾಗೆ mean? (“a crow”.) Say it once more.

60.5 ಹಕ್ಕಿ (hakki) — a bird

Before the new one: what did *kāge* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹಕ್ಕಿ

ಹಕ್ಕಿ (*hakki*) — “a bird”.

ಹಕ್ಕಿ is the general one: any bird at all, the ಕೋಳಿ and the ಕಾಗೆ both inside it. It is Kannada's own, and it sits beside a borrowed word that covers the same ground more formally — the arrangement you already saw when ಸ್ನೇಹಿತ turned out to have ಗೆಲಿಯ living quietly beside it.

One warning before you say it out loud. Written in our letters, *hakki* is *akki* with an *h* on the front, and ಅಕ್ಕಿ is the raw rice from the water-and-rice

chapter. In Kannada letters they start differently and there is no danger; in a romanization there is. Say the *h*.

What you've built

Five: ಹಸು, ಮೇಕೆ, ಕೋಳಿ, ಕಾಗೆ, ಹಕ್ಕಿ. Enough to greet a house and name what lives in it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hakki*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *namaskāra* to whoever keeps them

Before you move on

What does ಹಕ್ಕಿ mean? (“a bird”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 61

In the Kitchen

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five things in a Kannada kitchen, from the curd to the sugar.

Complete KA-C61-sugar and say all five words in order.

61.1 ಮೊಸರು (mosaru) — curd

Before the new run: what did *kāge* mean, and what did *hakki* mean?

You'll want to know: ಮೊಸರು

ಮೊಸರು (*mosaru*) — “curd”.

ಮೊಸರು is what ಹಾಲು becomes when it is left overnight with a spoonful of yesterday's ಮೊಸರು in it. The ಹಸು from the last chapter is the front of that chain and this is the end of it.

It closes a meal rather than opening one. ಮೊಸರು over ಅನ್ನ is the last thing on the plate, and a Kannada speaker will tell you the meal is not finished without it.

What you've built

The first of five things in a Kannada kitchen.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mosaru*
- it once more, slowly
- *hālu*, then *mosaru*, and say which one waits overnight

Before you move on

What does ಮೊಸರು mean? (“curd”.) Say it once more.

61.2 ತುಪ್ಪ (tuppa) — ghee

Before the new one: what did *mosaru* mean?

You’ll want to know: ತುಪ್ಪ

ತುಪ್ಪ (*tuppa*) — “ghee”.

ತುಪ್ಪ is the other thing ಹಾಲು turns into, further along the same road: cream taken off, churned, then cooked until only the fat is left. Inherited, and shared with the sisters.

A spoonful goes on hot ಅನ್ನ, and a ದೀಪ will burn on it as readily as on any oil. It is the one item in this chapter that is food and light at once.

What you’ve built

Two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *tuppa*
- it once more, slowly
- *mosaru*, then *tuppa*, and say which one is poured

Before you move on

What does ತುಪ್ಪ mean? (“ghee”.) Say it once more.

61.3 ಎಣ್ಣೆ (eṇṇe) — oil

Before the new one: what did *tuppa* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಎಣ್ಣೆ

ಎಣ್ಣೆ (*eṇṇe*) — “oil”.

ಎಣ್ಣೆ is Kannada’s own oil-word, and it owes ತುಪ್ಪ nothing at all. ತುಪ್ಪ comes out of an animal; ಎಣ್ಣೆ is pressed out of a ಬೀಜ, and the two sit in different jars on the same shelf.

There is a small joke in this for you. The friend-word ಸ್ನೇಹಿತ was built on a Sanskrit word whose first sense was oil — smoothness, the thing that makes two surfaces run easily on each other. That is the borrowed, figurative oil. This is the one in the jar.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *eṇṇe*
- it once more, slowly
- *tuppa*, then *eṇṇe*, and say which one starts as a seed

Before you move on

What does ಎಣ್ಣೆ mean? (“oil”.) Say it once more.

61.4 ಬೆಲ್ಲ (bella) — jaggery

Before the new one: what did *eṇṇe* mean?

You'll want to know: ಬೆಲ್ಲ

ಬೆಲ್ಲ (*bella*) — “jaggery”.

ಬೆಲ್ಲ is cane juice boiled down and set in a lump, brown and sticky and sold by weight rather than by the spoon. Kannada's own word, and the older of the two sweet things in this chapter.

South Karnataka cooking puts a piece of it into food that is not a sweet at all — into the same dish as the *uppu* you already have, deliberately, so that neither taste wins. A cook who leaves it out is making somebody else's version of the dish.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bella*
- it once more, slowly
- *bella*, then *uppu*, and say which two go into the same pot

Before you move on

What does ಬೆಲ್ಲ mean? (“jaggery”.) Say it once more.

61.5 ಸಕ್ಕರೆ (sakkare) — sugar

Before the new one: what did *bella* mean?

You'll want to know: ಸಕ್ಕರೆ

ಸಕ್ಕರೆ (*sakkare*) — “sugar”.

ಸಕ್ಕರೆ is the refined one, white and loose, and it is the traveller of this chapter. It goes back to a Sanskrit word meaning gravel or grit — a fair description of what sugar looks like beside a lump of ಬೆಲ್ಲ.

The coffee-word and the tea-word each reached Kannada after a long journey inward. This word went the other way. It left India, crossed Arabic

and Latin, turned into the English *sugar*, and Kannada kept the original at home the whole time.

What you've built

Five: ಮೊಸರು, ತುಪ್ಪ, ಎಣ್ಣೆ, ಬೆಲ್ಲ, ಸಕ್ಕರೆ. Enough to say what is in the food you are given.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *sakkare*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then give your name to the person cooking

Before you move on

What does ಸಕ್ಕರೆ mean? (“sugar”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 62

Things People Make

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name five things a Kannada household keeps to hand, and ask politely for one.

Complete KA-C62-umbrella and say all five words in order.

62.1 ನೂಲು (nūlu) — thread, yarn

Before the new run: what did *bella* mean, and what did *sakkare* mean?

You'll want to know: ನೂಲು

ನೂಲು (nūlu) — “thread, yarn”.

ನೂಲು is inherited, and it is the stuff ಬಟ್ಟೆ is made of. Everything worn in the cloth chapter began here.

The same shape does double duty: ನೂಲು is the thread and it is equally the spinning of it, so one word covers the material and the making. Kannada does that often, and you will start to expect it.

What you've built

The first of five things a household makes or keeps.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nūlu*
- it once more, slowly
- *nūlu*, then *batte*, and say which one comes first

Before you move on

What does ಸೂಲು mean? (“thread, yarn”.) Say it once more.

62.2 ಸೂಜಿ (sūji) — a needle

Before the new one: what did *nūlu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಸೂಜಿ

ಸೂಜಿ (*sūji*) — “a needle”.

ಸೂಜಿ is what the ಸೂಲು is put through. It is a borrowing from the north, and it arrived early enough that nothing about it feels foreign now.

It is also the hand of a clock. A ಗಂಟೆ has two ಸೂಜಿ on its face, and Kannada saw the resemblance before anybody thought to give the hands a separate name.

What you’ve built

Two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *sūji*
- it once more, slowly
- *nūlu*, then *sūji*, and say which one goes through the other

Before you move on

What does ಸೂಜಿ mean? (“a needle”.) Say it once more.

62.3 ಹಗ್ಗ (hagga) — a rope

Before the new one: what did *sūji* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹಗ್ಗ

ಹಗ್ಗ (*hagga*) — “a rope”.

ಹಗ್ಗ is ನೂಲು grown up: strands laid together until the result will hold weight. Native, with nothing borrowed anywhere in it.

In a ಹಳ್ಳಿ yard it is the thing at the end of which the ಹಸು stands. Twist it thinner and it ties a ಬುಟ್ಟಿ shut; twist it thicker and it draws water out of a ಕೆರೆ.

What you've built

Three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hagga*
- it once more, slowly
- *nūlu*, then *hagga*, and say which one holds a cow

Before you move on

What does ಹಗ್ಗ mean? (“a rope”.) Say it once more.

62.4 ಪೊರಕೆ (porake) — a broom

Before the new one: what did *hagga* mean?

You'll want to know: ಪೊರಕೆ

ಪೊರಕೆ (*porake*) — “a broom”.

ಪೊರಕೆ is a bundle of stiff ribs tied at one end — no handle, so it is used bent over, in short strokes.

It is the first object of the day. The ground outside the ಬಾಗಿಲು is swept with a ಪೊರಕೆ before the ರಂಗೋಲಿ is set out on it, because the pattern needs clean ground to sit on. Sweeping, then drawing: that order is fixed.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *porake*
- it once more, slowly
- *porake*, then *rangoli*, and say which one comes first

Before you move on

What does ಪೊರಕೆ mean? (“a broom”.) Say it once more.

62.5 ಕೊಡೆ (koḍe) — an umbrella

Before the new one: what did *porake* mean?

You'll want to know: ಕೊಡೆ

ಕೊಡೆ (*koḍe*) — “an umbrella”.

ಕೊಡೆ works twice over in Karnataka: it keeps the ಮಳೆಗಾಲ off you, and it keeps the ಬಿಸಿಲು off you in the months on either side of it. In a Kannada street both uses are ordinary.

Read it carefully. ಕೊಡೆ and the ಕೊಡು you already know start with the same two letters, and they are separate items — one is a thing, the other is what you do with it, and joining them would be inventing a story. Kannada gives you plenty of real ones; this is not one.

Put ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು in front of any of this chapter's five and you have asked for it properly.

What you've built

Five: ನೂಲು, ಸೂಜಿ, ಹಗ್ಗ, ಪೊರಕೆ, ಕೊಡೆ. Enough to ask a household politely for the thing you need.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *koḍe*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *dayavittu* in front of the one you want

Before you move on

What does ಕೊಡೆ mean? (“an umbrella”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 63

Hunger, Sleep and Health

Modes:  voice (5)  Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say in Kannada how my body is, from hunger to health, and ask it back.

Complete KA-C63-health and say all five words in order.

63.1 ಹಸಿವು (hasivu) — hunger

Before the new run: what did *porake* mean, and what did *kode* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹಸಿವು

ಹಸಿವು (*hasivu*) — “hunger”.

ಹಸಿವು is the naming-word made out of the everyday word for going hungry, and it takes a shape you have had since the knowing-sentence: ನನಗೆ ಹಸಿವು. The ನನಗೆ in front, the thing standing plain, and nothing joining them.

That is the whole design. Hunger happens to you in Kannada rather than being something you have, and the sentence is built to say so.

It begins like ಹಸು and has nothing to do with cows. Two words can share an opening and share no history at all.

What you've built

The first of five words for how a body is.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hasivu*
- it once more, slowly
- *hasivu*, then *nanage hasivu*, and say who is hungry

Before you move on

What does ಹಸಿವು mean? (“hunger”.) Say it once more.

63.2 ನಿಡ್ಡೆ (nidde) — sleep

Before the new one: what did *hasivu* mean?

You’ll want to know: ನಿಡ್ಡೆ

ನಿಡ್ಡೆ (*nidde*) — “sleep”.

ನಿಡ್ಡೆ is a Sanskrit word worn smooth by everyday use — the original had a hard cluster in the middle that Kannada softened into the doubled sound you hear now.

It takes the same frame ಹಸಿವು took: ನನಗೆ ನಿಡ್ಡೆ. Learn one of these sentences and you have the shape for the rest of the chapter, which is why they are grouped.

What you’ve built

Two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nidde*
- it once more, slowly
- *hasivu*, then *nidde*, and say which one a night fixes

Before you move on

What does ನಿದ್ರೆ mean? (“sleep”.) Say it once more.

63.3 ಜ್ವರ (jvara) — a fever

Before the new one: what did *nidde* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಜ್ವರ

ಜ್ವರ (*jvara*) — “a fever”.

ಜ್ವರ came in from Sanskrit whole, cluster and all, and Kannada did not smooth this one — which tells you it arrived through books and doctors rather than through kitchens.

It is the word you hand a ವೈದ್ಯ first. ನನಗೆ ಜ್ವರ, with the same three pieces as the last two lessons, and you have said the most useful sentence in the chapter.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *jvara*
- it once more, slowly
- *jvara*, then *vaidya*, and say which one you go to

Before you move on

What does ಜ್ವರ mean? (“a fever”.) Say it once more.

63.4 ನೋವು (nōvu) — pain

Before the new one: what did *jvara* mean?

You'll want to know: ನೋವು

ನೋವು (*nōvu*) — “pain”.

ನೋವು is inherited, and it is the most useful word here because it attaches to everything you already have. ತಲೆ ನೋವು, ಹೊಟ್ಟೆ ನೋವು, ಹಲ್ಲು ನೋವು, ಬೆನ್ನು ನೋವು — the body part goes in front and the whole thing is one compound.

Every part of the body this book has taught you can be put in that slot. That is a sentence for every body part this book has given you, out of one new word, which is the best trade in the chapter.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nōvu*
- it once more, slowly
- *nōvu*, then *tale nōvu*, then *hotṭe nōvu*, and say where it hurts

Before you move on

What does ನೋವು mean? (“pain”.) Say it once more.

63.5 ಆರೋಗ್ಯ (ārōgya) — health

Before the new one: what did *nōvu* mean?

You'll want to know: ಆರೋಗ್ಯ

ಆರೋಗ್ಯ (*ārōgya*) — “health”.

ಆರೋಗ್ಯ is Sanskrit, and it is built the negative way round: a piece meaning being unwell, with a *not* fixed on the front of it. Health is named by what is missing rather than by what is there.

It gives you a better answer than you had. ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? has been answered with ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ since the how-are-you chapter, which says you are doing well. ಆರೋಗ್ಯ says the body itself is sound, and it is the word a ವೈದ್ಯ wants.

What you've built

Five: ಹಸಿವು, ನಿದ್ರೆ, ಜ್ವರ, ನೋವು, ಆರೋಗ್ಯ. Enough to say how you are and to ask it back.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ārōgya*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *nīvu hēgiddīrā* to whoever asked you first

Before you move on

What does ಆರೋಗ್ಯ mean? (“health”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 64

Joining Words

Modes: ⇄ voice (5) ⇄ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can join one Kannada answer to the next five ways, from afterwards to in that case.

Complete KA-C64-in-that-case and say all five words in order.

64.1 ಆಮೇಲೆ (āmēle) — afterwards, later

Before the new run: what did *nōvu* mean, and what did *ārōgya* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಆಮೇಲೆ

ಆಮೇಲೆ (āmēle) — “afterwards, later”.

ಆಮೇಲೆ opens with the same far-pointing ಆ that stands at the front of ಅದು and ಅಲ್ಲಿ. Not this one, not here — that one, over there, and here it is time rather than place: not now, later.

Put it in front of a farewell you already own and you have a new one. ಆಮೇಲೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ sits beside ಮತ್ತೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ and ನಾಳೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ, three ways of promising the same thing with different amounts of commitment.

What you’ve built

The first of five words that join one thing to the next.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *āmēle*
- it once more, slowly
- *āmēle*, then *matte sigōṇa*, and say which one leaves the time open

Before you move on

What does ಆಮೇಲೆ mean? (“afterwards, later”.) Say it once more.

64.2 ಕೂಡ (kūḍa) — also, too

Before the new one: what did *āmēle* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಕೂಡ

ಕೂಡ (*kūḍa*) — “also, too”.

ಕೂಡ goes after the word it adds, not in front of it: ನಾನು ಕೂಡ, me as well. English puts *also* almost anywhere in a sentence; Kannada puts this one straight behind the thing it is including and leaves it there.

The same shape carries the idea of coming together, which is where the adding sense comes from — two things joined, and the second one mentioned.

Take care with the middle letter. ಕೂಡ and ಕೂದಲು from the body chapter open alike and then part company, and in a rough spelling they can look closer than they are.

What you’ve built

Two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kūḍa*
- it once more, slowly
- *nānu*, then *nānu kūḍa*, and say which one adds somebody

Before you move on

What does ಕೂಡ mean? (“also, too”.) Say it once more.

64.3 ಇನ್ನೂ (innū) — still, yet

Before the new one: what did *kūḍa* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಇನ್ನೂ

ಇನ್ನೂ (*innū*) — “still, yet”.

ಇನ್ನೂ is the word for a thing that has not stopped or has not started. With ಇಲ್ಲ behind it you get *not yet*, which is the single most useful thing in this chapter.

It stacks with the measuring words from the replies chapter. ಇನ್ನೂ ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ is a little more still; ಇನ್ನೂ ಹೆಚ್ಚು is more than that again. One word in front and your five replies have doubled.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *innū*
- it once more, slowly
- *svalpa*, then *innū svalpa*, and say which one asks for more

Before you move on

What does ಇನ್ನೂ mean? (“still, yet”.) Say it once more.

64.4 ಬೇಗ (bēga) — soon, quickly

Before the new one: what did *innū* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಬೇಗ

ಬೇಗ (*bēga*) — “soon, quickly”.

ಬೇಗ is inherited, and it holds hurry and nearness-in-time on one shape. ಬೇಗ ಬಾ is *come quickly* and equally *come soon*, and which one is meant is settled by everything around it rather than by the word.

Set it against *īga*, the now-word from the leave-taking chapter. *īga* is this moment. ಬೇಗ is a moment that has not arrived but will not keep you waiting. They rhyme and are unrelated, which by now should surprise you less than it did.

What you’ve built

Four.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bēga*
- it once more, slowly
- *īga*, then *bēga*, and say which one has not happened yet

Before you move on

What does ಬೇಗ mean? (“soon, quickly”.) Say it once more.

64.5 ಹಾಗಾದರೆ (*hāgādare*) — in that case, then

Before the new one: what did *bēga* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಹಾಗಾದರೆ

ಹಾಗಾದರೆ (*hāgādare*) — “in that case, then”.

ಹಾಗಾದರೆ is built out of ಹಾಗಿ, the *that way* word from the earlier replies chapter, with an *if it becomes* wrapped around it. If it is that way — in that case.

It is the word that lets you answer a fact with a decision. Somebody says the shop is shut; you say ಹಾಗಾದರೆ ಆಮೇಲೆ, and with two of this chapter’s five words you have made a plan without a single naming-word in it.

What you've built

Five: ಅಮೇಲೆ, ಕೂಡ, ಇನ್ನೂ, ಬೇಗ, ಹಾಗಾದರೆ. Enough to keep a conversation moving without answering yes or no.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hāgādare*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *hāge*, then *hāgādare*, and say which came from which

Before you move on

What does ಹಾಗಾದರೆ mean? (“in that case, then”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 65

More Good Manners

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name what Kannada courtesy is made of, from a request to good manners.

Complete KA-C65-manners and say all five words in order.

65.1 ವಿನಂತಿ (vinanti) — a request

Before the new run: what did *bēga* mean, and what did *hāgādare* mean?

You’ll want to know: ವಿನಂತಿ

ವಿನಂತಿ (*vinanti*) — “a request”.

ವಿನಂತಿ is the naming-word for the thing ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು has been doing for you since the please-chapter. ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು is how you make one; ವಿನಂತಿ is what you have made.

Sanskrit, and its shape says *a bending* — the asker lowers himself a little, and that is exactly the difference between a ವಿನಂತಿ and an instruction.

What you’ve built

The first of five courtesy words.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *vinanti*
- it once more, slowly
- *dayavittu*, then *vinanti*, and say which one goes inside a sentence

Before you move on

What does ವಿನಂತಿ mean? (“a request”.) Say it once more.

65.2 ಅನುಮತಿ (anumati) — permission

Before the new one: what did *vinanti* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಅನುಮತಿ

ಅನುಮತಿ (*anumati*) — “permission”.

ಅನುಮತಿ is Sanskrit for a mind that goes along with you — agreement given rather than merely not refused.

It belongs with ಹೊರಡು from the leave-taking chapter. In a Kannada house you do not simply set out; you ask ಅನುಮತಿ of whoever is host, and only then do you say ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ. The farewell you learned early has this word standing in front of it.

What you’ve built

Two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *anumati*
- it once more, slowly
- *anumati*, then *horaḍu*, and say which one comes first

Before you move on

What does ಅನುಮತಿ mean? (“permission”.) Say it once more.

65.3 ಸಂಕೋಚ (saṅkōca) — hesitancy, holding back

Before the new one: what did *anumati* mean?

You'll want to know: ಸಂಕೋಚ

ಸಂಕೋಚ (*saṅkōca*) — “hesitancy, holding back”.

ಸಂಕೋಚ is Sanskrit for a drawing-in, a shrinking — and in Kannada it names the polite reluctance that stops you accepting what you actually want.

It is the one word in this chapter you will hear said to you rather than by you. A host feeding an *atithi* says ಸಂಕೋಚ ಬೇಡ, using the refusal-word from the replies chapter to refuse your refusal. Hearing it is the signal to eat.

What you've built

Three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *saṅkōca*
- it once more, slowly
- *saṅkōca*, then *bēḍa*, and say what a host tells a guest

Before you move on

What does ಸಂಕೋಚ mean? (“hesitancy, holding back”.) Say it once more.

65.4 ನಂಬಿಕೆ (nambike) — trust

Before the new one: what did *saṅkōca* mean?

You'll want to know: ನಂಬಿಕೆ

ನಂಬಿಕೆ (*nambike*) — “trust”.

ನಂಬಿಕೆ is native, made out of the everyday word for believing, and it covers both trust in a person and belief in a thing being so.

Set it beside ಗೌರವ from the courtesy chapter. ಗೌರವ can be given to a stranger at once, because it is owed to a position. ನಂಬಿಕೆ has to be collected slowly, and no amount of the first turns into the second.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nambike*
- it once more, slowly
- *gaurava*, then *nambike*, and say which one is earned slowly

Before you move on

What does ನಂಬಿಕೆ mean? (“trust”.) Say it once more.

65.5 ಸೌಜನ್ಯ (saujanya) — courtesy, good manners

Before the new one: what did *nambike* mean?

You'll want to know: ಸೌಜನ್ಯ

ಸೌಜನ್ಯ (*saujanya*) — “courtesy, good manners”.

ಸೌಜನ್ಯ is Sanskrit, and underneath it is *a good person* — courtesy named as a quality of the one behaving rather than as a list of rules being followed. That is a real difference, and Kannada means it.

It is the word for everything this book has been quietly teaching alongside the vocabulary: ಧನ್ಯವಾದ, ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು, ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ, ಗೌರವ, ವಂದನೆ, and now the four words in front of this one. ಸೌಜನ್ಯ is the name of the whole habit.

What you've built

Five: ವಿನಂತಿ, ಅನುಮತಿ, ಸಂಕೋಚ, ನಂಬಿಕೆ, ಸೌಜನ್ಯ. Enough to name what you have been doing since the thank-you word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *saujanya*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *dhanyavāda* to close

Before you move on

What does ಸೌಜನ್ಯ mean? (“courtesy, good manners”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 66

The Field

Modes: 🗣️ voice (5) 🗣️ Hands-free start: all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a Kannada field and its crop, and take my leave of the village that grew it.

Complete KA-C66-harvest and say all five words in order.

66.1 ಹೊಲ (hola) — a field

Before the new run: what did *nambike* mean, and what did *saujanya* mean?

You'll want to know: ಹೊಲ

ಹೊಲ (*hola*) — “a field”.

ಹೊಲ is inherited, and it is the dry field — ground that is ploughed and planted and waits on the ಮಳೆಗಾಲ for its water.

It lies past the edge of the ಹಳ್ಳಿ, along the ದಾರಿ you learned to ask for, and it is where the ರೈತ is when he is not at home.

What you've built

The first of five field words.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hola*

- it once more, slowly
- *hola*, then *raita*, and say which one works the other

Before you move on

What does ಹೊಲ mean? (“a field”.) Say it once more.

66.2 ಹುಲ್ಲು (hullu) — grass

Before the new one: what did *hola* mean?

You’ll want to know: ಹುಲ್ಲು

ಹುಲ್ಲು (*hullu*) — “grass”.

ಹುಲ್ಲು is what comes up on ground nobody planted, and it is why the ಹಸು and the ಮೇಕೆ from the animal chapter are walked out of the yard at all.

Say it carefully against ಹಲ್ಲು, the tooth-word. One vowel sign separates them and the rest of the two words is identical. It is the closest pair this book has handed you, and the good news is that the ಹಸು eats the one with your teeth.

What you’ve built

Two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hullu*
- it once more, slowly
- *hallu*, then *hullu*, and say which one is in your mouth

Before you move on

What does ಹುಲ್ಲು mean? (“grass”.) Say it once more.

66.3 ಭತ್ತ (bhatta) — paddy, rice in the husk

Before the new one: what did *hullu* mean?

You'll want to know: ಭತ್ತ

ಭತ್ತ (*bhatta*) — “paddy, rice in the husk”.

ಭತ್ತ completes a set you have been assembling since the water-and-rice chapter. One plant, three names, and Kannada keeps them strictly apart: ಭತ್ತ standing in the ಹೊಲ, ಅಕ್ಕಿ once it is husked and in the sack, ಅನ್ನ once it is cooked and on the plate.

English makes do with *rice* for all three and adds a word when it must. Kannada gives each stage its own name, and a speaker who used the wrong one would be understood but marked as not from here.

What you've built

Three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bhatta*
- it once more, slowly
- *bhatta*, then *akki*, then *anna*, in that order

Before you move on

What does ಭತ್ತ mean? (“paddy, rice in the husk”.) Say it once more.

66.4 ಬೆಳೆ (bele) — a crop

Before the new one: what did *bhatta* mean?

You'll want to know: ಬೆಳೆ

ಬೆಳೆ (*bele*) — “a crop”.

ಬೆಳೆ is the general one: ಭತ್ತ is a ಬೆಳೆ, and so is everything else a ಹೊಲ is put to. Native, and made from the everyday word for growing — so the

same shape names the growing and the grown thing, the way ನೂಲು named the thread and the spinning.

The chain runs the length of this book by now. A ಬೀಜ goes into the ground, the ಮಳೆಗಾಲ arrives, and a ಬೆಳೆ stands in the ಹೊಲ.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *beḷe*
- it once more, slowly
- *bīja*, then *beḷe*, and say which one comes first

Before you move on

What does ಬೆಳೆ mean? (“a crop”.) Say it once more.

66.5 ಸುಗ್ಗಿ (suggi) — the harvest

Before the new one: what did *beḷe* mean?

You'll want to know: ಸುಗ್ಗಿ

ಸುಗ್ಗಿ (*suggi*) — “the harvest”.

ಸುಗ್ಗಿ is not only the cutting. It is the season, and it is the mood of the season — the stretch of weeks when the ಬೆಳೆ is in and there is enough, and Karnataka's harvest festival carries the word in its name.

So these five words end where a farming year does. It opened with ಮಳೆಗಾಲ in the seasons chapter, ran through the ಬೀಜ and the ಬೆಳೆ, and arrives at the ಸುಗ್ಗಿ with the ಹೊಲ empty and the house full.

Which makes this the right place to take your leave of the ಹಳ್ಳಿ. You can name what it grows now, and thank the people who grew it.

What you've built

Five: ಹೊಲ, ಹುಲ್ಲು, ಭತ್ತ, ಬೆಳೆ, ಸುಗ್ಗಿ. A field, what grows on it, and the season that takes it in.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *suggi*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *hōgi baruttēne*

Before you move on

What does ಸುಗ್ಗಿ mean? (“the harvest”.) Say it once more.

The Kannada script — a reference

Not to be read before the lessons — they teach reading through real words, each letter introduced as a word needs it. This page just gathers the system.

The three facts

1. **Consonants carry a built-in “a.”** ಕ = ka, ಮ = ma, ರ = ra.
2. **A vowel sign changes that built-in vowel.** ಕಾ = kā, ಕಿ = ki, ಕೀ = kī, ಕು = ku, ಕೂ = kū, ಕೆ = ke, ಕೇ = kē, ಕೊ = ko, ಕೋ = kō, ಕೌ = kau.
3. **A *virama* strips the built-in vowel, and the bare consonant *stacks under the next* as a conjunct (*ottakṣara*):** ನೆ + ಕೆ → ನ್ಕೆ (ska), ನೆ + ಯೆ → ನ್ಯೆ (nya), ಲ + ಲ → ಳ (lla). This stacking is a signature of the Kannada–Telugu scripts.

Independent vowels (word-initial)

ಅ a · ಆ ā · ಇ i · ಈ ī · ಉ u · ಊ ū · ಎ e · ಏ ē · ಐ ai · ಒ o · ಓ ō · ಔ au.

Worth flagging

- **Aspiration is written.** ಕೆ k / ಖೆ kh, ದೆ d / ಧೆ dh — the “h” is a real puff. (Unlike Tamil, Kannada keeps separate letters for the Sanskrit aspirates and voiced stops, because it borrowed so many Sanskrit words.)
- **Round forms.** Kannada letters are rounded and looping — developed for writing on palm-leaf, where straight strokes would split the leaf. Telugu, its closest script-sister, shares the look.

Kannada in the Dravidian family

Kannada is one of the four literary **Dravidian** languages (with Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam) — a family entirely separate from the Indo-European one (English, Latin, Sanskrit). It shares the grammar and much native vocabulary with its sisters, but — like Telugu, and unlike Tamil — it borrowed *heavily* from Sanskrit. The lessons trace, word by word, which Kannada words are home-grown (*haudu*, *illa*, *sari*) and which came from Sanskrit (*namaskāra*, *dhanyavāda*).

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

-ಗೆ *-ge*

the dative suffix *-ge*, 'to / for,' and its family sound history
Introduced in Chapter 6.

ಅದು *adu*

that one — the thing over there
Introduced in Chapter 41.

ಅಜ್ಜ *ajja*

grandfather
Introduced in Chapter 45.

ಅಜ್ಜಿ *ajji*

grandmother
Introduced in Chapter 45.

ಆಕಾಶ *ākāśa*

the sky
Introduced in Chapter 53.

ಅಲ್ಲಿ *alli*

there — where I am not
Introduced in Chapter 41.

ಆಮೇಲೆ *āmēle*

afterwards, later
Introduced in Chapter 64.

ಅನುಮತಿ *anumati*

permission
Introduced in Chapter 65.

ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ *aparāhna*

“afternoon” (*aparāhna*) — a genuine Sanskrit tatsama distinct from ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ/
madhyāhna (“noon”), sharing its “-ahna” (“day”) suffix; *apara* (“latter”) vs
madhya (“middle”), the same clean structure applied to two different day-parts
Introduced in Chapter 28.

ಆರೋಗ್ಯ *ārōgya*

health

Introduced in Chapter 63.

ಅರ್ಥಮಾಡಿಕೊ *arthamāḍiko*

to understand — “meaning, having done, take for yourself,” three pieces in a row, and the ending that hands an action back to its doer

Introduced in Chapter 33.

ಆಶೀರ್ವಾದ *āśīrvāda*

a blessing

Introduced in Chapter 51.

ಅಷ್ಟೇ *aṣṭē*

that’s all, just that

Introduced in Chapter 58.

ಅತಿಥಿ *atithi*

a guest

Introduced in Chapter 48.

ಬಾ *bā*

come

Introduced in Chapter 43.

ಬಾ *bā / baru*

come — the form you call the verb by is not the form the beads attach to

Introduced in Chapter 32.

ಬಾಗಿಲು *bāgilu*

a door

Introduced in Chapter 52.

ಬಹುಶಃ *bahuśaḥ*

perhaps

Introduced in Chapter 49.

ಬರೆ *bare*

to write, to draw — an old Dravidian word for scratching a line, and the third proof of the sound law that gave Kannada its b

Introduced in Chapter 33.

ಬರೆ *bare*

write

Introduced in Chapter 44.

ಬಟ್ಟೆ *baṭṭe*

cloth

Introduced in Chapter 46.

ಬಾಯಿ *bāyi*

mouth — a word this book has already shown you twice, in two sound-law tables, without ever saying what it means

Introduced in Chapter 37.

ಬೇಡ *bēḍa*

no thank you, I don't want it
Introduced in Chapter 58.

ಬೇಗ *bēga*

soon, quickly
Introduced in Chapter 64.

ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ *beḷagge*

“morning” (beḷagge) — genuine native Dravidian, from beḷagu (“to shine, to dawn”) + beḷaku (“light”); unlike Kannada's Sanskrit tatsama day/night/noon words (dina, ratri, madhyāhna), this one is Kannada's own
Introduced in Chapter 26.

ಬೆಳೆ *beḷe*

a crop
Introduced in Chapter 66.

ಬೆಲ್ಲ *bella*

jaggery
Introduced in Chapter 61.

ಬೆಂಕಿ *beniki*

fire
Introduced in Chapter 59.

ಬೆನ್ನು *bennu*

the back
Introduced in Chapter 57.

ಬೆರಳು *beraḷu*

a finger
Introduced in Chapter 47.

ಬೇರು *bēru*

a root
Introduced in Chapter 54.

ಬೆಟ್ಟ *beṭṭa*

a hill
Introduced in Chapter 55.

ಭತ್ತ *bhatta*

paddy, rice in the husk
Introduced in Chapter 66.

ಭುಜ *bhuja*

the shoulder
Introduced in Chapter 57.

ಬೀಜ *bīja*

a seed
Introduced in Chapter 54.

ಬೀಳ್ಕೊಡುಗೆ *biḷkoḍuge*

a send-off, a farewell

Introduced in Chapter 50.

ಬಿಸಿಲು *bisilu*

sunshine, the sun's heat

Introduced in Chapter 53.

ಬುಟ್ಟಿ *butṭi*

a basket

Introduced in Chapter 56.

ಚಹಾ *cahā*

tea — a word that travelled overland from China through Persia before it ever reached Kannada, the same road Chapter 20's weather-word took

Introduced in Chapter 39.

ಚಾಕು *cāku*

a knife

Introduced in Chapter 56.

ಚಂದ್ರ *candra*

the moon

Introduced in Chapter 53.

ಚಾಪೆ *cāpe*

a mat

Introduced in Chapter 56.

ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ *cennāgi*

well, nicely — and the reply “ನಾನು ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ”

Introduced in Chapter 3.

ಚಿಕ್ಕ *cikka*

small

Introduced in Chapter 42.

ಚುಕ್ಕಿ *cukki*

a star; a dot

Introduced in Chapter 53.

ದಾರಿ *dāri*

a way, a path

Introduced in Chapter 55.

ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು *dayaviṭṭu*

please (dayaviṭṭu — “having placed compassion,” from ದಯ *daya* “compassion”)

Introduced in Chapter 8.

ಧನ್ಯವಾದ *dhanyavāda*

thank you (dhanyavāda — “an utterance of 'worthy'”)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

ದಿನ *dina*

day” — a Sanskrit tatsama word, kept whole and unworn, unlike Hindi’s own eroded din; Kannada also has a real native Dravidian word, hagalu, but it means specifically “daytime,” not “a day
Introduced in Chapter 23.

ದೀಪ *dīpa*

a lamp
Introduced in Chapter 46.

ದೊಡ್ಡ *dodḍa*

big
Introduced in Chapter 42.

ಎಲೆ *ele*

a leaf
Introduced in Chapter 54.

ಎಲ್ಲಿ *elli*

where? — asking about a place
Introduced in Chapter 41.

ಎಣ್ಣೆ *eṇṇe*

oil
Introduced in Chapter 61.

ಏನು *ēnu*

what
Introduced in Chapter 2.

ಗಾಳಿ *gāli*

wind, air
Introduced in Chapter 59.

ಗಂಡ *gaṇḍa*

husband
Introduced in Chapter 45.

ಗಂಟಿ *gaṇṭe*

hour — the SAME Sanskrit “bell” word behind Hindi’s ghaṇṭā, borrowed via Prakrit
Introduced in Chapter 18.

ಗೌರವ *gaurava*

respect
Introduced in Chapter 51.

ಗೊತ್ತು *gottu*

known — the chapter’s closer, a know-word with no stem, no tense and no person, so the knower has to sit outside the verb
Introduced in Chapter 32.

ಹಾಗಾದರೆ *hāgādare*

in that case, then

Introduced in Chapter 64.

ಹಾಗೆ *hāge*

that way, just so

Introduced in Chapter 49.

ಹಗ್ಗ *hagga*

a rope

Introduced in Chapter 62.

ಹಕ್ಕಿ *hakki*

a bird

Introduced in Chapter 60.

ಹಳೆಯ *halēya*

old — of a thing, not of a person

Introduced in Chapter 42.

ಹಳ್ಳಿ *halli*

a village

Introduced in Chapter 55.

ಹಲ್ಲು *hallu*

a tooth

Introduced in Chapter 47.

ಹಾಲು *hālu*

milk — a word Chapter 32 already used, unexplained, as one of its four proof-pairs for the sound law that made Kannada sound like Kannada

Introduced in Chapter 39.

ಹಣ್ಣು *haṇṇu*

a fruit

Introduced in Chapter 46.

ಹಸಿರು, ಹಳದಿ *hasiru haḷadi*

green and yellow — *hasiru* is genuine pan-Dravidian, sharing its Proto-Dravidian root with Tamil's *paccai* and Telugu's *pacca*; *haḷadi* is a Sanskrit/Hindi loan built on the word for turmeric, and traces back to the SAME ancient PIE root already behind Hindi's *harā* (green) and German's *gelb* (yellow)

Introduced in Chapter 22.

ಹಸಿವು *hasivu*

hunger

Introduced in Chapter 63.

ಹಸು *hasu*

a cow

Introduced in Chapter 60.

ಹೌದು *haudu*

yes (haudu)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

ಹವಾಮಾನ *havāmāna*

weather — a Persian+Sanskrit HYBRID compound: hava (“air,” from Persian/Arabic) + maana (“measure,” Sanskrit)

Introduced in Chapter 20.

ಹೆಚ್ಚು *heccu*

more, a lot

Introduced in Chapter 58.

ಹೇಗೆ *hēge*

how

Introduced in Chapter 3.

ಹೆಂಡತಿ *heṇḍati*

wife

Introduced in Chapter 45.

ಹೆಸರು *hesaru*

name

Introduced in Chapter 2.

ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ *hōgi baruttēne*

goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”)

Introduced in Chapter 4.

ಹೋಗು *hōgu*

to go (and ಬಾ, come)

Introduced in Chapter 4.

ಹೋಗು *hōgu*

to go — and the one sound-law that separates Kannada from all three of its sisters

Introduced in Chapter 32.

ಹೊಲ *hola*

a field

Introduced in Chapter 66.

ಹೊರಡು *horaḍu*

to set out

Introduced in Chapter 50.

ಹೊಸ *hosa*

new

Introduced in Chapter 42.

ಹೊಟ್ಟೆ *hoṭṭe*

the stomach, the belly

Introduced in Chapter 47.

ಹೃದಯ *hṛdaya*

heart — a Sanskrit word that is, astonishingly, a genuine cousin of the English one
Introduced in Chapter 38.

ಹುಲ್ಲು *hullu*

grass

Introduced in Chapter 66.

ಹೂಮಾಲೆ *hūmāle*

a garland

Introduced in Chapter 52.

ಹೂವು *hūvu*

a flower

Introduced in Chapter 52.

ಇದು *idu*

this one — the thing near me

Introduced in Chapter 41.

ಈಗ *iga*

now

Introduced in Chapter 50.

ಇಲ್ಲ *illa*

no / there isn't (illa — the negative)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

ಇಲ್ಲಿ *illi*

here — where I am

Introduced in Chapter 41.

ಇನ್ನೂ *innū*

still, yet

Introduced in Chapter 64.

ಇರು *iru*

to be, to exist, to stay — and the three-piece machine every Kannada verb is built on

Introduced in Chapter 32.

ಇರು *iru*

to be, to stay, to live

Introduced in Chapter 5.

ಜ್ವರ *jvara*

a fever

Introduced in Chapter 63.

ಕಡಿಮೆ *kadime*

less, fewer

Introduced in Chapter 58.

ಕಾಗೆ *kāge*

a crow

Introduced in Chapter 60.

ಕಾಲು *kālu*

leg, foot

Introduced in Chapter 47.

ಕಣ್ಣು *kaṇṇu*

eye — matching Telugu almost letter for letter, and Tamil and Malayalam nearly as closely

Introduced in Chapter 37.

ಕಾಫಿ *kāphi*

coffee — a word that crossed Arabic, Turkish, Dutch and English before it ever reached Kannada, the longest chain of loans in this book

Introduced in Chapter 39.

ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡು *kelasa māḍu*

to work (lit. “work-do”)

Introduced in Chapter 5.

ಕೇಳು *kēḷu*

listen

Introduced in Chapter 44.

ಕೇಳು *kēḷu*

to ask, and equally to hear — one Kannada verb doing two jobs English keeps apart, and Telugu does too

Introduced in Chapter 34.

ಕೆರೆ *kere*

a tank, a reservoir

Introduced in Chapter 55.

ಕೆಸರು *kesaru*

mud

Introduced in Chapter 59.

ಖಂಡಿತ *khaṇḍita*

certainly

Introduced in Chapter 49.

ಕಿವಿ *kivi*

ear — matching Tamil and Telugu’s literary word, where everyday spoken Tamil actually reaches for a different one

Introduced in Chapter 37.

ಕೊಡೆ *koḍe*

an umbrella

Introduced in Chapter 62.

ಕೊಡು *koḍu*

give

Introduced in Chapter 43.

ಕೋಳಿ *kōḷi*

a hen

Introduced in Chapter 60.

ಕೊಂಬೆ *kombe*

a branch

Introduced in Chapter 54.

ಕೃತಜ್ಞತೆ *kṛtajñate*

gratitude

Introduced in Chapter 51.

ಕೂಡ *kūḍa*

also, too

Introduced in Chapter 64.

ಕೂದಲು *kūdalu*

hair

Introduced in Chapter 47.

ಕುಳಿತುಕೋ *kuḷitukō*

sit

Introduced in Chapter 43.

ಕುರ್ಚಿ *kurci*

a chair

Introduced in Chapter 52.

ಕುತ್ತಿಗೆ *kuttige*

the neck

Introduced in Chapter 57.

ಕುಟುಂಬ *kuṭumba*

family — the collective word Chapter 12's parents and siblings never needed, because each of them was already the name of one specific person

Introduced in Chapter 35.

ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ *madhyāhna madhyarātri*

noon and midnight — both direct Sanskrit tatsama compounds built on the SAME “middle” root, madhya

Introduced in Chapter 17.

ಮಗ *maga*

son — the same root as “child,” with its ending changed

Introduced in Chapter 36.

ಮಗಳು *magalu*

daughter — one more ending on the same root, where Chapter 12 needed four whole words to do a similar job

Introduced in Chapter 36.

ಮಗು *magu*

baby, child — gender-neutral, and the root that the next two lessons split by gender

Introduced in Chapter 36.

ಮಂಜು *mañju*

mist, fog, frost

Introduced in Chapter 59.

ಮರ *marā*

a tree

Introduced in Chapter 54.

ಮರಳು *maralu*

sand

Introduced in Chapter 59.

ಮಾತಾಡು *mātāḍu*

speak

Introduced in Chapter 44.

ಮಾತನಾಡು *mātanāḍu*

to speak

Introduced in Chapter 5.

ಮತ್ತೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ *matte sigōṇa*

we'll meet again

Introduced in Chapter 4.

ಮೇಕೆ *mēke*

a goat

Introduced in Chapter 60.

ಮೋಡ *mōḍa*

a cloud

Introduced in Chapter 53.

ಮೊಸರು *mosaru*

curd

Introduced in Chapter 61.

ಮೂಗು *mūgu*

nose — matching Tamil and Malayalam closely, with Telugu the odd one out this time

Introduced in Chapter 37.

ಮೂಳೆ *mūḷe*

a bone

Introduced in Chapter 57.

ನದಿ *nadi*

a river

Introduced in Chapter 55.

ನಾಡಿದ್ದು *nāḍiddu*

the day after tomorrow

Introduced in Chapter 50.

ನಾಳೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ *nāḷe sigōṇa*

see you tomorrow

Introduced in Chapter 4.

ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ *namaskāra*

hello / greetings (namaskāra — “a making of a bow”)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

ನೆಂಬಿಕೆ *nambike*

trust

Introduced in Chapter 65.

ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು *nanage kannada gottu*

‘I know Kannada’ — built with no subject, because knowing happens TO you

Introduced in Chapter 6.

ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಇಷ್ಟ *nanage kannada iṣṭa*

‘I like Kannada’ — a sentence with no verb anywhere in it, the liker pushed into the dative and the liked thing left standing plain

Introduced in Chapter 34.

ನನ್ನ *nanna*

my

Introduced in Chapter 2.

ನಾನು *nānu*

I

Introduced in Chapter 3.

ನಿದ್ನೆ *nidde*

sleep

Introduced in Chapter 63.

ನಿಜ *nija*

true

Introduced in Chapter 49.

ನಿಲ್ಲು *nilḷu*

stand

Introduced in Chapter 43.

ನೀನು / ನೀವು *nīnu / nīvu*

you (familiar / respectful)

Introduced in Chapter 2.

ನೀರು ಅಕ್ಕಿ ಅನ್ನ *nīru akki anna*

water (matching Tamil’s neer, unlike Malayalam), and rice raw/cooked

Introduced in Chapter 15.

ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? *nīvu hēgiddirā*

how are you? (respectful)

Introduced in Chapter 3.

ನೋಡು *nōḍu*

look

Introduced in Chapter 44.

ನೋಡು *nōḍu*

to see, to look — the third slot, and the one everyday word the four sisters do NOT share

Introduced in Chapter 32.

ನೋವು *nōvu*

pain

Introduced in Chapter 63.

ನೂಲು *nūlu*

thread, yarn

Introduced in Chapter 62.

ಓದು *ōdu*

to read, to study — an inherited Dravidian word that once meant reciting aloud, and that Kannada alone kept in the everyday job

Introduced in Chapter 33.

ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ *olleya*

good

Introduced in Chapter 42.

ಒಂದು ಎರಡು ಮೂರು ನಾಲ್ಕು ಐದು *ondu eraḍu mūru nālku aidu*

one to five — the same Dravidian numbers as Tamil, with a Kannada accent

Introduced in Chapter 7.

ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ *paravāgilla*

it's okay / no problem / you're welcome

Introduced in Chapter 3.

ಪಾತ್ರೆ *pātre*

a vessel, a cooking pot

Introduced in Chapter 56.

ಪೆಟ್ಟಿಗೆ *petṭige*

a box

Introduced in Chapter 56.

ಪೊರಕೆ *porake*

a broom

Introduced in Chapter 62.

ಪ್ರಯಾಣ *prayāṇa*

a journey

Introduced in Chapter 50.

ಪುಸ್ತಕ *pustaka*

a book

Introduced in Chapter 46.

ರೈತ *raita*

a farmer

Introduced in Chapter 48.

ರಂಗೋಲಿ *raṅgōli*

the pattern drawn at a doorway

Introduced in Chapter 52.

ರಾತ್ರಿ *rātri*

“night” — the same Sanskrit tatsama word already hiding inside madhyarātri;

Kannada’s real native Dravidian word, *irulu*, has been pushed into archaism,

unlike *hagalu*’s living daytime sense

Introduced in Chapter 24.

ಸಹಾಯ ಮಾಡು *sahāya māḍu*

to help — literally “help-do,” a Sanskrit noun in front of a native Dravidian verb,
and the single most useful thing you can say to a stranger

Introduced in Chapter 34.

ಸಕ್ಕರೆ *sakkare*

sugar

Introduced in Chapter 61.

ಸಾಕು *sāku*

enough

Introduced in Chapter 49.

ಸಂಜೆ *sañje*

“evening” (*sañje*) — borrowed from Maharashtri Prakrit *sañjhā*, itself from

Sanskrit *संध्या* (*saṃdhyā*); a striking cross-family convergence with Hindi’s *साँझ* /

sañjh, same Sanskrit root, arriving via a DIFFERENT sister Prakrit dialect

Introduced in Chapter 27.

ಸಂಕೋಚ *saṅkōca*

hesitancy, holding back

Introduced in Chapter 65.

ಸಂತೋಷ *santōṣa*

joy / pleased to meet you

Introduced in Chapter 2.

ಸರಿ *sari*

okay / alright / correct (*sari*)

Introduced in Chapter 1.

ಸೌಜನ್ಯ *saujanya*

courtesy, good manners

Introduced in Chapter 65.

ಶಿಕ್ಷಕ *śikṣaka*

a teacher

Introduced in Chapter 48.

ಸ್ನೇಹಿತ *snēhita*

friend — built on the Sanskrit word for oil, sitting beside a native Dravidian word that means exactly the same thing

Introduced in Chapter 35.

ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ *śubha madhyāhna*

“good afternoon” (śubha madhyāhna) — reuses ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ, KA-C17’s “noon” word, not the more precise ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ from KA-C28; one directly-fetched source describes it leaning formal/workplace, though this wasn’t cross-corroborated the way

ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ’s universal, any-time-of-day status was

Introduced in Chapter 31.

ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ *śubha rātri*

good night” — literally “auspicious night,” pairing rātri (already met) with shubha, a word that started life meaning “to be beautiful

Introduced in Chapter 25.

ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ *śubha sañje*

“good evening” (śubha sañje) — pairs with ಸಂಜೆ, already established (KA-C27) as Sanskrit-via-Prakrit, NOT native Dravidian, whatever an unverified claim you might encounter elsewhere says; leans formal, with ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ likely covering casual use, echoing (with real hedging) the formal-skew question already raised for

ಸುಪ್ರಭಾತ and ಶುಭೋದಯ

Introduced in Chapter 30.

ಶುಭೋದಯ *śubhōdaya*

“good morning” (śubhōdaya) — śubha (“good”) + udaya (“rising, sunrise,” ← ud- “up” + i “to go”), a DIFFERENT root from ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ; sources conflict on its everyday spoken commonality, but the more careful ones describe it skewing formal/

written, similar to Hindi’s सुप्रभात, with ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ likely covering casual mornings

Introduced in Chapter 29.

ಸುಗ್ಗಿ *suggi*

the harvest

Introduced in Chapter 66.

ಸೂಜಿ *sūji*

a needle

Introduced in Chapter 62.

ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ *svalpa*

a little, a bit

Introduced in Chapter 58.

ತೆಗೆದುಕೊ *tegeduko*

to take — “having pulled it out, keep it for yourself,” a two-verb design all three Dravidian sisters share where English has one flat word

Introduced in Chapter 34.

ತಿನ್ನು *tinnu*

to eat — and the middle bead, which carries the past but does not bother to separate the future
Introduced in Chapter 32.

ತುಪ್ಪ *tuppa*

ghee
Introduced in Chapter 61.

ತುಟಿ *tuti*

a lip
Introduced in Chapter 57.

ಉಪಕಾರ *upakāra*

a good turn, a favour
Introduced in Chapter 51.

ಉಪ್ಪು *uppu*

salt
Introduced in Chapter 46.

ಊಟ *ūṭa*

a meal — the word Chapter 32 already used to explain what “eating” doesn’t cover, without ever teaching it, and the word that sits at the hour of two greetings you already know
Introduced in Chapter 40.

ವೈದ್ಯ *vaidya*

a doctor
Introduced in Chapter 48.

ವಂದನೆ *vandane*

a salutation
Introduced in Chapter 51.

ವಿದ್ಯಾರ್ಥಿ *vidyārthi*

a student
Introduced in Chapter 48.

ವಿನಂತಿ *vinanti*

a request
Introduced in Chapter 65.

ಯಾರು *yāru*

who? — asking about a person
Introduced in Chapter 41.

ಯೋಚಿಸು *yōcisu*

to think — a Sanskrit noun wearing Kannada’s own verb-making suffix, beside the inherited root Kannada kept for remembering
Introduced in Chapter 33.

ಅಪ್ಪ ಅಮ್ಮ ಅಣ್ಣ ತಮ್ಮ ಅಕ್ಕ ತಂಗಿ

father, mother, and four age-graded sibling words — nearly identical to Tamil's own set

Introduced in Chapter 12.

ಆರು ಏಳು ಎಂಟು ಒಂಬತ್ತು ಹತ್ತು

six to ten — and the sound-change that turns Tamil p- into Kannada h-

Introduced in Chapter 7.

ಕಪ್ಪು ಬಿಳಿ ಕೆಂಪು ನೀಲಿ

black, white, red, blue — Kannada's own basic colors, and the same shared Sanskrit blue

Introduced in Chapter 11.

ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ

forgive me / sorry (kṣamisi — imperative of kṣamisu, “to forgive,” from Sanskrit kṣamā)

Introduced in Chapter 9.

ಚೈತ್ರ ವೈಶಾಖ ಜ್ಯೇಷ್ಠ ಆಷಾಢ ಶ್ರಾವಣ ಭಾದ್ರಪದ ಅಶ್ವಯುಜ ಕಾರ್ತಿಕ ಮಾರ್ಗಶಿರ ಪುಷ್ಯ ಮಾಘ ಫಾಲ್ಗುಣ

the twelve lunisolar months — NOT Kannada's own calendar like Tamil/Malayalam's, but the same pan-Indian Sanskritic system Hindi's Vikram Samvat uses

Introduced in Chapter 16.

ತಲೆ ಕೈ

head and hand — native Dravidian, matching Tamil/Malayalam closely

Introduced in Chapter 13.

ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ

I speak Kannada

Introduced in Chapter 5.

ನಿನ್ನ ವಯಸ್ಸು ಎಷ್ಟು?

how old are you? — literally “your age how-much?”; ವಯಸ್ಸು is a Sanskrit loan, distant cousin of Latin's own vis

Introduced in Chapter 19.

ನನ್ನ ಹೆಸರು ...

my name is... (with no “is”)

Introduced in Chapter 2.

ನಿಮ್ಮ ಹೆಸರು ಏನು?

what's your name?

Introduced in Chapter 2.

ನಾಯಿ, ಬೆಕ್ಕು

dog and cat — naayi is a solid, ancient native Dravidian root, no mystery at all; bekku is a DIFFERENT ancient Dravidian “wildcat” root, distinct from Tamil's everyday word for cat

Introduced in Chapter 21.

ವಸಂತ ಋತು ಬೇಸಿಗೆ ಮಳೆಗಾಲ ಚಳಿಗಾಲ

spring, summer, monsoon, winter — native heat/rain/cold words, one shared Sanskrit “spring”

Introduced in Chapter 14.

ಸೋಮವಾರ ಮಂಗಳವಾರ ಬುಧವಾರ ಗುರುವಾರ ಶುಕ್ರವಾರ ಶನಿವಾರ ಭಾನುವಾರ

the seven weekdays — fully Sanskritic, like Hindi, but Sunday uses a DIFFERENT sun-name

Introduced in Chapter 10.

ಹನ್ನೊಂದು — ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು

11-20 — additive “ten-echo” compounds for the teens, then ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು (20), compositionally “two-tens” from OLD Dravidian roots — though the pieces have shifted enough that it no longer looks like the MODERN words eraḍu/hattu on the surface

Introduced in Chapter 20.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 6

6.1 -೨ — *one suffix, one job*

Why is Kannada called agglutinative?

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 6

6.1 -ŕ — *one suffix, one job*

Answer: it stacks visible pieces with one job each

Also accepted: it stacks visible pieces each with one job; it stacks one-job pieces

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

0–9

11-20 — additive “ten-echo” compounds for the teens, then ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು (20), compositionally “two-tens” from OLD Dravidian roots — though the pieces have shifted enough that it no longer looks like the MODERN words eraḍu/hattu on the surface ಹನ್ನೊಂದು — ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 20, p. 93

A

a basket ಬುಟ್ಟಿ (buṭṭi)
Chapter 56, p. 257

a bird ಹಕ್ಕಿ (hakki)
Chapter 60, p. 281

a blessing ಆಶೀರ್ವಾದ (āśīrvāda)
Chapter 51, p. 227

a bone ಮೂಳೆ (mūḷe)
Chapter 57, p. 263

a book ಪುಸ್ತಕ (pustaka)
Chapter 46, p. 197

a box ಪೆಟ್ಟಿಗೆ (peṭṭige)
Chapter 56, p. 257

a branch ಕೊಂಬೆ (kombe)
Chapter 54, p. 245

a broom ಪೊರಕೆ (porake)
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- a chair** ಕುರ್ಚಿ (kurci)
Chapter 52, p. 233
- a cloud** ಮೋಡ (mōḍa)
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- a cow** ಹಸು (hasu)
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- a crop** ಬೆಳೆ (beḷe)
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- a crow** ಕಾಗೆ (kāge)
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- a doctor** ವೈದ್ಯ (vaidya)
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- a door** ಬಾಗಿಲು (bāgilu)
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- a farmer** ರೈತ (raitā)
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- a fever** ಜ್ವರ (jvara)
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- a field** ಹೊಲ (hola)
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- a finger** ಬೆರಳು (beraḷu)
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- a flower** ಹೂವು (hūvu)
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- a fruit** ಹಣ್ಣು (haṇṇu)
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- a garland** ಹೂಮಾಲೆ (hūmāle)
Chapter 52, p. 233
- a goat** ಮೇಕೆ (mēke)
Chapter 60, p. 281
- a good turn, a favour** ಉಪಕಾರ (upakāra)
Chapter 51, p. 227
- a guest** ಅತಿಥಿ (atithi)
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- a hen** ಕೋಳಿ (kōḷi)
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- a hill** ಬೆಟ್ಟ (beṭṭa)
Chapter 55, p. 251
- a journey** ಪ್ರಯಾಣ (prayāṇa)
Chapter 50, p. 221
- a knife** ಚಾಕು (cāku)
Chapter 56, p. 257

a lamp ದೀಪ (dīpa)

Chapter 46, p. 197

a leaf ಎಲೆ (ele)

Chapter 54, p. 245

a lip ತುಟಿ (tuṭi)

Chapter 57, p. 263

a little, a bit ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ (svalpa)

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a mat ಚಾಪೆ (cāpe)

Chapter 56, p. 257

A Meal

chapter topic; Chapter 40, p. 171

a meal — the word Chapter 32 already used to explain what “eating” doesn’t cover, without ever teaching it, and the word that sits at the hour of two greetings you already

know ಊಟ (ūṭa)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 40, p. 171

a needle ಸೂಜಿ (sūji)

Chapter 62, p. 293

a request ವಿನಂತಿ (vinanti)

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a river ನದಿ (nadi)

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a root ಬೇರು (bēru)

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a rope ಹಗ್ಗ (hagga)

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a student ವಿದ್ಯಾರ್ಥಿ (vidyārthi)

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a tank, a reservoir ಕೆರೆ (kere)

Chapter 55, p. 251

a teacher ಶಿಕ್ಷಕ (śikṣaka)

Chapter 48, p. 209

a tooth ಹಲ್ಲು (hallu)

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a tree ಮರ (mara)

Chapter 54, p. 245

a vessel, a cooking pot ಪಾತ್ರೆ (pātre)

Chapter 56, p. 257

a village ಹಳ್ಳಿ (halli)

Chapter 55, p. 251

a way, a path ದಾರಿ (dāri)

Chapter 55, p. 251

Afternoon

chapter topic; Chapter 28, p. 113

“afternoon” (aparāhna) — a genuine Sanskrit tatsama distinct from ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ/madhyāhna (“noon”), sharing its “-ahna” (“day”) suffix; apara (“latter”) vs madhya (“middle”), the same clean structure applied to two different day-parts ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ (aparāhna)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 28, p. 113

afterwards, later ಆಮೇಲೆ (āmēle)

Chapter 64, p. 305

also, too ಕೂಡ (kūḍa)

Chapter 64, p. 305

an umbrella ಕೊಡೆ (koḍe)

Chapter 62, p. 293

Animals of the House

chapter topic; Chapter 60, p. 281

Answering With More Than Yes

chapter topic; Chapter 49, p. 215

Asking Someone’s Age

chapter topic; Chapter 19, p. 89

B

baby, child — gender-neutral, and the root that the next two lessons split by gender ಮಗು (magu)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 153

before the noun, unchanged — five words, one rule

grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 42, p. 179

big ದೊಡ್ಡ (doḍḍa)

Chapter 42, p. 179

black, white, red, blue — Kannada’s own basic colors, and the same shared Sanskrit blue ಕಪ್ಪು ಬಿಳಿ ಕೆಂಪು ನೀಲಿ

Chapter 11, p. 55

C

Case Endings and Dative Subjects

chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 23

certainly ಖಂಡಿತ (khaṇḍita)

Chapter 49, p. 215

cloth ಬಟ್ಟೆ (baṭṭe)

Chapter 46, p. 197

coffee — a word that crossed Arabic, Turkish, Dutch and English before it ever reached Kannada, the longest chain of loans in this**book** ಕಾಫಿ (kāphi)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 39, p. 165

come ಬಾ (bā)

Chapter 43, p. 185

come — the form you call the verb by is not the form the beads**attach to** ಬಾ (bā / baru)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 32, p. 121

courtesy, good manners ಸೌಜನ್ಯ (saujanya)

Chapter 65, p. 311

Courtesy Words

chapter topic; Chapter 51, p. 227

curd ಮೊಸರು (mosaru)

Chapter 61, p. 287

D

daughter — one more ending on the same root, where Chapter**12 needed four whole words to do a similar job** ಮಗಳು (magalu)

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 153

Day

chapter topic; Chapter 23, p. 103

day” — a Sanskrit tatsama word, kept whole and unworn, unlike Hindi’s own eroded din; Kannada also has a real native**Dravidian word, hagalu, but it means specifically “daytime,” not****”a day** ದಿನ (dina)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 23, p. 103

Days of the Week

chapter topic; Chapter 10, p. 49

Describing Things

chapter topic; Chapter 42, p. 179

Dog and Cat

chapter topic; Chapter 21, p. 99

dog and cat — naayi is a solid, ancient native Dravidian root, no mystery at all; bekku is a DIFFERENT ancient Dravidian “wildcat” root, distinct from Tamil’s everyday word for cat ನಾಯಿ, ಬೆಕ್ಕು

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 21, p. 99

E

ear — matching Tamil and Telugu’s literary word, where everyday spoken Tamil actually reaches for a different one ಕಿವಿ (kivi)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 157

enough ಸಾಕು (sāku)

Chapter 49, p. 215

Evening

chapter topic; Chapter 27, p. 111

“evening” (sañje) — borrowed from Maharashtri Prakrit sañjhā, itself from Sanskrit संध्या (saṃdhyā); a striking cross-family convergence with Hindi’s साँझ/sāñjh, same Sanskrit root, arriving via a DIFFERENT sister Prakrit dialect ಸಂಜೆ (sañje)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 27, p. 111

eye — matching Telugu almost letter for letter, and Tamil and Malayalam nearly as closely ಕಣ್ಣು (kaṇṇu)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 157

F

Family

chapter topic; Chapter 12, p. 59

Family and Friends

chapter topic; Chapter 35, p. 149

family — the collective word Chapter 12’s parents and siblings never needed, because each of them was already the name of one specific person ಕುಟುಂಬ (kuṭumba)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 149

Farewells

chapter topic; Chapter 4, p. 15

father, mother, and four age-graded sibling words — nearly identical to Tamil’s own set ಅಪ್ಪ ಅಮ್ಮ ಅಣ್ಣ ತಮ್ಮ ಅಕ್ಕ ತಂಗಿ

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 59

fire ಬೆಂಕಿ (benki)

Chapter 59, p. 275

forgive me / sorry (kṣamisi — imperative of kṣamisu, “to

forgive,” from Sanskrit kṣamā) ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 43

Four Core Colours

chapter topic; Chapter 11, p. 55

Four Verbs Between People

chapter topic; Chapter 34, p. 139

Four Verbs of Mind and Page

chapter topic; Chapter 33, p. 131

Four Words on the Face

chapter topic; Chapter 37, p. 157

friend — built on the Sanskrit word for oil, sitting beside a native Dravidian word that means exactly the same

thing ಸ್ನೇಹಿತ (snēhita)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 149

G

ghee ತುಪ್ಪ (tuppa)

Chapter 61, p. 287

give ಕೊಡು (koḍu)

Chapter 43, p. 185

good ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ (olḷeya)

Chapter 42, p. 179

Good Afternoon

chapter topic; Chapter 31, p. 119

“good afternoon” (śubha madhyāhna) — reuses ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ, KA-C17’s “noon” word, not the more precise ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ from KA-C28; one directly-fetched source describes it leaning formal/workplace, though this wasn’t cross-corroborated the way ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ’s universal, any-time-of-day status was ಶುಭ

ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (śubha madhyāhna)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 31, p. 119

Good Evening

chapter topic; Chapter 30, p. 117

“good evening” (śubha sañje) — pairs with ಸಂಜೆ, already established (KA-C27) as Sanskrit-via-Prakrit, NOT native Dravidian, whatever an unverified claim you might encounter elsewhere says; leans formal, with ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ likely covering casual use, echoing (with real hedging) the formal-skew question already raised for ಸುಪ್ರಭಾತ and ಶುಭೋದಯ ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ (śubha sañje)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 30, p. 117

Good Morning

chapter topic; Chapter 29, p. 115

“good morning” (śubhōdaya) — śubha (“good”) + udaya (“rising, sunrise,” ← ud- “up” + i “to go”), a DIFFERENT root from ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ; sources conflict on its everyday spoken commonality, but the more careful ones describe it skewing formal/written, similar to Hindi’s सुप्रभात, with ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ likely covering casual mornings ಶುಭೋದಯ (śubhōdaya)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 29, p. 115

Good Night

chapter topic; Chapter 25, p. 107

“good night” — literally “auspicious night,” pairing rātri (already met) with shubha, a word that started life meaning “to be beautiful ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ (śubha rātri)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 25, p. 107

goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”) ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ (hōgi baruttēne)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 15

grandfather ಅಜ್ಜ (ajja)

Chapter 45, p. 193

grandmother ಅಜ್ಜಿ (ajji)

Chapter 45, p. 193

grass ಹುಲ್ಲು (hullu)

Chapter 66, p. 317

gratitude ಕೃತಜ್ಞತೆ (kṛtajñate)

Chapter 51, p. 227

Green and Yellow

chapter topic; Chapter 22, p. 101

green and yellow — hasiru is genuine pan-Dravidian, sharing its Proto-Dravidian root with Tamil’s paccai and Telugu’s pacca; haladi is a Sanskrit/Hindi loan built on the word for turmeric, and traces back to the SAME ancient PIE root already behind Hindi’s harā (green) and German’s gelb (yellow) ಹಸಿರು, ಹಳದಿ (hasiru haḷadi)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 22, p. 101

Greetings

chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1

H

hair ಕೂದಲು (kūdalū)

Chapter 47, p. 203

Head and Hand

chapter topic; Chapter 13, p. 65

head and hand — native Dravidian, matching Tamil/Malayalam**closely ತಲೆ ಕೈ**

Chapter 13, p. 65

health ಆರೋಗ್ಯ (ārōgya)

Chapter 63, p. 299

heart — a Sanskrit word that is, astonishingly, a genuine cousin of the English one ಹೃದಯ (hr̥daya)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 38, p. 163

hello / greetings (namaskāra — “a making of a bow”) ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ (namaskāra)

explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

here — where I am ಇಲ್ಲಿ (illi)

Chapter 41, p. 173

hesitancy, holding back ಸಂಕೋಚ (saṅkōca)

Chapter 65, p. 311

hour — the SAME Sanskrit “bell” word behind Hindi’s ghantā, borrowed via Prakrit ಗಂಟೆ (gaṇṭe)

explicit focus: grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 18, p. 85

how ಹೇಗೆ (hēge)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 11

How Are You?

chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 11

how are you? (respectful) ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? (nīvu hēgiddīrā)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 11

how old are you? — literally “your age how-much?”; ವಯಸ್ಸು is a Sanskrit loan, distant cousin of Latin’s own vīs ನಿನ್ನ ವಯಸ್ಸು ಎಷ್ಟು?

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 19, p. 89

hunger ಹಸಿವು (hasivu)

Chapter 63, p. 299

Hunger, Sleep and Health

chapter topic; Chapter 63, p. 299

husband ಗಂಡ (gaṇḍa)

Chapter 45, p. 193

I**I ನಾನು (nānu)**

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 11

i- / a- / e- — six words, one machine

grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 41, p. 173

‘I know Kannada’ — built with no subject, because knowing

happens TO you ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು (nanage kannaḍa gottu)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 6, p. 23

‘I like Kannada’ — a sentence with no verb anywhere in it, the liker pushed into the dative and the liked thing left standing

plain ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಇಷ್ಟ (nanage kannaḍa iṣṭa)

explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 139

I speak Kannada ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 19

in that case, then ಹಾಗಾದರೆ (hāgāḍare)

Chapter 64, p. 305

In the House

chapter topic; Chapter 56, p. 257

In the Kitchen

chapter topic; Chapter 61, p. 287

Introducing Yourself

chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 7

it’s okay / no problem / you’re welcome ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ (paravāgilla)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 11

J

jaggery ಬೆಲ್ಲ (bella)

Chapter 61, p. 287

Joining Words

chapter topic; Chapter 64, p. 305

joy / pleased to meet you ಸಂತೋಷ (santōṣa)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 2, p. 7

K

known — the chapter’s closer, a know-word with no stem, no tense and no person, so the knower has to sit outside the verb ಗೊತ್ತು (gottu)

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 32, p. 121

L

leg, foot ಕಾಲು (kālu)

Chapter 47, p. 203

less, fewer ಕಡಿಮೆ (kaḍime)

Chapter 58, p. 269

listen ಕೇಳು (kēḷu)

Chapter 44, p. 189

look ನೋಡು (nōḍu)

Chapter 44, p. 189

M

milk — a word Chapter 32 already used, unexplained, as one of its four proof-pairs for the sound law that made Kannada sound like Kannada ಹಾಲು (hālu)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 165

mist, fog, frost ಮಂಜು (mañju)

Chapter 59, p. 275

more, a lot ಹೆಚ್ಚು (heccu)

Chapter 58, p. 269

More Everyday Verbs

chapter topic; Chapter 43, p. 185

More Good Manners

chapter topic; Chapter 65, p. 311

More of the Body

chapter topic; Chapter 57, p. 263

More Short Replies

chapter topic; Chapter 58, p. 269

Morning

chapter topic; Chapter 26, p. 109

“morning” (beḷagge) — genuine native Dravidian, from beḷagu (“to shine, to dawn”) + beḷaku (“light”); unlike Kannada’s

Sanskrit tatsama day/night/noon words (dina, ratri,

madhyāhna), this one is Kannada’s own ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ (beḷagge)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 26, p. 109

mouth — a word this book has already shown you twice, in two sound-law tables, without ever saying what it means ಬಾಯಿ (bāyi)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 157

mud ಕೆಸರು (kesaru)

Chapter 59, p. 275

my ನನ್ನ (nanna)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 7

my name is... (with no “is”) ನನ್ನ ಹೆಸರು ...

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 2, p. 7

N

name ಹೆಸರು (hesaru)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 7

Naming Who Someone Is

chapter topic; Chapter 48, p. 209

new ಹೊಸ (hosa)

Chapter 42, p. 179

Night

chapter topic; Chapter 24, p. 105

“night” — the same Sanskrit tatsama word already hiding inside madhyarātri; Kannada’s real native Dravidian word, irulu, has been pushed into archaism, unlike hagalu’s living daytime

sense ರಾತ್ರಿ (rātri)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 24, p. 105

no thank you, I don’t want it ಬೇಡ (bēḍa)

Chapter 58, p. 269

no / there isn’t (illa — the negative) ಇಲ್ಲ (illa)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

Noon and Midnight

chapter topic; Chapter 17, p. 81

noon and midnight — both direct Sanskrit tatsama compounds built on the SAME “middle” root, madhya ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ

ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ (madhyāhna madhyarātri)

explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 17, p. 81

nose — matching Tamil and Malayalam closely, with Telugu the odd one out this time ಮೂಗು (mūgu)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 157

now ಈಗ (īga)

Chapter 50, p. 221

Numbers 11–20 and Weather

chapter topic; Chapter 20, p. 93

Numbers One to Ten

chapter topic; Chapter 7, p. 31

O

oil ಎಣ್ಣೆ (eṇṇe)

Chapter 61, p. 287

okay / alright / correct (sari) ಸರಿ (sari)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

old — of a thing, not of a person ಹಳೆಯ (haḷeya)

Chapter 42, p. 179

ೞ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 31

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script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 31

ೞ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 37

ೞ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 9, p. 43

ೞ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 10, p. 49

ೞ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 13, p. 65

ೞ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 15, p. 73

ೞ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 19, p. 89

One Root, Three Endings

chapter topic; Chapter 36, p. 153

**one to five — the same Dravidian numbers as Tamil, with a
Kannada accent ಒಂದು ಎರಡು ಮೂರು ನಾಲ್ಕು ಐದು** (ondu eraḍu mūru
nālku aidu)

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 7, p. 31

P

paddy, rice in the husk ಭತ್ತ (bhatta)

Chapter 66, p. 317

pain ನೋವು (nōvu)

Chapter 63, p. 299

perhaps ಬಹುಶಃ (bahuśaḥ)

Chapter 49, p. 215

permission ಅನುಮತಿ (anumati)

Chapter 65, p. 311

Please

chapter topic; Chapter 8, p. 37

**please (dayaviṭṭu — “having placed compassion,” from ದಯೆ daya
“compassion”) ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು** (dayaviṭṭu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 8, p. 37

Pointing, and Asking

chapter topic; Chapter 41, p. 173

R

respect ಗೌರವ (gaurava)

Chapter 51, p. 227

River and Road

chapter topic; Chapter 55, p. 251

S

salt ಉಪ್ಪು (uppu)

Chapter 46, p. 197

sand ಮರಳು (maralu)

Chapter 59, p. 275

Seasons

chapter topic; Chapter 14, p. 69

see you tomorrow ನಾಳೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ (nāle sigōṇa)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 15

sit ಕುಳಿತುಕೋ (kūlitukō)

Chapter 43, p. 185

six to ten — and the sound-change that turns Tamil p- into

Kannada h- ಆರು ಏಳು ಎಂಟು ಒಂಬತ್ತು ಹತ್ತು

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 7, p. 31

sleep ನಿದ್ರೆ (nidde)

Chapter 63, p. 299

small ಚಿಕ್ಕ (cikka)

Chapter 42, p. 179

son — the same root as “child,” with its ending

changed ಮಗ (maga)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 153

soon, quickly ಬೇಗ (bēga)

Chapter 64, p. 305

Sorry

chapter topic; Chapter 9, p. 43

speak ಮಾತಾಡು (mātāḍu)

Chapter 44, p. 189

spring, summer, monsoon, winter — native heat/rain/cold

words, one shared Sanskrit “spring” ವಸಂತ ಋತು ಬೇಸಿಗೆ ಮಳೆಗಾಲ

ಚಳಿಗಾಲ

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 14, p. 69

stand ನಿಲ್ಲು (nillu)

Chapter 43, p. 185

still, yet ಇನ್ನೂ (innū)

Chapter 64, p. 305

sugar ಸಕ್ಕರೆ (sakkare)

Chapter 61, p. 287

sunshine, the sun's heat ಬಿಸಿಲು (bisilu)

Chapter 53, p. 239

T

Taking Your Leave

chapter topic; Chapter 50, p. 221

tea — a word that travelled overland from China through Persia before it ever reached Kannada, the same road Chapter 20's

weather-word took ಚಹಾ (cahā)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 165

Tea, Coffee, Milk

chapter topic; Chapter 39, p. 165

Telling Time

chapter topic; Chapter 18, p. 85

thank you (dhanyavāda — “an utterance of ‘worthy’”) ಧನ್ಯವಾದ (dhanyavāda)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

that one — the thing over there ಅದು (adu)

Chapter 41, p. 173

that's all, just that ಅಷ್ಟೇ (aṣṭē)

Chapter 58, p. 269

that way, just so ಹಾಗೆ (hāge)

Chapter 49, p. 215

the back ಬೆನ್ನು (bennu)

Chapter 57, p. 263

The Core Verbs

chapter topic; Chapter 32, p. 121

the dative suffix -ge, 'to / for,' and its family sound

history -ಗೆ (-ge)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 6, p. 23

the day after tomorrow ನಾಡಿದ್ದು (nāḍiddu)

Chapter 50, p. 221

The Field

chapter topic; Chapter 66, p. 317

The First Verbs

chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 19

the harvest ಸುಗ್ಗಿ (suggi)

Chapter 66, p. 317

The Heart

chapter topic; Chapter 38, p. 163

The Leg and the Tooth

chapter topic; Chapter 47, p. 203

the moon ಚಂದ್ರ (candra)

Chapter 53, p. 239

the neck ಕುತ್ತಿಗೆ (kuttige)

Chapter 57, p. 263

The Older Generation

chapter topic; Chapter 45, p. 193

the pattern drawn at a doorway ರಂಗೋಲಿ (raṅgōli)

Chapter 52, p. 233

the seven weekdays — fully Sanskritic, like Hindi, but Sunday

uses a DIFFERENT sun-name ಸೋಮವಾರ ಮಂಗಳವಾರ ಬುಧವಾರ

ಗುರುವಾರ ಶುಕ್ರವಾರ ಶನಿವಾರ ಭಾನುವಾರ

Chapter 10, p. 49

the shoulder ಭುಜ (bhuja)

Chapter 57, p. 263

The Sky

chapter topic; Chapter 53, p. 239

the sky ಆಕಾಶ (ākāśa)

Chapter 53, p. 239

the stomach, the belly ಹೊಟ್ಟೆ (hoṭṭe)

Chapter 47, p. 203

The Traditional Months

chapter topic; Chapter 16, p. 77

The Tree

chapter topic; Chapter 54, p. 245

the twelve lunisolar months — NOT Kannada's own calendar

like Tamil/Malayalam's, but the same pan-Indian Sanskritic

system Hindi's Vikram Samvat uses ಚೈತ್ರ ವೈಶಾಖ ಜ್ಯೇಷ್ಠ ಆಷಾಢ ಶ್ರಾವಣ

ಭಾದ್ರಪದ ಆಶ್ವಯುಜ ಕಾರ್ತಿಕ ಮಾರ್ಗಶಿರ ಪುಷ್ಯ ಮಾಘ ಫಾಲ್ಗುಣ

explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 77

there — where I am not ಅಲ್ಲಿ (alli)

Chapter 41, p. 173

Things People Make

chapter topic; Chapter 62, p. 293

Things You Ask For

chapter topic; Chapter 46, p. 197

this one — the thing near me ಇದು (idu)

Chapter 41, p. 173

thread, yarn ನೂಲು (nūlu)

Chapter 62, p. 293

to ask, and equally to hear — one Kannada verb doing two jobs

English keeps apart, and Telugu does too ಕೇಳು (kēḷu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 139

to be, to exist, to stay — and the three-piece machine every

Kannada verb is built on ಇರು (iru)

explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar; Chapter 32, p. 121

to be, to stay, to live ಇರು (iru)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 19

to eat — and the middle bead, which carries the past but does

not bother to separate the future ತಿನ್ನು (tinnu)

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 32, p. 121

**to go — and the one sound-law that separates Kannada from all
three of its sisters ಹೋಗು (hōgu)**

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 121

to go (and ಬಾ, come) ಹೋಗು (hōgu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 15

**to help — literally “help-do,” a Sanskrit noun in front of a native
Dravidian verb, and the single most useful thing you can say to a
stranger ಸಹಾಯ ಮಾಡು (sahāya māḍu)**

explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 139

**to read, to study — an inherited Dravidian word that once
meant reciting aloud, and that Kannada alone kept in the
everyday job ಓದು (ōḍu)**

explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 131

**to see, to look — the third slot, and the one everyday word the
four sisters do NOT share ನೋಡು (nōḍu)**

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 32, p. 121

to set out ಹೊರಡು (horaḍu)

Chapter 50, p. 221

to speak ಮಾತನಾಡು (mātanāḍu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 19

**to take — “having pulled it out, keep it for yourself,” a two-verb
design all three Dravidian sisters share where English has one
flat word ತೆಗೆದುಕೊ (tegeduko)**

explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 139

**to think — a Sanskrit noun wearing Kannada’s own verb-making
suffix, beside the inherited root Kannada kept for
remembering ಯೋಚಿಸು (yōcisu)**

explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 131

to understand — “meaning, having done, take for yourself,”

**three pieces in a row, and the ending that hands an action back
to its doer ಅರ್ಥಮಾಡಿಕೊ (arthamāḍiko)**

explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 131

to work (lit. “work-do”) ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡು (kelasa māḍu)

explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 19

to write, to draw — an old Dravidian word for scratching a line,
and the third proof of the sound law that gave Kannada its

b ಬರೆ (bare)

explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 131

true ನಿಜ (nija)

Chapter 49, p. 215

trust ನಂಬಿಕೆ (nambike)

Chapter 65, p. 311

V

Verbs of Seeing and Saying

chapter topic; Chapter 44, p. 189

W

Water and Rice

chapter topic; Chapter 15, p. 73

water (matching Tamil’s neer, unlike Malayalam), and rice raw/

cooked ನೀರು ಅಕ್ಕಿ ಅನ್ನ (nīru akki anna)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 15, p. 73

we’ll meet again ಮತ್ತೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ (matte sigōṇa)

explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 15

weather — a Persian+Sanskrit HYBRID compound: hava

(“air,” from Persian/Arabic) + maana (“measure,”

Sanskrit) ಹವಾಮಾನ (havāmāna)

explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 20, p. 93

Weather and Ground

chapter topic; Chapter 59, p. 275

Welcoming a Guest

chapter topic; Chapter 52, p. 233

well, nicely — and the reply “ನಾನು ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ” ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ (cennāgi)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 11

what ಏನು (ēnu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 7

what’s your name? ನಿಮ್ಮ ಹೆಸರು ಏನು?

explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 2, p. 7

where? — asking about a place ಎಲ್ಲಿ (elli)

Chapter 41, p. 173

who? — asking about a person ಯಾರು (yāru)

Chapter 41, p. 173

wife ಹೆಂಡತಿ (heṇḍati)

Chapter 45, p. 193

wind, air ಗಾಳಿ (gāḷi)

Chapter 59, p. 275

write ಬರೆ (bare)

Chapter 44, p. 189

Y

yes (haudu) ಹೌದು (haudu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

you (familiar / respectful) ನೀನು / ನೀವು (nīnu / nīvu)

explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 7

Other

ಇ — one character, met inside words you already say

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 11, p. 55

ಓ — one character, met inside a word you already say

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 34, p. 139

ಈ — one character, met inside words you already say

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 12, p. 59

ಀ — one character, met inside words you already say

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 37

-ಀ — one suffix, one job

grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 6, p. 23

ಚ — one character, met inside words you already say

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 18, p. 85

ಡ — one character, met inside words you already say

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 14, p. 69

ತ — one character, met inside words you already say

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 10, p. 49

ದ — one character, met inside words you already say

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 11, p. 55

ನ — one character, met inside words you already say

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 23

ಪ — one character, met inside words you already say

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 20, p. 93

ಬ — one character, met inside words you already say

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 23

ಯ — one character, met inside words you already say

script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 13, p. 65

- 𐑖 — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 12, p. 59
- 𐑗 — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 9, p. 43
- 𐑘 — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 17, p. 81
- 𐑙 — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 16, p. 77